Daily Vocabulary List
Michil

Words 1 to 1400: Stability through Understatement

Each card gives the word, part of speech, pronunciation, meaning, and two example sentences.

Day 01- 200 Words: Stability through Compound

Cards 001 to 200

Stability

noun

/stəˈbɪlɪti/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The quality of being enduring and free from change or variation
2. The quality or attribute of being firm and steadfast
3. A stable order (especially of society)

USAGE

1. The bridge's **stability** depended on the foundation beneath it.

2. Her steady job gave the family a sense of **stability**.

Biography

noun

/baɪˈɑgrəfi/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

An account of the series of events making up a person's life

USAGE

1. She is reading a **biography** of the physicist Marie Curie.

2. The museum displayed a short **biography** beside each painting.

Emulate

verb

/ˈɛmjəleɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Strive to equal or match, especially by imitating; compete with successfully

USAGE

1. To really become fluent in a new language, **emulate** the speech patterns and intonation of people who speak the language.

2. Young musicians often **emulate** the style of their heroes.

Presumptuousness

noun

/prɪˈzʌmptʃuəsnəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Audacious (even arrogant) behavior that you have no right to

USAGE

1. He despised them for their **presumptuousness**

2. His **presumptuousness** in giving orders to the director annoyed everyone.

Forecast

noun / verb

/ˈfɔrˌkæst/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) A prediction about how something (as the weather) will develop
2. (verb) Judge to be probable
3. (verb) Indicate by signs

USAGE

1. The weather **forecast** predicts heavy rain for the weekend.

2. Economists **forecast** slower growth next year.

Antipathy

noun

/ænˈtɪpəθi/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

An intense feeling of dislike or aversion

USAGE

1. Maria had an **antipathy** for tour groups, often bolting to the other side of the museum as soon as she saw a chaperone leading a group of wide-eyed tourists.

2. He felt a deep **antipathy** toward loud, crowded parties.

Neutralize

verb

/ˈnutrəˌlaɪz/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Make chemically neutral
2. Make ineffective by counterbalancing the effect of
3. Make incapable of military action

USAGE

1. She **neutralized** the solution

2. Her optimism **neutralizes** his gloom

Inhibit

verb

/ˌɪnˈhɪbət/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. To put down by force or authority
2. Limit the range or extent of
3. Control and refrain from showing; of emotions, desires, impulses, or behavior

USAGE

1. Contact between the young was **inhibited** by strict social customs

2. **Inhibit** the action of the enzyme

Contrary

noun / adjective

/ˈkɑntrɛri/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) Exact opposition
2. (noun) A relation of direct opposition
3. (adjective) In an opposing direction

USAGE

1. Public opinion to the **contrary** he is not guilty

2. A **contrary** wind

Artifact

noun

/ˈɑrtəˌfækt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

A man-made object taken as a whole

USAGE

1. Archaeologists unearthed an ancient pottery **artifact** at the dig site.

2. The glitch was an **artifact** of the old software.

Unreserved

adjective

/ˌʌnrɪˈzɜrvd/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Not cautious or reticent
2. Not reserved

USAGE

1. **Unreserved** behavior

2. She gave her **unreserved** support to the new project.

Meager

adjective

/ˈmigər/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Deficient in amount or quality or extent

USAGE

1. **Meager** resources

2. **Meager** fare

Fortify

verb

/ˈfɔrtɪˌfaɪ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Make strong or stronger
2. Add alcohol to (beverages)
3. Add nutrients to

USAGE

1. **Fortified** milk

2. The villagers **fortified** the walls before the invasion.

Anxiety

noun

/æŋˈzaɪəti/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. A vague unpleasant emotion that is experienced in anticipation of some (usually ill-defined) misfortune
2. (psychiatry) A relatively permanent state of worry and nervousness occurring in a variety of mental disorders, usually accompanied by compulsive behavior or attacks of panic

USAGE

1. Her **anxiety** grew as the exam results were delayed.

2. Public **anxiety** about the disease spread quickly.

Verdict

noun

/ˈvɜrdɪkt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

(law) The findings of a jury on issues of fact submitted to it for decision; can be used in formulating a judgment

USAGE

1. The jury reached a **verdict** after six hours of deliberation.

2. The critics gave the film a harsh **verdict**.

Castigate

verb

/ˈkæstɪgeɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

To reprimand harshly

USAGE

1. Drill sergeants are known to **castigate** new recruits so mercilessly that the latter often break down during their first week in training.

2. The coach **castigated** the team after their humiliating loss.

Encapsulate

verb

/ɛnˈkæpsəˌleɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Put in a short or concise form; reduce in volume
2. Enclose in a capsule or other small container

USAGE

1. The slogan **encapsulates** the company's entire philosophy.

2. The short poem **encapsulates** a lifetime of grief.

Spatial

adjective

/ˈspeɪʃəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Pertaining to or involving or having the nature of space

USAGE

1. The first dimension to concentrate on is the **spatial** one

2. **Spatial** ability

Authenticate

verb

/ɔˈθɛntəˌkeɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Establish the authenticity of something

USAGE

1. Experts **authenticated** the painting before the auction.

2. The bank asked him to **authenticate** his identity by phone.

Spontaneity

noun

/ˌspɑntəˈniəti/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

The quality of being spontaneous and coming from natural feelings without constraint

USAGE

1. The **spontaneity** of his laughter

2. Her **spontaneity** made every trip with her exciting.

Ameliorate

verb

/əˈmiliəreɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Make something bad better

USAGE

1. Three Cups of Tea tells the story of a western man who hopes to **ameliorate** poverty and the lack of education in Afghanistan.

2. New irrigation systems helped **ameliorate** the drought's effects on farmers.

Obscure

verb / adj.

/əbˈskjʊr/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (verb) Make unclear
2. (adj.) Known by only a few

USAGE

1. On the Smith's drive through the Grand Canyon, Mr. Smith's big head **obscured** much of Mrs. Robinson's view, so that she only saw momentary patches of red rock.

2. Many of the biggest movie stars were once **obscure** actors who got only bit roles in long forgotten films.

Neurology

noun

/nʊˈrɑlədʒi/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

The branch of medical science that deals with the nervous system

USAGE

1. He trained in **neurology** before becoming a surgeon.

2. The clinic's **neurology** department treats patients with migraines.

Lenient

adjective

/ˈliniənt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Characterized by tolerance and mercy
2. Not strict
3. Tolerant or lenient

USAGE

1. **Lenient** rules

2. The judge was **lenient** and gave him only a fine.

Popularity

noun

/ˌpɑpjəˈlɛrəti/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

The quality of being widely admired or accepted or sought after

USAGE

1. His charm soon won him affection and **popularity**

2. The universal **popularity** of American movies

Transcribe

verb

/trænsˈkraɪb/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Rewrite in a different script
2. Make a phonetic transcription of
3. Write out from speech, notes, etc.

USAGE

1. The anthropologist **transcribed** the sentences of the native informant

2. **Transcribe** the oral history of this tribe

Hinder

verb

/ˈhɪndər/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Put at a disadvantage
2. Be a hindrance or obstacle to
3. Hinder or prevent the progress or accomplishment of

USAGE

1. The brace I have to wear is **hindering** my movements

2. Heavy snow **hindered** the rescue team's progress.

Shortsighted

adjective

/ˈʃɔrˈtsaɪtɪd/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Lacking foresight or scope
2. Not given careful consideration
3. Unable to see distant objects clearly

USAGE

1. **Shortsighted** policies

2. **Shortsighted** critics derided the plan

Discrete

adj.

/dɪˈskrit/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Constituting a separate entity or part

USAGE

1. What was once known as Czechoslovakia has since split into two **discrete**, independent nations.

2. The project was divided into three **discrete** phases.

Aggravate

verb

/ˈægrəˌveɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Make worse
2. Exasperate or irritate

USAGE

1. This drug **aggravates** the pain

2. Loud music **aggravated** the headache she already had.

Explicit

adjective

/ɪksˈplɪsət/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

In accordance with fact or the primary meaning of a term

USAGE

1. **Explicit** instructions

2. She made her wishes **explicit**

Intense

adjective

/ˌɪnˈtɛns/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (of color) Having the highest saturation
2. Extremely sharp or intense
3. Possessing or displaying a distinctive feature to a heightened degree

USAGE

1. **Intense** blue

2. **Intense** itching and burning

Dermatology

noun

/ˌdərməˈtɑlədʒi/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

The branch of medicine dealing with the skin and its diseases

USAGE

1. The **dermatology** clinic treats skin conditions such as acne.

2. She studied **dermatology** to understand skin diseases.

Endure

verb

/ɛnˈdjʊr/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Put up with something or somebody unpleasant
2. Undergo or be subjected to
3. Continue to live through hardship or adversity

USAGE

1. The new secretary had to **endure** a lot of unprofessional remarks

2. The legend of Elvis **endures**

Gossamer

adj.

/ˈgɑsəmər/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Characterized by unusual lightness and delicacy

USAGE

1. The **gossamer** wings of a butterfly, which allow it to fly, are also a curse, so delicate that they are often damaged.

2. A **gossamer** veil floated over the bride's face.

Preen

verb

/prin/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Dress or groom with elaborate care
2. Pride or congratulate (oneself) for an achievement
3. Clean with one's bill

USAGE

1. The birds **preened**

2. The peacock began to **preen** its feathers in front of the crowd.

Overblown

adjective

/ˌoʊvərbˈloʊn/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Past the stage of full bloom
2. Puffed up with vanity

USAGE

1. **Overblown** roses

2. **Overblown** oratory

Occlude

verb

/əˈklud/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Block passage through

USAGE

1. A thick layer of dust **occluded** the window.

2. The blood clot **occluded** the artery.

Lose

verb

/luz/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Be set at a disadvantage
2. Fail to win
3. Retreat

USAGE

1. Our team might **lose** the game if the defense fails.

2. He will **lose** his keys if he is not careful.

Project

noun / verb

/ˈprɑdʒɛkt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) Any piece of work that is undertaken or attempted
2. (noun) A planned undertaking
3. (verb) Present for consideration, examination, criticism, etc.

USAGE

1. He **projected** his feelings

2. **Project** a missile

Flag

verb

/flæg/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Droop, sink, or settle from or as if from pressure or loss of tautness; become less intense

USAGE

1. After the three crushing defeats in the last three games, the team's enthusiasm began to **flag**.

2. Her energy began to **flag** in the final mile.

Substantiate

verb

/səbˈstæntʃiˌeɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Solidify, firm, or strengthen
2. Establish or strengthen as with new evidence or facts
3. Make real or concrete; give reality or substance to

USAGE

1. The president's trip will **substantiate** good relations with the former enemy country

2. Our ideas must be **substantiated** into actions

Alleviate

verb

/əˈliviˌeɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Provide physical relief, as from pain
2. Make easier

USAGE

1. The new medicine **alleviated** the pain within an hour.

2. Extra staff were hired to **alleviate** the long waits.

Eccentric

adj.

/ɪkˈsɛntrɪk/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Highly unconventional or usual (usually describes a person)

USAGE

1. Mozart was well-known for his **eccentricities**, often speaking words backward to confuse those around him.

2. The **eccentric** inventor wore a top hat to every meeting.

Insinuate

verb

/ˌɪnˈsɪnjueɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Give to understand
2. Introduce or insert (oneself) in a subtle manner

USAGE

1. I **insinuated** that I did not like his wife

2. He **insinuated** himself into the conversation of the people at the nearby table

Abscond

verb

/æbˈskɑnd/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Run away; usually includes taking something or somebody along

USAGE

1. The accountant **absconded** with the cash from the safe

2. The clerk **absconded** with the company's money overnight.

Satisfaction

noun

/ˌsætəsˈfækʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Act of fulfilling a desire or need or appetite
2. The contentment one feels when one has fulfilled a desire, need, or expectation
3. Compensation for a wrong

USAGE

1. The **satisfaction** of their demand for better services

2. The chef tasted the sauce with great **satisfaction**

Purchase

noun / verb

/ˈpɜrtʃəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) The acquisition of something for payment
2. (noun) A means of exerting influence or gaining advantage
3. (noun) The mechanical advantage gained by being in a position to use a lever

USAGE

1. They closed the **purchase** with a handshake

2. He could get no **purchase** on the situation

Pediatrics

noun

/ˌpidiˈætrɪks/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

The branch of medicine concerned with the treatment of infants and children

USAGE

1. The hospital's **pediatrics** ward is full of children with flu.

2. She is a doctor who specializes in **pediatrics**.

Transpose

noun / verb

/trænˈspoʊz/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) A matrix formed by interchanging the rows and columns of a given matrix
2. (verb) Cause to change places
3. (verb) Change the order or arrangement of

USAGE

1. Dyslexics often **transpose** letters in a word

2. Can you **transpose** this fugue into G major?

Sustain

verb

/səsˈteɪn/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Undergo (as of injuries and illnesses)
2. Establish or strengthen as with new evidence or facts
3. Admit as valid

USAGE

1. The court **sustained** the motion

2. She alone **sustained** her family

Cooperation

noun

/koʊˌɑpərˈeɪʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The practice of cooperating
2. Joint operation or action

USAGE

1. Economic **cooperation**

2. They agreed on a policy of **cooperation**

Relevant

adjective

/ˈrɛləvənt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Having a bearing on or connection with the subject at issue

USAGE

1. The scientist corresponds with colleagues in order to learn about matters **relevant** to her own research

2. Only the **relevant** documents need to be submitted to the court.

Exacerbate

verb

/ɪgˈzæsərbeɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Make worse

USAGE

1. Her sleeplessness **exacerbated** her cold--when she woke up the next day, her sinuses were completely blocked.

2. Skipping sleep can **exacerbate** stress and make it harder to focus.

Interpret

verb

/ˌɪnˈtɜrprət/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Make sense of a language
2. Make sense of; assign a meaning to
3. Give an interpretation or explanation to

USAGE

1. How do you **interpret** his behavior?

2. Can you **interpret** the speech of the visiting dignitaries?

Disclose

verb

/dɪsˈkloʊz/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Disclose to view as by removing a cover

USAGE

1. The auction house would not **disclose** the price at which the van Gogh had sold

2. The curtain rose to **disclose** a stunning set

Pragmatic

adj.

/præg'mætɪk/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Guided by practical experience and observation rather than theory

USAGE

1. Rather than make a philosophical appeal to the Congressmen, the Speaker decided to take a far more **pragmatic** approach, making small side-deals that would add votes to his bill.

2. A **pragmatic** approach to the budget kept the project on track.

Inconsistent

adjective

/ˌɪnkənˈsɪstənt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Not in agreement
2. Displaying a lack of consistency
3. Not capable of being made consistent or harmonious

USAGE

1. **Inconsistent** statements cannot both be true at the same time

2. **Inconsistent** with the roadmap

Texture

noun

/ˈtɛkstʃər/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The feel of a surface or a fabric
2. The characteristic appearance of a surface having a tactile quality
3. The musical pattern created by parts being played or sung together

USAGE

1. Breadfruit has the same **texture** as bread

2. Fish with a delicate flavor and **texture**

Intractable

adjective

/ˌɪnˈtræktəbəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Not tractable; difficult to manage or mold

USAGE

1. An **intractable** disposition

2. **Intractable** pain

Extend

verb

/ɪkˈstɛnd/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Extend one's limbs or muscles, or the entire body
2. Thrust or extend out
3. Increase in quantity or bulk by adding a cheaper substance

USAGE

1. **Extend** your right arm above your head

2. **Extend** a hand

Meteorology

noun

/ˌmitiərˈɑlədʒi/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The earth science dealing with phenomena of the atmosphere (especially weather)
2. Predicting what the weather will be

USAGE

1. **Meteorology** uses satellites to track storm systems.

2. He studied **meteorology** at a university in the north.

Preponderate

verb

/prɪˈpɑndəˌreɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Weigh more heavily

USAGE

1. Opinion in the town seemed to **preponderate** in favor of the bridge.

2. Women **preponderate** among the nurses in the hospital.

Relent

verb

/rɪˈlɛnt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Give in, as to influence or pressure

USAGE

1. After hours of pleading, her father finally **relented**.

2. The storm did not **relent** until the next morning.

Regret

noun / verb

/rəgˈrɛt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) Sadness associated with some wrong done or some disappointment
2. (verb) Express with regret
3. (verb) Decline formally or politely

USAGE

1. He wrote a note expressing his **regret**

2. I **regret** to say that you did not gain admission to Harvard

Abundant

adjective

/əˈbʌndənt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Present in great quantity

USAGE

1. An **abundant** supply of water

2. The region has **abundant** rainfall and fertile soil.

Accelerate

verb

/ækˈsɛlərˌeɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Move faster
2. Cause to move faster

USAGE

1. The car **accelerated**

2. He **accelerated** the car

Irony

noun

/ˈaɪrəni/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Incongruity between what might be expected and what actually occurs
2. Witty language used to convey insults or scorn;--Jonathan Swift
3. A trope that involves incongruity between what is expected and what occurs

USAGE

1. The **irony** of Ireland's copying the nation she most hated

2. **Irony** is wasted on the stupid

Pathology

noun

/pəˈθɑlədʒi/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Any deviation from a healthy or normal condition

USAGE

1. The **pathology** report showed the cause of the disease.

2. **Pathology** studies the nature and causes of illness.

Admonitory

adj.

/ədˈmɑnɪtɔri/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Serving to warn; expressing reproof or reproach, especially as a corrective

USAGE

1. At the assembly, the high school vice-principal gave the students an **admonitory** speech, warning them of the many risks and dangers of prom night.

2. She gave him an **admonitory** look that stopped him mid-sentence.

Demure

adj.

/dɪˈmjʊr/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

To be modest and shy

USAGE

1. The portrait of her in a simple white blouse was sweet and **demure**.

2. The **demure** bride lowered her eyes as she walked down the aisle.

Rectify

verb

/ˈrɛktəˌfaɪ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Convert into direct current
2. Make right or correct
3. Set straight or right

USAGE

1. **Rectify** alternating current

2. **Rectify** the calculation

Novelty

noun

/ˈnɑvəlti/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Cheap showy jewelry or ornament on clothing
2. A small inexpensive mass-produced article
3. Originality by virtue of being refreshingly novel

USAGE

1. The **novelty** of the gadget wore off within a week.

2. The child was thrilled by the **novelty** of the snow.

Circumscribe

verb

/ˈsɜrkəmskraɪb/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Restrict or confine

USAGE

1. Their tour of South America was **circumscribed** so that they saw only popular destinations and avoided the dangerous parts of cities.

2. The new rules **circumscribe** what employees may post online.

Conspiracy

noun

/kənˈspɪrəsi/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. A plot to carry out some harmful or illegal act (especially a political plot)
2. A secret agreement between two or more people to perform an unlawful act

USAGE

1. The detectives uncovered a **conspiracy** to rig the election.

2. Some people still believe in the **conspiracy** theory.

Chronological

adjective

/ˌkranəˈladʒɪkəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Relating to or arranged according to temporal order

USAGE

1. **Chronological** age

2. Please list the events in **chronological** order.

Controvert

verb

/ˌkɑntrəˈvɜrt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Prove to be false or incorrect
2. Be resistant to

USAGE

1. He **controverted** the claims made in the report.

2. The scientist **controverted** the theory with new data.

Prodigious

adj.

/prəˈdɪdʒəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

So great in size or force or extent as to elicit awe

USAGE

1. After the relatively small homerun totals in the "dead ball" era, Babe Ruth's homerun totals were truly **prodigious**: every year, he set a new all-time record.

2. The chef has a **prodigious** appetite for spicy food.

Distinct

adjective

/dɪsˈtɪŋkt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Clearly or sharply defined to the mind
2. Recognizable; marked
3. Easy to perceive; especially clearly outlined

USAGE

1. Claudius was the first to invade Britain with **distinct**…intentions of conquest

2. Trenchant **distinctions** between right and wrong

Elude

verb

/ɪˈlud/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Escape understanding

USAGE

1. Even a basic understanding of physics can **elude** most high schools students.

2. The answer seemed to **elude** every member of the team.

Corroborate

verb

/kəˈrɑbəreɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

To confirm or lend support to (usually an idea or claim)

USAGE

1. Her claim that frog populations were falling precipitously in Central America was **corroborated** by locals, who reported that many species of frogs had seemingly vanished overnight.

2. Two witnesses **corroborated** her story.

Belie

verb

/bɪˈlaɪ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Give a false representation to; misrepresent

USAGE

1. The smile on her face **belies** the pain she must feel after the death of her husband.

2. His calm face **belied** the panic he felt inside.

Expense

noun / verb

/ɪkˈspɛns/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) A detriment or sacrifice
2. (noun) Money spent to perform work and usually reimbursed by an employer
3. (verb) Reduce the estimated value of something

USAGE

1. At the **expense** of

2. He kept a careful record of his **expenses** at the meeting

Peremptory

adj.

/pəˈrɛmptəri/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Bossy and domineering

USAGE

1. My sister used to **peremptorily** tell me to do the dishes, a chore I would either do perfunctorily or avoid doing altogether.

2. The manager gave a **peremptory** order to finish the work.

Dormant

adjective

/ˈdɔrmənt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Inactive but capable of becoming active
2. (of e.g. volcanos) Not erupting and not extinct
3. In a condition of biological rest or suspended animation

USAGE

1. Her feelings of affection are **dormant** but easily awakened

2. A **dormant** volcano

Squander

verb

/ˈskwɑndər/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Spend thoughtlessly; waste time, money, or an opportunity

USAGE

1. Fearing his money would be **squandered** by his family, he gave all of it to charity when he died.

2. He **squandered** his inheritance in two years.

Reliable

adjective

/rɪˈlaɪəbəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Worthy of reliance or trust
2. Conforming to fact and therefore worthy of belief
3. Worthy of being depended on

USAGE

1. A **reliable** source of information

2. **Reliable** information

Dissemble

verb

/dɪˈsɛmbəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Conceal one's true motives, usually through deceit

USAGE

1. To get close to the senator, the assassin **dissembled** his intentions, convincing many people that he was a reporter for a well-known newspaper.

2. He tried to **dissemble**, but his story kept changing.

Decry

verb

/dɪˈkraɪ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Express strong disapproval of

USAGE

1. The entire audience erupted in shouts and curses, **decrying** the penalty card issued by the referee.

2. Environmentalists **decried** the plan to build a new highway.

Oppose

verb

/əˈpoʊz/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Be against; express opposition to
2. Be resistant to
3. Set into opposition or rivalry

USAGE

1. We **oppose** the ban on abortion

2. The board **opposed** his motion

Raise

noun / verb

/reɪz/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) The act of raising something
2. (noun) Increasing the size of a bet (as in poker)
3. (noun) The amount a salary is increased

USAGE

1. Fireman learn several different **raises** for getting ladders up

2. I'll see your **raise** and double it

Disparage

verb

/dɪsˈpɛrɪdʒ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Express a negative opinion of

USAGE

1. She **disparaged** her student's efforts

2. He **disparaged** his rival's work in front of the board.

Dispute

noun / verb

/dɪsˈpjut/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) Coming into conflict with
2. (noun) A disagreement or argument about something important
3. (verb) Have a disagreement over something

USAGE

1. He had a **dispute** with his wife

2. The two neighbors are in a **dispute** over the property line.

Assumption

noun

/əˈsʌmpʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The act of taking possession of or power over something
2. The act of assuming or taking for granted
3. Audacious (even arrogant) behavior that you have no right to

USAGE

1. His **assumption** of office coincided with the trouble in Cuba

2. The Nazi **assumption** of power in 1934

Accurate

adjective

/ˈækjərət/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Conforming exactly or almost exactly to fact or to a standard or performing with total accuracy
2. (of ideas, images, representations, expressions) Characterized by perfect conformity to fact or truth ; strictly correct

USAGE

1. An **accurate** reproduction

2. The accounting was **accurate**

Lax

adjective

/læks/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Emptying easily or excessively
2. Lacking in rigor or strictness
3. Lacking in strength or firmness or resilience

USAGE

1. Such **lax** and slipshod ways are no longer acceptable

2. **Lax** in attending classes

Commensurate

adj.

/kəˈmɛnʃərət/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

To be in proportion or corresponding in degree or amount

USAGE

1. The convicted felon's life sentence was **commensurate** to the heinousness of his crime.

2. Her salary is **commensurate** with her experience and responsibilities.

Counterfeit

noun / verb / adjective

/ˈkaʊntərˌfɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) A copy that is represented as the original
2. (verb) Make a copy of with the intent to deceive
3. (adjective) Not genuine; imitating something superior

USAGE

1. They **counterfeited** dollar bills

2. **Counterfeit** emotion

Belittle

verb

/bɪˈlɪtəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Lessen the importance, dignity, or reputation of

USAGE

1. A good teacher will never **belittle** his students, but will instead empower them.

2. Never **belittle** a student's efforts in front of the class.

Further

verb / adjective / adverb

/ˈfɜrðər/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (verb) Promote the growth of
2. (verb) Contribute to the progress or growth of
3. (adjective) More distant in especially degree

USAGE

1. Nothing could be **further** from the truth

2. **Further** from our expectations

Derive

verb

/dɪˈraɪv/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Come from; be connected by a relationship of blood
2. Reason by deduction; establish by deduction

USAGE

1. Many words in the English language are derived from Latin, including the word "**derive**."

2. From the multiple set of footprints in the living room, the investigator **derived** an important clue: Sheila was not alone in the room at the time of the murder.

Prohibitive

adjective

/proʊˈhɪbətɪv/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Tending to discourage (especially of prices)

USAGE

1. The price was **prohibitive**

2. The price of the car was **prohibitive** for most families.

Amplify

verb

/ˈæmpləˌfaɪ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Increase the volume of
2. Exaggerate or make bigger
3. Increase in size, volume or significance

USAGE

1. **Amplify** sound

2. The microphone **amplified** her voice across the large hall.

Account

noun / verb

/əˈkaʊnt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) The quality of taking advantage
2. (noun) Importance or value
3. (noun) A record or narrative description of past events

USAGE

1. She turned her writing skills to good **account**

2. A person of considerable **account**

Tacit

adjective

/ˈtæsɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Implied by or inferred from actions or statements

USAGE

1. A **tacit** agreement

2. They reached a **tacit** agreement not to mention the accident.

Pervade

verb

/pərˈveɪd/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Spread or diffuse through

USAGE

1. A sense of calm **pervaded** the village after the storm.

2. The smell of baking bread **pervaded** the whole house.

Prosper

verb

/ˈprɑspər/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Make steady progress; be at the high point in one's career or reach a high point in historical significance or importance

USAGE

1. The small shop began to **prosper** once it moved downtown.

2. Under her leadership, the company continued to **prosper**.

Laudatory

adjective

/ˈlɔdəˌtɔri/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Full of or giving praise

USAGE

1. A **laudatory** remark

2. The review was **laudatory** and praised every chapter.

Inadequate

adjective

/ˌɪˈnædəkwət/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Lacking the requisite qualities or resources to meet a task
2. Not sufficient to meet a need

USAGE

1. **Inadequate** training

2. The staff was **inadequate**

Obtain

adj.

/əbˈteɪn/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Be valid, applicable, or true

USAGE

1. The custom of waiting your turn in line does not **obtain** in some countries, in which many people try to rush to front of the line at the same time.

2. The old rule still **obtains** under the new contract.

Alternative

noun / adjective

/ɔlˈtɜrnətɪv/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) One of a number of things from which only one can be chosen
2. (adjective) Necessitating a choice between mutually exclusive possibilities
3. (adjective) Pertaining to unconventional choices

USAGE

1. There no other **alternative**

2. **Alternative** possibilities were neutrality or war

Ineffectual

adjective

/ˌɪnəˈfɛktʃuəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Not producing an intended effect
2. Lacking in power or forcefulness
3. Producing no result or effect

USAGE

1. An **ineffective** teacher

2. **Ineffective** legislation

Tortuous

adj.

/ˈtɔrtʃuəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Marked by repeated turns and bends; not straightforward

USAGE

1. Because the logic behind McMahon's side of the debate was so **tortuous**, his audience came out either completely confused or, worse, feeling they'd been tricked.

2. The **tortuous** road wound up the mountain for twenty miles.

Dividend

noun

/ˈdɪvɪˌdɛnd/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. A bonus; something extra (especially a share of a surplus)
2. A number to be divided by another number

USAGE

1. Shareholders received a **dividend** of two dollars per share.

2. The new policy will pay **dividends** in the long run.

Buttress

verb

/ˈbʌtrəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Make stronger or defensible

USAGE

1. China's economy has been **buttressed** by a global demand for the electronic parts the country manufactures.

2. New beams **buttress** the old bridge against strong winds.

Illicit

adj.

/ɪˈlɪsɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Contrary to or forbidden by law

USAGE

1. Though Al Capone was engaged in many **illicit** activities, he was finally arrested for income tax evasion, a relatively minor offense.

2. The police seized **illicit** goods at the border.

Promote

verb

/prəˈmoʊt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Make publicity for; try to sell (a product)
2. Be changed for a superior chess or checker piece
3. Give a promotion to or assign to a higher position

USAGE

1. I got **promoted** after many years of hard work

2. I am **promoting** the use of computers in the classroom

Adversity

noun

/ædˈvɜrsɪˌti/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. A stroke of ill fortune; a calamitous event
2. A state of misfortune or affliction

USAGE

1. A period marked by **adversities**

2. Debt-ridden farmers struggling with **adversity**

Sparse

adjective

/spars/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Not dense

USAGE

1. Trees were **sparse**

2. The **sparse** crowd at the concert made the hall feel empty.

Thrive

verb

/θraɪv/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Grow vigorously

USAGE

1. Plants **thrive** in bright, indirect sunlight.

2. The community continued to **thrive** despite the drought.

Accumulate

verb

/əkˈjumjəˌleɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Collect or gather
2. Get or gather together

USAGE

1. Journals are **accumulating** in my office

2. I am **accumulating** evidence for the man's unfaithfulness to his wife

Nutrient

noun / adjective

/ˈnutriənt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

(adjective) Of or providing nourishment

USAGE

1. Roots absorb **nutrients** from the soil.

2. Spinach is rich in vitamins and other **nutrients**.

Resistance

noun

/rɪˈzɪstəns/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The action of opposing something that you disapprove or disagree with
2. The military action of resisting the enemy's advance
3. Group action in opposition to those in power

USAGE

1. He encountered a general feeling of **resistance** from many citizens

2. The enemy offered little **resistance**

Credible

adjective

/ˈkrɛdəbəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Appearing to merit belief or acceptance
2. Capable of being believed
3. (a common but incorrect usage where `credulous' would be appropriate) Credulous

USAGE

1. A **credible** witness

2. Completely **credible** testimony

Unassailable

adj.

/ˌʌnəˈseɪləbəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Immune to attack; without flaws

USAGE

1. Professor Williams is so self-assured as to seem arrogant, presenting each and every opinion as an **unassailable** fact.

2. His lead in the polls seemed **unassailable**.

Portability

noun

/ˌpɔrtəˈbɪlɪti/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

The quality of being light enough to be carried

USAGE

1. The **portability** of the laptop makes it ideal for travel.

2. **Portability** is the main advantage of the new phone.

Allege

verb

/əˈlɛdʒ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Report or maintain

USAGE

1. He **alleged** that he was the victim of a crime

2. The prosecutor **alleged** that the director had hidden the funds.

Fidelity

noun

/fəˈdɛləti/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

The quality of being faithful

USAGE

1. The dog showed great **fidelity** to its owner.

2. The recording has remarkable **fidelity** to the original sound.

Compensate

verb

/ˈkɑmpənˌseɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Make payment to; compensate
2. Make amends for; pay compensation for
3. Do or give something to somebody in return

USAGE

1. She was **compensated** for the loss of her arm in the accident

2. He is **compensating** for being a bad father

Despair

noun / verb

/dɪsˈpɛr/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) The feeling that everything is wrong and nothing will turn out well
2. (noun) A state in which all hope is lost or absent
3. (verb) Abandon hope; give up hope; lose heart

USAGE

1. They moaned in **despair** and dismay

2. One harsh word would send her into the depths of **despair**

Conflate

verb

/kənˈfleɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Mix together different elements or concepts

USAGE

1. In her recent book, the author **conflates** several genres--the detective story, the teen thriller, and the vampire romance--to create a memorable read.

2. Critics often **conflate** fame with talent.

Commodity

noun

/kəˈmɑdəti/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Articles of commerce

USAGE

1. Oil and wheat are important **commodities** in global trade.

2. Water was a precious **commodity** during the drought.

Diminish

verb

/dɪˈmɪnɪʃ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Decrease in size, extent, or range
2. Lessen the authority, dignity, or reputation of

USAGE

1. The noise of the traffic began to **diminish** after midnight.

2. The hope of finding survivors slowly **diminished**.

Ecology

noun

/ɪˈkɑlədʒi/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

The environment as it relates to living organisms

USAGE

1. It changed the **ecology** of the island

2. The **ecology** of the lake changed after the factory opened.

Elevate

verb

/ˈɛləˌveɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Raise in rank or condition
2. Raise from a lower to a higher position
3. Give a promotion to or assign to a higher position

USAGE

1. The new job **elevated** her to a senior position.

2. The platform **elevates** the speaker above the crowd.

Extrapolate

verb

/ɪkˈstræpəˌleɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Draw from specific cases for more general cases

USAGE

1. By **extrapolating** from the data on the past three months, we can predict a 5% increase in traffic to our website.

2. Scientists **extrapolate** from small samples to predict larger trends.

Lumber

noun / verb

/ˈlʌmbər/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) An implement used in baseball by the batter
2. (noun) The wood of trees cut and prepared for use as building material
3. (verb) Cut lumber, as in woods and forests

USAGE

1. The heavy man **lumbered** across the room

2. The truck was loaded with **lumber** for the new barn.

Comply

verb

/kəmˈplaɪ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Act in accordance with someone's rules, commands, or wishes

USAGE

1. You must **comply** or else!

2. All employees must **comply** with the safety rules.

Subtlety

noun

/ˈsʌtəlti/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The quality of being difficult to detect or analyze
2. A subtle difference in meaning or opinion or attitude

USAGE

1. You had to admire the **subtlety** of the distinctions he drew

2. The **subtlety** of her humor escaped the younger audience.

Simultaneous

adjective

/ˌsaɪməlˈteɪniəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Occurring or operating at the same time

USAGE

1. The two events took place at **simultaneous** times in different cities.

2. The translators gave **simultaneous** interpretations at the conference.

Ensure

verb

/ɛnˈʃʊr/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Be careful or certain to do something; make certain of something
2. Make certain of

USAGE

1. This nest egg will **ensure** a nice retirement for us

2. Please check the wiring to **ensure** the lights work properly.

Financial

adjective

/fəˈnænʃəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Involving financial matters

USAGE

1. The company published its **financial** results for the year.

2. He needed **financial** help to pay for college.

Scarcity

noun

/ˈskɛrsɪti/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

A small and inadequate amount

USAGE

1. The **scarcity** of water forced the farmers to change their crops.

2. Doctors complained about the **scarcity** of nurses.

Simplistic

adjective

/sɪmˈplɪstɪk/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Characterized by extreme and often misleading simplicity

USAGE

1. A **simplistic** theory of the universe

2. **Simplistic** arguments of the ruling party

Eradicate

verb

/ɪˈrædɪkeɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

To completely destroy

USAGE

1. I tried **eradicating** the mosquitos in my apartment with a rolled up newspaper, but there were too many of them.

2. Vaccination campaigns have helped **eradicate** several once-common diseases.

Emotional

adjective

/ɪˈmoʊʃənəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (of persons) Excessively affected by emotion
2. Of more than usual emotion
3. Determined or actuated by emotion rather than reason

USAGE

1. He would become **emotional** over nothing at all

2. His behavior was highly **emotional**

Absolve

verb

/əbˈzɑlv/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Let off the hook
2. Grant remission of a sin to

USAGE

1. I **absolve** you from this responsibility

2. The priest **absolved** him and told him to say ten Hail Mary's

Vulnerable

adjective

/ˈvʌlnərəbəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Capable of being wounded or hurt
2. Susceptible to criticism or persuasion or temptation
3. Susceptible to attack

USAGE

1. **Vulnerable** parts of the body

2. **Vulnerable** to bribery

Resent

verb

/rɪˈzɛnt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Feel bitter or indignant about
2. Wish ill or allow unwillingly

USAGE

1. She **resents** being paid less than her co-workers

2. She **resented** being told what to do by her younger brother.

Exclude

verb

/ɪksˈklud/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Prevent from being included or considered or accepted
2. Prevent from entering; keep out
3. Put out or expel from a place

USAGE

1. The bad results were **excluded** from the report

2. The unruly student was **excluded** from the game

Engender

verb

/ɪnˈdʒɛndər/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Give rise to

USAGE

1. The restrictions of the Treaty of Versailles were so severe that they **engendered** deep hatred and resentment in the German people.

2. Poor communication often **engenders** suspicion among team members.

Cautious

noun / adjective

/ˈkɔʃəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) People who are fearful and cautious
2. (adjective) Showing careful forethought
3. (adjective) Avoiding excess

USAGE

1. Reserved and **cautious**; never making swift decisions

2. A **cautious** driver

Pretense

noun

/priˈtɛns/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The act of giving a false appearance
2. An artful or simulated semblance
3. A false or unsupportable quality

USAGE

1. His conformity was only **pretending**

2. He lived with an air of **pretense**, pretending to be wealthy.

Vogue

noun

/voʊg/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The popular taste at a given time
2. A current state of general acceptance and use

USAGE

1. Leather is the latest **vogue**

2. Bright colors are back in **vogue** this season.

Nurture

noun / verb

/ˈnɜrtʃər/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) Helping someone grow up to be an accepted member of the community
2. (verb) Help develop, help grow
3. (verb) Provide with nourishment

USAGE

1. They debated whether nature or **nurture** was more important

2. **Nurture** his talents

Dearth

noun

/dɜrθ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

A lack or shortage

USAGE

1. I am surprised by the **dearth** of fast food chains; this is America and I assumed they were on every street.

2. There was a **dearth** of qualified applicants for the job.

Mitigate

verb

/ˈmɪtɪgeɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Make less severe or harsh
2. Lessen the severity of an offense

USAGE

1. I can only spend so much time **mitigating** your disagreements with your wife, and at certain point, you need to do it on your own.

2. If it weren't for the **mitigating** circumstances, he would have certainly lost his job.

Encompass

verb

/ɛnˈkʌmpəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Include in scope; include as part of something broader; have as one's sphere or territory

USAGE

1. This group **encompasses** a wide range of people from different backgrounds

2. The park **encompasses** forests, lakes, and mountain trails.

Rigidity

noun

/rɪˈdʒɪdəti/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The quality of being rigid and rigorously severe
2. The physical property of being stiff and resisting bending

USAGE

1. The **rigidity** of the rules prevented any flexibility.

2. Her **rigidity** made it hard to work with her.

Problematic

adjective

/ˌprɑbləˈmætɪk/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Making great mental demands; hard to comprehend or solve or believe
2. Open to doubt or debate

USAGE

1. A **problematic** situation at home

2. If you ever get married, which seems to be extremely **problematic**

Resolve

verb

/rɪˈzɑlv/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Reach a conclusion after a discussion or deliberation

USAGE

1. After much thought, Ted **resolved** not to travel abroad this summer because he didn't have much money in his bank account.

2. The committee needed to **resolve** the dispute before Friday.

Strive

verb

/straɪv/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. To exert much effort or energy
2. Attempt by employing effort

USAGE

1. Students **strive** to earn high grades every semester.

2. We must **strive** for peace in every situation.

Impair

verb

/ˌɪmˈpɛr/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Make worse or less effective
2. Make imperfect

USAGE

1. His vision was **impaired**

2. Lack of sleep can **impair** your judgment and memory.

Justify

verb

/ˈdʒʌstəˌfaɪ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Adjust the spaces between words
2. Defend, explain, clear away, or make excuses for by reasoning
3. Show to be right by providing justification or proof

USAGE

1. **Justify** the margins

2. The end **justifies** the means

Legend

noun

/ˈlɛdʒənd/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Brief description accompanying an illustration
2. A story about mythical or supernatural beings or events

USAGE

1. According to **legend**, the castle is haunted by a ghost.

2. The explorer became a **legend** in his own lifetime.

Disrupt

verb

/dɪsˈrʌpt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Interfere in someone else's activity
2. Throw into disorder
3. Make a break in

USAGE

1. This event **disrupted** the orderly process

2. A power cut **disrupted** the broadcast for an hour.

Slack

noun / verb / adjective

/slæk/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) A cord or rope or cable that is hanging loosely
2. (noun) The quality of being loose (not taut)
3. (noun) A soft wet area of low-lying land that sinks underfoot

USAGE

1. He took up the **slack**

2. He hadn't counted on the **slackness** of the rope

Severe

adjective

/səˈvɪr/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Causing fear or anxiety by threatening great harm
2. Very bad in degree or extent
3. Unsparing and uncompromising in discipline or judgment

USAGE

1. A **severe** case of pneumonia

2. A **severe** worldwide depression

Ponderous

adj.

/ˈpɑndərəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Weighed-down; moving slowly

USAGE

1. Laden with 20 kilograms of college text books, the freshman moved **ponderously** across the campus.

2. The **ponderous** speech dragged on for almost two hours.

Loose

verb / adjective / adverb

/lus/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (verb) Become loose or looser or less tight
2. (verb) Make loose or looser
3. (verb) Turn loose or free from restraint

USAGE

1. The noose **loosened**

2. **Loosen** the tension on a rope

Quiescent

adjective

/kwaɪˈɛsənt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (pathology) Causing no symptoms
2. Being quiet or still or inactive
3. Not active or activated

USAGE

1. A **quiescent** tumor

2. The **quiescent** level of centimeter wave-length solar radiation

Condone

verb

/kənˈdoʊn/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Excuse, overlook, or make allowances for; be lenient with

USAGE

1. She **condoned** her husband's occasional infidelities

2. The school will not **condone** cheating of any kind.

Taciturn

adj.

/ˈtæsɪtɜrn/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Habitually reserved and uncommunicative

USAGE

1. While the CEO enthusiastically shares his plans and agenda with all who will listen, the CFO is far more **taciturn**, rarely revealing his perspective.

2. The **taciturn** farmer rarely spoke more than three words at a time.

Proliferate

verb

/proʊˈlɪfərˌeɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Cause to grow or increase rapidly
2. Grow rapidly

USAGE

1. We must not **proliferate** nuclear arms

2. Pizza parlors **proliferate** in this area

Auditory

adjective

/ˈɔdɪˌtɔri/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Of or relating to the process of hearing

USAGE

1. **Auditory** processing

2. The test measures **auditory** memory and hearing.

Pose

noun / verb

/poʊz/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) A deliberate pretense or exaggerated display
2. (noun) Affected manners intended to impress others
3. (noun) A posture assumed by models for photographic or artistic purposes

USAGE

1. She **posed** as the Czar's daughter

2. We don't know the woman who **posed** for Leonardo so often

Deride

verb

/dɪˈraɪd/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Treat or speak of with contempt

USAGE

1. The nun **derided** the students for trying to sneak insects and worms into the classroom.

2. Critics **derided** the new design as ugly and impractical.

Resolution

noun

/ˌrɛzəˈluʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Finding a solution to a problem
2. A decision to do something or to behave in a certain manner
3. The trait of being resolute

USAGE

1. He always wrote down his New Year's **resolutions**

2. His **resoluteness** carried him through the battle

Sensitive

noun / adjective

/ˈsɛnsətɪv/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) Someone who serves as an intermediary between the living and the dead
2. (adjective) Hurting
3. (adjective) Able to feel or perceive

USAGE

1. A mimosa's leaves are **sensitive** to touch

2. A **sensitive** voltmeter

Adversary

noun

/ˈædvərˌsɛri/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Someone who offers opposition

USAGE

1. The general faced a fierce **adversary** on the battlefield.

2. The two lawyers became fierce **adversaries** in court.

Awkward

adjective

/ˈɑkwərd/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Socially uncomfortable; unsure and constrained in manner
2. Causing inconvenience
3. Hard to deal with; especially causing pain or embarrassment

USAGE

1. **Awkward** and reserved at parties

2. They arrived at an **awkward** time

Grace

noun / verb

/greɪs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) A disposition to kindness and compassion
2. (noun) (Christian theology) the free and unmerited favor or beneficence of God
3. (noun) A sense of propriety and consideration for others

USAGE

1. The victor's **grace** in treating the vanquished

2. God's **grace** is manifested in the salvation of sinners

Exculpate

verb

/ˌɛkˈskʌlpeɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Pronounce not guilty of criminal charges

USAGE

1. The new evidence **exculpated** the accused man.

2. The report **exculpates** the company from any blame.

Concern

noun / verb

/kənˈsɜrn/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) Something that interests you because it is important or affects you
2. (noun) Something or someone that causes anxiety; a source of unhappiness
3. (noun) A feeling of sympathy for someone or something

USAGE

1. The safety of the ship is the captain's **concern**

2. New York traffic is a constant **concern**

Context

noun

/ˈkɑntɛkst/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

The set of facts or circumstances that surround a situation or event

USAGE

1. The historical **context**

2. Read the sentence in **context** before choosing an answer.

Enumerate

verb

/ɪˈnumərˌeɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Determine the number or amount of
2. Specify individually, one by one

USAGE

1. The survey **enumerates** the number of happy workers and the number of unhappy workers.

2. I sat and listened as she **enumerated** all of the things she did not like about the past three months.

Evolution

noun

/ˌɛvəˈluʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. A process in which something passes by degrees to a different stage (especially a more advanced or mature stage)
2. (biology) The sequence of events involved in the evolutionary development of a species or taxonomic group of organisms

USAGE

1. The **evolution** of Greek civilization

2. The **evolution** of language happens over many centuries.

Sincere

adjective

/sɪnˈsɪr/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Characterized by a firm and humorless belief in the validity of your opinions
2. Open and genuine; not deceitful

USAGE

1. An entirely **sincere** and cruel tyrant

2. He was a good man, decent and **sincere**

Contradict

verb

/ˌkɑntrəˈdɪkt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Prove negative; show to be false
2. Be resistant to
3. Deny the truth of

USAGE

1. His story **contradicted** the statements of two witnesses.

2. The new results **contradict** the earlier findings.

Complicate

verb

/ˈkɑmplə˩keɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Make more complex, intricate, or richer
2. Make more complicated

USAGE

1. There was a new development that **complicated** the matter

2. The rain **complicated** our plans for a picnic.

Assault

noun / verb

/əˈsɔlt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) Close fighting during the culmination of a military attack
2. (noun) Thoroughbred that won the triple crown in 1946

USAGE

1. The mugger **assaulted** the woman

2. Nightmares **assailed** him regularly

Receipt

noun / verb

/rɪˈsit/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) The act of receiving
2. (noun) An acknowledgment (usually tangible) that payment has been made
3. (verb) Mark or stamp as paid

USAGE

1. Keep the **receipt** in case you need to return the item.

2. The clerk handed me a **receipt** for the payment.

Contumacy

noun

/ˈkɑntjəməsi/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Obstinate rebelliousness and insubordination; resistance to authority

USAGE

1. The defendant's **contumacy** in court angered the judge.

2. He showed **contumacy** by ignoring every court order.

Economic

adjective

/ˌɛkəˈnɑmɪk/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Using the minimum of time or resources necessary for effectiveness
2. Financially rewarding
3. Concerned with worldly necessities of life (especially money)

USAGE

1. An **economic** use of home heating oil

2. A modern **economical** heating system

Imperative

noun / adjective

/ˌɪmˈpɛrətɪv/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) Some duty that is essential and urgent
2. (noun) A mood that expresses an intention to influence the listener's behavior
3. (adjective) Requiring attention or action

USAGE

1. As nuclear weapons proliferate, preventing war becomes **imperative**

2. Requests that grew more and more **imperative**

Preventive

noun / adjective

/prɪˈvɛntɪv/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) An agent or device intended to prevent conception
2. (noun) Any obstruction that impedes or is burdensome
3. (noun) Remedy that prevents or slows the course of an illness or disease

USAGE

1. The doctor recommended several **preventatives**

2. **Preventive** medicine

Economy

noun

/ɪˈkɑnəmi/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. An act of economizing; reduction in cost
2. Frugality in the expenditure of money or resources
3. The efficient use of resources

USAGE

1. It was a small **economy** to walk to work every day

2. The Scots are famous for their **economy**

Nuance

noun

/ˈnuːɑns/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

A subtle difference in meaning or opinion or attitude

USAGE

1. Because of the **nuances** involved in this case, I hired an outside consultant to advice us and help.

2. The translator caught a subtle **nuance** that the literal version missed.

Extenuate

verb

/ɪkˈstɛnjuˌeɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Lessen or to try to lessen the seriousness or extent of

USAGE

1. The circumstances **extenuate** the crime

2. Nothing could **extenuate** his crime in the eyes of the public.

Compound

verb

/kəmˈpaʊnd/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Make more intense, stronger, or more marked

USAGE

1. Her headache was **compounded** by the construction crew outside, which had six jackhammers going at the same time.

2. Losing the key player **compounded** the team's problems.

Day 02- 200 Words: Reconciliation through Capitulate

Cards 201 to 400

Reconciliation

noun

/ˌrɛkənˌsɪliˈeɪʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Getting two things to correspond
2. The reestablishing of cordial relations

USAGE

1. The **reconciliation** of his checkbook and the bank statement

2. After years of silence, the brothers reached a **reconciliation**.

Enthusiasm

noun

/ɪnˈθuziˌæzəm/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Overflowing with eager enjoyment or approval
2. A lively interest
3. A feeling of excitement

USAGE

1. **Enthusiasm** for his program is growing

2. Her **enthusiasm** for science inspired her students.

Inordinate

adjective

/ˌɪˈnɔrdənɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Beyond normal limits

USAGE

1. A book of **inordinate** length

2. He spends an **inordinate** amount of time on social media.

Aseptic

adjective

/eɪˈsɛptɪk/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Free of or using methods to keep free of pathological microorganisms

USAGE

1. **Aseptic** surgical instruments

2. **Aseptic** surgical techniques

Deposit

noun / verb

/dəˈpɑzɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) The act of putting something somewhere
2. (noun) A facility where things can be deposited for storage or safekeeping
3. (noun) A payment given as a guarantee that an obligation will be met

USAGE

1. His **deposit** was refunded when he returned the car

2. **Deposit** the suitcase on the bench

Presumptuous

adj.

/prɪˈzʌmptʃuəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Excessively forward

USAGE

1. Many felt that Barney was **presumptuous** in moving into the large office before the management even made any official announcement of his promotion.

2. It was **presumptuous** of him to speak for the whole group.

Consensus

noun

/kənˈsɛnsəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Agreement in the judgment or opinion reached by a group as a whole

USAGE

1. The lack of **consensus** reflected differences in theoretical positions

2. Those rights and obligations are based on an unstated **consensus**

Territory

noun

/ˈtɛrɪˌtɔri/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. An area of knowledge or interest
2. The geographical area under the jurisdiction of a sovereign state
3. A region marked off for administrative or other purposes

USAGE

1. His questions covered a lot of **territory**

2. The wolves defend their **territory** from other packs.

Charisma

noun

/kərˈɪzmə/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

A personal attractiveness or interestingness that enables you to influence others

USAGE

1. Her **charisma** made her a natural leader.

2. The actor's **charisma** filled the entire stage.

Subordinate

noun / verb / adjective

/səˈbɔrdəˌneɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) A word that is more specific than a given word
2. (noun) An assistant subject to the authority or control of another
3. (verb) Make subordinate, dependent, or subservient

USAGE

1. Our wishes have to be **subordinated** to that of our ruler

2. Art is sometimes **subordinated** to Science in these schools

Independence

noun

/ˌɪndɪˈpɛndəns/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The successful ending of the American Revolution
2. A city in western Missouri; the beginning of the Santa Fe Trail
3. Freedom from control or influence of another or others

USAGE

1. They maintained close relations with England even after **independence**

2. The country celebrated its **independence** with a parade.

Convoluted

adj.

/ˈkɑnvəˌluːtɪd/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Highly complex or intricate

USAGE

1. Instead of solving the math problem in three simple steps, Kumar used a **convoluted** solution requiring fifteen steps.

2. The **convoluted** plot made the movie hard to follow.

Precarious

adj.

/prɪˈkɛriəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Fraught with danger

USAGE

1. People smoke to relax and forget their cares, but ironically, in terms of health risks, smoking is far more **precarious** than either mountain-climbing or skydiving.

2. The **precarious** bridge swayed in the strong wind.

Margin

noun

/ˈmɑrdʒən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. A permissible difference; allowing some freedom to move within limits
2. An amount beyond the minimum necessary
3. The blank space that surrounds the text on a page

USAGE

1. The **margin** of victory

2. He jotted a note in the **margin**

Mean

noun / verb / adjective

/min/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (verb) Have in mind as a purpose
2. (verb) Destine or designate for a certain purpose
3. (verb) Intend to refer to

USAGE

1. I **mean** no harm

2. I only **meant** to help you

Disillusionment

noun

/ˌdɪsɪˈluʒənmənt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Freeing from false belief or illusions

USAGE

1. Years of broken promises led to **disillusionment** with the government.

2. Her **disillusionment** with the job was complete.

Obviate

verb

/ˈɑbviˌeɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Prevent the occurrence of; prevent from happening
2. Do away with

USAGE

1. A quick check now will **obviate** the need for repairs later.

2. The new bridge **obviates** the long ferry ride.

Provocative

adjective

/proʊˈvɑkətɪv/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Exciting sexual desire

USAGE

1. A **provocative** remark

2. A **provocative** smile

Erudite

adj.

/ˈɛrjʊˌdaɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Having or showing profound knowledge

USAGE

1. Before the Internet, the library was typically were you would find **erudite** readers.

2. The **erudite** historian quoted sources written in five different languages.

Permanent

noun / adjective

/ˈpɜrmənənt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) A series of waves in the hair made by applying heat and chemicals
2. (adjective) Not capable of being reversed or returned to the original condition

USAGE

1. **Permanent** secretary to the president

2. **Permanent** address

Defer

verb

/dɪˈfɜr/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Yield to another's wish or opinion
2. Hold back to a later time

USAGE

1. We decided to **defer** the decision until next month.

2. Junior staff often **defer** to senior colleagues.

Privilege

noun / verb

/ˈprɪvlədʒ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) A special advantage or immunity or benefit not enjoyed by all
2. (verb) Bestow a privilege upon

USAGE

1. It is a **privilege** to speak at this event.

2. Attending the top school was a **privilege** for her family.

Liquidity

noun

/lɪkˈwɪdəti/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Being in cash or easily convertible to cash; debt paying ability
2. The property of flowing easily

USAGE

1. The company struggled with **liquidity** after losing its main client.

2. Cash offers high **liquidity** for investors.

Pristine

adj.

/ˈprɪstɪn/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Unspoiled, untouched (usu. of nature)
2. Immaculately clean and unused

USAGE

1. The glacial lake was **pristine** and we filled our canteens to drink deeply.

2. Drill sergeants are known for demanding **pristine** cabinets, uniforms, and beds, and often make new recruits clean and clean and clean until they meet the expected high standards.

Ambivalence

noun

/æmˈbɪvələns/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Mixed feelings or emotions

USAGE

1. She felt **ambivalence** about moving to a new city.

2. His **ambivalence** was obvious in every answer.

Reliance

noun

/rɪˈlaɪəns/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Certainty based on past experience
2. The state of relying on something

USAGE

1. He wrote the paper with considerable **reliance** on the work of other scientists

2. The village's **reliance** on fishing makes it vulnerable to bad seasons.

Boor

noun

/bʊr/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

A crude uncouth ill-bred person lacking culture or refinement

USAGE

1. The **boor** interrupted every speaker at the dinner.

2. No one wanted to sit next to the **boor** at the wedding.

Negotiate

verb

/nəˈgoʊʃiˌeɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Discuss the terms of an arrangement
2. Succeed in passing through, around, or over

USAGE

1. They **negotiated** the sale of the house

2. The union will **negotiate** a new contract next month.

Tension

noun

/ˈtɛnʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The action of stretching something tight
2. (physics) A stress that produces an elongation of an elastic physical body
3. Feelings of hostility that are not manifest

USAGE

1. **Tension** holds the belt in the pulleys

2. The direction of maximum **tension** moves asymptotically toward the direction of the shear

Rhetoric

noun

/ˈrɛtərɪk/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Loud and confused and empty talk
2. High-flown style; excessive use of verbal ornamentation
3. Using language effectively to please or persuade

USAGE

1. Mere **rhetoric**

2. The politician's **rhetoric** was full of empty promises.

Estranged

adjective

/ɛsˈtreɪndʒd/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Caused to be unloved

USAGE

1. He has been **estranged** from his father for ten years.

2. The **estranged** couple finally agreed to meet.

Animate

verb / adjective

/ˈænəmət/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (verb) Give new life or energy to
2. (verb) Make lively
3. (verb) Give lifelike qualities to

USAGE

1. **Animated** cartoons

2. We are **animate** beings

Sensitivity

noun

/ˌsɛnsɪˈtɪvɪti/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The ability to respond to affective changes in your interpersonal environment
2. (physiology) Responsiveness to external stimuli; the faculty of sensation
3. Sensitivity to emotional feelings (of self and others)

USAGE

1. A galvanometer of extreme **sensitivity**

2. The **sensitiveness** of Mimosa leaves does not depend on a change of growth

Qualified

adjective

/ˈkwɑləˌfaɪd/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Contingent on something else
2. Restricted in meaning; (as e.g. `man' in `a tall man')
3. Limited or restricted; not absolute

USAGE

1. Many **qualified** applicants for the job

2. Gave only **qualified** approval

Repress

verb

/rip'rɛs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Block the action of
2. Put out of one's consciousness
3. Conceal or hide

USAGE

1. Governments sometimes **repress** protests with force.

2. She tried to **repress** her laughter during the serious speech.

Precious

adjective / adverb

/ˈprɛʃəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (adjective) Obviously contrived to charm
2. (adjective) Characterized by feeling or showing fond affection for
3. (adjective) Of high worth or cost

USAGE

1. An insufferably **precious** performance

2. Children are **precious**

Specialisation

noun

/ˌspɛʃəlaɪˈzeɪʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The special line of work you have adopted as your career
2. The act of specializing; making something suitable for a special purpose
3. (biology) The structural adaptation of some body part for a particular function

USAGE

1. Doctors often choose a **specialisation** after medical school.

2. **Specialisation** allows workers to master one skill.

Foster

noun / verb / adjective

/ˈfɑstər/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (verb) Help develop, help grow
2. (verb) Bring up under fosterage; of children
3. (verb) Promote the growth of

USAGE

1. **Foster** our children's well-being and education

2. **Foster** parent

Reconcile

verb

/ˈrɛkənsaɪl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Make (one thing) compatible with (another)

USAGE

1. Peggy was unable to **reconcile** her kind friend Jane with the cruel and merciless character Jane played on television.

2. Can you **reconcile** these two conflicting reports?

Demise

noun / verb

/dɪˈmaɪz/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) The time when something ends
2. (verb) Transfer by a lease or by a will

USAGE

1. The **demise** of the old factory left hundreds of workers jobless.

2. The **demise** of the local newspaper saddened the whole town.

Agreeable

adjective

/əgˈriəbəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Conforming to your own liking or feelings or nature
2. Prepared to agree or consent
3. In keeping

USAGE

1. Is the plan **agreeable** to you?

2. He's an **agreeable** fellow

Clot

noun / verb

/klat/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) A lump of material formed from the content of a liquid
2. (verb) Coalesce or unite in a mass
3. (verb) Turn into curds

USAGE

1. Blood **clots**

2. A small **clot** blocked the blood vessel.

Nutrition

noun

/nutˈrɪʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The scientific study of food and drink (especially in humans)
2. A source of materials to nourish the body

USAGE

1. Good **nutrition** is important for healthy growth.

2. The school improved the **nutrition** of its lunch menu.

Reputation

noun

/ˌrɛpjəˈteɪʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The general estimation that the public has for a person
2. The state of being held in high esteem and honor
3. Notoriety for some particular characteristic

USAGE

1. He acquired a **reputation** as an actor before he started writing

2. His **reputation** for promiscuity

Disprove

verb

/dɪsˈpruv/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Prove to be false

USAGE

1. The physicist **disproved** his colleagues' theories

2. The experiment **disproved** the old theory.

Console

noun / verb

/ˈkɑnsoʊl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) Housing for electronic instruments, as radio or television
2. (noun) A small table fixed to a wall or designed to stand against a wall

USAGE

1. The bust of Napoleon stood on a **console**

2. The teacher tried to **console** the crying child.

Vituperate

adj.

/vaɪˈtupəˌreɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

To criticize harshly; to berate

USAGE

1. Jason had dealt with disciplinarians before, but nothing prepared him for the first week of boot camp, as drill sergeants **vituperated** him for petty oversights such as forgetting to double knot the laces on his boots.

2. The tabloids **vituperated** the actress for weeks.

Extreme

noun / adjective

/ɛksˈtrim/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) The furthest or highest degree of something
2. (noun) The point located farthest from the middle of something
3. (adjective) Most distant in any direction

USAGE

1. He carried it to **extremes**

2. The **extreme** edge of town

Tangible

adjective

/ˈtændʒəbəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Capable of being treated as fact
2. Perceptible by the senses especially the sense of touch

USAGE

1. **Tangible** evidence

2. Skin with a **tangible** roughness

Considerable

adjective

/kənˈsɪdərəbəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Large or relatively large in number or amount or extent or degree

USAGE

1. A **considerable** quantity

2. The economy was a **considerable** issue in the campaign

Detrimental

adj.

/ˌdɛtrɪˈmɛntəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

(sometimes followed by "to") Causing harm or injury

USAGE

1. Many know that smoking is **detrimental** to your health, but processed sugar in large quantities is equally bad.

2. Lack of sleep is **detrimental** to memory and mood.

Unfeigned

adjective

/ˌʌnˈfeɪnd/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Not pretended; sincerely felt or expressed

USAGE

1. Her interest in people was **unfeigned**

2. Her **unfeigned** joy at the news was obvious to everyone.

Caustic

noun / adjective

/ˈkɑstɪk/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) Any chemical substance that burns or destroys living tissue
2. (adjective) Harsh or corrosive in tone

USAGE

1. **Caustic** jokes about political assassination, talk-show hosts and medical ethics

2. His **caustic** remarks hurt the feelings of the entire team.

Distort

verb

/dɪsˈtɔrt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Alter the shape of (something) by stress
2. Make false by mutilation or addition; as of a message or story
3. Affect as in thought or feeling

USAGE

1. The mirror **distorted** his reflection into a strange shape.

2. Biased reports can **distort** the facts.

Refine

verb

/rəˈfaɪn/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Make more complex, intricate, or richer
2. Make more precise or increase the discriminatory powers of
3. Attenuate or reduce in vigor, strength, or validity by polishing or purifying

USAGE

1. **Refine** a design or pattern

2. **Refine** a method of analysis

Cynicism

noun

/ˈsɪnɪˌsɪzəm/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

A cynical feeling of distrust

USAGE

1. Years of corruption had filled the voters with **cynicism**.

2. Her **cynicism** made her doubt every promise.

Negotiation

noun

/nɪˌgoʊʃiˈeɪʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The activity or business of negotiating an agreement; coming to terms
2. A discussion intended to produce an agreement

USAGE

1. The buyout **negotiation** lasted several days

2. The **negotiation** between the two companies lasted all night.

Dissuade

verb

/dɪsˈweɪd/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Turn away from by persuasion

USAGE

1. Negative campaigning will only **dissuade** people

2. Her parents tried to **dissuade** her from quitting school.

Loathe

verb

/loʊð/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Find repugnant

USAGE

1. I **loathe** that man

2. She **loathes** the smell of cigarette smoke.

Courteous

adjective

/ˈkɜrtiəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Characterized by courtesy and gracious good manners
2. Exhibiting courtesy and politeness

USAGE

1. If a man be gracious and **courteous** to strangers it shows he is a citizen of the world

2. The **courteous** waiter held the door open for us.

Impose

verb

/ˌɪmˈpoʊz/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Impose something unpleasant
2. Impose and collect
3. Compel to behave in a certain way

USAGE

1. Social relations **impose** courtesy

2. The new law will **impose** a tax on sugary drinks.

Synthesis

noun

/ˈsɪnθəsəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Reasoning from the general to the particular (or from cause to effect)
2. The combination of ideas into a complex whole

USAGE

1. The essay offers a **synthesis** of several research studies.

2. The chemist achieved the **synthesis** of a new drug.

Refund

noun / verb

/rɪˈfʌnd/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) The act of returning money received previously
2. (noun) Money returned to a payer
3. (verb) Pay back

USAGE

1. Please **refund** me my money

2. The store will **refund** your money if the item is faulty.

Impartial

adj.

/ɪmˈpɑrʃəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Free from undue bias or preconceived opinions

USAGE

1. The judge was not **impartial** since he had been bribed by the witness's family.

2. A good judge must remain **impartial** in every case.

Equivalence

noun

/ɪkˈwɪvələns/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Qualities that are comparable
2. Essential equality and interchangeability
3. A state of being essentially equal or equivalent; equally balanced

USAGE

1. The **equivalence** of the two currencies was fixed by law.

2. The teacher checked the **equivalence** of the two formulas.

Effect

noun / verb

/ɪˈfɛkt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) An outward appearance
2. (noun) (of a law) having legal validity
3. (noun) An impression (especially one that is artificial or contrived)

USAGE

1. She retained that bold **effect** in her reproductions of the original painting

2. The law is still in **effect**

Clarity

noun

/ˈklɛrəti/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

The quality of clear water

USAGE

1. When she awoke the **clarity** was back in her eyes

2. The speaker's **clarity** made the difficult topic easy to follow.

Specious

adj.

/ˈspiʃəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Based on pretense; deceptively pleasing
2. Plausible but false

USAGE

1. Almost every image on TV is **specious** and not to be trusted.

2. He made a career out of **specious** arguments and fictional lab results, but lost his job and reputation when his lies were exposed by an article in The New York Times.

Uncertainty

noun

/ənˈsɜrtənti/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Being unsettled or in doubt or dependent on chance
2. The state of being unsure of something

USAGE

1. The **uncertainty** of the outcome

2. **Uncertainty** about the future kept the workers anxious.

Inspire

verb

/ˌɪnˈspaɪr/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Draw in (air)
2. Fill with revolutionary ideas
3. Serve as the inciting cause of

USAGE

1. The patient has trouble **inspiring**

2. The lung cancer patient cannot **inspire** air very well

Authoritative

adjective

/əˈθɔrəˌteɪtɪv/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Sanctioned by established authority
2. Having authority or ascendancy or influence
3. Of recognized authority or excellence

USAGE

1. An **authoritative** communique

2. The captain's **authoritative** manner

Miniature

noun / adjective

/ˈmɪniəˌtʃʊr/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) A copy that reproduces a person or thing in greatly reduced size
2. (adjective) Being on a very small scale

USAGE

1. A **miniature** camera

2. The museum displayed a **miniature** model of the ancient city.

Prevaricate

verb

/prɪˈværɪkeɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

To speak in an evasive way

USAGE

1. The cynic quipped, "There is not much variance in politicians; they all seem to **prevaricate**".

2. Instead of answering directly, the minister chose to **prevaricate**.

Ascent

noun

/əˈsɛnt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The act of changing location in an upward direction
2. A movement upward
3. An upward slope or grade (as in a road)

USAGE

1. The climbers began their **ascent** of the mountain at dawn.

2. Her **ascent** to the top of the company took twenty years.

Disciple

noun

/dɪˈsaɪpəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Someone who believes and helps to spread the doctrine of another

USAGE

1. He became a **disciple** of the great philosopher.

2. The monk was a devoted **disciple** of his teacher.

Alliance

noun

/əˈlaɪəns/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The act of forming an alliance or confederation
2. An organization of people (or countries) involved in a pact or treaty
3. A connection based on kinship or marriage or common interest

USAGE

1. The shifting **alliances** within a large family

2. The two countries formed an **alliance** against the common enemy.

Seductive

adjective

/sɪˈdʌktɪv/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Tending to entice into a desired action or state

USAGE

1. The **seductive** scent of fresh coffee filled the kitchen.

2. The advertisement made a **seductive** offer of free travel.

Arrogance

noun

/ˈɛrəgəns/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Overbearing pride evidenced by a superior manner toward inferiors

USAGE

1. His **arrogance** made him unpopular with his colleagues.

2. The **arrogance** of the captain angered the crew.

Suppress

verb

/səpˈrɛs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Reduce the incidence or severity of or stop
2. To put down by force or authority
3. Put out of one's consciousness

USAGE

1. **Suppress** a yawn

2. This drug can **suppress** the hemorrhage

Bolster

verb

/ˈboʊlstər/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Support and strengthen

USAGE

1. The case for the suspect's innocence was **bolstered** considerably by the fact that neither fingerprints nor DNA were found at the scene.

2. Extra training will **bolster** the team's defense.

Allusion

noun

/əˈluʒən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Passing reference or indirect mention

USAGE

1. The poem contains an **allusion** to a famous Greek myth.

2. His **allusion** to the scandal was obvious to everyone.

Rise

noun / verb

/raɪz/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) The act of changing location in an upward direction
2. (noun) Increase in price or value
3. (noun) The property possessed by a slope or surface that rises

USAGE

1. They asked for a 10% **rise** in rates

2. They cheered the **rise** of the hot-air balloon

Propensity

noun

/prəˈpɛnsɪti/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. A disposition to behave in a certain way
2. A natural inclination
3. An inclination to do something

USAGE

1. The **propensity** of disease to spread

2. She has a **propensity** to forget appointments.

Irrelevant

adjective

/ˌɪˈrɛləvənt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Having no bearing on or connection with the subject at issue

USAGE

1. An **irrelevant** comment

2. **Irrelevant** allegations

Innocuous

adj.

/ɪˈnɑkjuəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Harmless and doesn't produce any ill effects

USAGE

1. Everyone found Nancy's banter **innocuous--except** for Mike, who felt like she was intentionally picking on him.

2. The **innocuous-looking** pill caused a surprising allergic reaction.

Discharge

noun / verb

/dɪsˈtʃɑrdʒ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) The act of discharging a gun
2. (noun) A formal written statement of relinquishment
3. (noun) The termination of someone's employment (leaving them free to depart)

USAGE

1. The **discharge** of pus

2. **Discharge** liquids

Undermine

adj.

/ˌʌndərˈmaɪn/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

To weaken (usually paired with an abstract term)

USAGE

1. The student **undermined** the teacher's authority by questioning the teacher's judgment on numerous occasions.

2. Constant criticism can **undermine** a team's confidence.

Impugn

verb

/ɪmˈpjun/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Attack as false or wrong

USAGE

1. Though many initially tried to **impugn** Darwin's theory, in scientific circles today, the is idea taken as truth.

2. The lawyer **impugned** the witness's honesty in court.

Revoke

noun / verb

/rɪˈvoʊk/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) The mistake of not following suit when able to do so
2. (verb) Cancel officially
3. (verb) Fail to follow suit when able and required to do so

USAGE

1. He **revoked** the ban on smoking

2. The city council decided to **revoke** the restaurant's license.

Mismatch

noun / verb

/mɪsˈmætʃ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) A bad or unsuitable match
2. (verb) Match badly; match two objects or people that do not go together

USAGE

1. There was a clear **mismatch** between the job and her skills.

2. The two colors were a poor **mismatch**.

Excessive

adjective

/ɪkˈsɛsɪv/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Beyond normal limits
2. Unrestrained, especially with regard to feelings

USAGE

1. **Excessive** charges

2. The **excessive** heat made the outdoor event unpleasant.

Denounce

verb

/dɪˈnaʊns/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Speak out against
2. Give away information about somebody
3. Announce the termination of, as of treaties

USAGE

1. He **denounced** the Nazis

2. He **denounced** the government action

Discreet

adj.

/dɪˈskrit/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Careful to protect one's speech or actions in order to avoid offense or gain an advantage

USAGE

1. The professor thought that he was **discreet**, subtly wiping the stain off of his shirt, but as soon as he stepped off the podium a member of the audience pointed out the large ketchup stain.

2. She was **discreet** about the secret and told no one.

Intensify

verb

/ɪnˈtɛnsəˌfaɪ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Become more intense
2. Make more intense, stronger, or more marked;,
3. Increase in extent or intensity

USAGE

1. The debate **intensified**

2. The efforts were **intensified**

Confidence

noun

/ˈkɑnfədəns/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Freedom from doubt; belief in yourself and your abilities
2. A secret that is confided or entrusted to another
3. A feeling of trust (in someone or something)

USAGE

1. After that failure he lost his **confidence**

2. Everyone trusted him with their **confidences**

Somber

adjective

/ˈsambər/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Grave or even gloomy in character
2. Lacking brightness or color; dull

USAGE

1. A suit of **somber** black

2. A **somber** mood

Disengage

verb

/dɪsɪnˈgeɪdʒ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Become free
2. Free or remove obstruction from
3. Release from something that holds fast, connects, or entangles

USAGE

1. In neutral, the gears **disengage**

2. I want to **disengage** myself from his influence

Isolate

verb

/ˈaɪsəˌleɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Place or set apart
2. Set apart from others
3. Obtain in pure form

USAGE

1. They **isolated** the political prisoners from the other inmates

2. The chemist managed to **isolate** the compound

Cardinal

adj.

/ˈkɑrdənəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Of primary importance; fundamental

USAGE

1. Most cultures consider gambling a **cardinal** sin and thus have outlawed its practice.

2. Honesty is a **cardinal** rule of good journalism.

Preternatural

adjective

/ˌpritərˈnætʃərəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Existing outside of or not in accordance with nature
2. Surpassing the ordinary or normal

USAGE

1. Beyond his **preternatural** affability there is some acid and some steel

2. The child had a **preternatural** talent for mathematics.

Motion

noun / verb

/ˈmoʊʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) The act of changing location from one place to another
2. (noun) A change of position that does not entail a change of location

USAGE

1. Police controlled the **motion** of the crowd

2. The reflex **motion** of his eyebrows revealed his surprise

Exceed

verb

/ɪkˈsid/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Be or do something to a greater degree
2. Be superior or better than some standard
3. Be greater in scope or size than some standard

USAGE

1. This **exceeds** all my expectations

2. She **exceeded** our expectations

Restore

verb

/rɪsˈtɔr/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Return to life; get or give new life or energy
2. Restore by replacing a part or putting together what is torn or broken
3. Give or bring back

USAGE

1. The week at the spa **restored** me

2. **Restore** the stolen painting to its rightful owner

Cogitate

verb

/ˈkɑdʒɪˌteɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Consider carefully and deeply; reflect upon; turn over in one's mind

USAGE

1. She sat in silence, **cogitating** over the difficult question.

2. He **cogitated** on the offer for several days.

Disperse

verb

/dɪsˈpɜrs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Cause to separate
2. Cause to become widely known
3. Distribute loosely

USAGE

1. **Disperse** particles

2. The prosm **disperses** light

Iconoclast

noun

/aɪˈkɑnəklæst/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Somebody who attacks cherished beliefs or institutions

USAGE

1. Lady Gaga, in challenging what it means to be clothed, is an **iconoclast** for wearing a "meat dress" to a prominent awards show.

2. As an **iconoclast**, she mocked every sacred cow of the industry.

Enigmatic

adjective

/ˌɛnɪgˈmætɪk/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Resembling an oracle in obscurity of thought
2. Not clear to the understanding

USAGE

1. So **enigmatic** that priests might have to clarify it

2. An **enigmatic** smile

Advocate

verb / noun

/ˈædvəkət/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (verb) Speak, plead, or argue in favor of
2. (noun) A person who pleads for a cause or propounds an idea

USAGE

1. While the senator privately approved of gay marriage, he was unwilling to **advocate** for the cause in a public venue.

2. Martin Luther King Jr. was a tireless **advocate** for the rights of African-Americans in the United States.Â

Arbitrary

adj.

/ˈɑrbɪˌtrɛri/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Based on a random, groundless decision

USAGE

1. One of the **arbitrary** decrees in place during the emperor's rule is that all citizens pay him weekly homage at his palace.

2. The referee's **arbitrary** decisions frustrated both teams.

Commonplace

noun / adjective

/ˈkɑmənˌpleɪs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) A trite or obvious remark
2. (adjective) Not challenging; dull and lacking excitement
3. (adjective) Completely ordinary and unremarkable

USAGE

1. Air travel has now become **commonplace**

2. **Commonplace** everyday activities

Tonic

noun / adjective

/ˈtɑnɪk/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) A medicine that strengthens and invigorates
2. (noun) (music) the first note of a diatonic scale
3. (noun) A sweet drink containing carbonated water and flavoring

USAGE

1. In New England they call sodas **tonics**

2. A **tonic** syllables carries the main stress in a word

Vindictive

adj.

/vɪnˈdɪktɪv/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

To have a very strong desire for revenge

USAGE

1. Though the other girl had only lightly poked fun of Vanessa's choice in attire, Vanessa was so **vindictive** that she waited for an entire semester to get the perfect revenge.

2. The **vindictive** manager fired anyone who had criticized him.

Condemn

verb

/kənˈdɛm/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Declare or judge unfit for use or habitation
2. Express strong disapproval of
3. Pronounce a sentence on (somebody) in a court of law

USAGE

1. The building was **condemned** by the inspector

2. We **condemn** the racism in South Africa

Mastery

noun

/ˈmæstəri/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The act of mastering or subordinating someone
2. Great skillfulness and knowledge of some subject or activity
3. Power to dominate or defeat

USAGE

1. **Mastery** of the seas

2. Her **mastery** of the piano impressed the audience.

Precise

adjective

/prɪˈsaɪs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Sharply exact or accurate or delimited

USAGE

1. A **precise** image

2. A **precise** measurement

Personal

noun / adjective

/ˈpɜrsɪnəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) A short newspaper article about a particular person or group
2. (adjective) Particular to a given individual
3. (adjective) Intimately concerning a person's body or physical being

USAGE

1. A **personal** favor

2. For your **personal** use

Germane

adj.

/dʒɜrˈmeɪn/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Relevant and appropriate

USAGE

1. The professor wanted to tell the jury in detail about his new book, but the lawyer said it wasn't **germane** to the charges in the cases.

2. Please keep your comments **germane** to the agenda.

Exemplary

adjective

/ɪgˈzɛmpləri/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Serving to warn
2. Being or serving as an illustration of a type
3. Worthy of imitation

USAGE

1. An **exemplary** jail sentence

2. An action **exemplary** of his conduct

Penalty

noun

/ˈpɛnəlti/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The act of punishing
2. The disadvantage or painful consequences of an action or condition
3. A payment required for not fulfilling a contract

USAGE

1. Neglected his health and paid the **penalty**

2. The referee gave the team a **penalty** for the foul.

Enervate

verb

/ˈɛnərveɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

To sap energy from

USAGE

1. John preferred to avoid equatorial countries; the intense sun would always leave him **enervated** after he'd spent the day sightseeing.

2. Two nights of broken sleep left her completely **enervated** before the exam.

Imperceptible

adjective

/ˌɪmpərˈsɛptɪbəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Impossible or difficult to perceive by the mind or senses

USAGE

1. An **imperceptible** drop in temperature

2. An **imperceptible** nod

Rebate

noun / verb

/ˈriˌbeɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) A rectangular groove made to hold two pieces together
2. (noun) A refund of some fraction of the amount paid
3. (verb) Join with a rebate

USAGE

1. **Rebate** the pieces of timber and stone

2. The store offered a **rebate** on every new appliance.

Roadway

noun

/ˈroʊdˌweɪ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

A road (especially that part of a road) over which vehicles travel

USAGE

1. The **roadway** was closed for repairs during the week.

2. Cars slowed down on the narrow **roadway**.

Longevity

noun

/lɔnˈdʒɛvəti/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The property of being long-lived
2. Duration of service

USAGE

1. Her **longevity** as a star

2. Had unusual **longevity** in the company

Extemporize

verb

/ɪkˈstɛmpəˌraɪz/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Perform without preparation
2. Manage in a makeshift way; do with whatever is at hand

USAGE

1. He **extemporized** a speech at the wedding

2. The actor had to **extemporize** when he forgot his lines.

Logic

noun

/ˈlɑdʒɪk/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Reasoned and reasonable judgment
2. A system of reasoning
3. The principles that guide reasoning within a given field or situation

USAGE

1. It made a certain kind of **logic**

2. Economic **logic** requires it

Condense

verb

/kənˈdɛns/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Make more concise
2. Undergo condensation; change from a gaseous to a liquid state and fall in drops
3. Compress or concentrate

USAGE

1. **Condense** the contents of a book into a summary

2. Water **condenses**

Obligation

noun

/ˌɑblə ˈgeɪʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The social force that binds you to the courses of action demanded by that force
2. A written promise to repay a debt
3. A personal relation in which one is indebted for a service or favor

USAGE

1. Every right implies a responsibility; every opportunity, an **obligation**; every possession, a duty

2. He is under an **obligation** to finish the job

Improvident

adj.

/ɪmˈprɑvɪdənt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Not given careful consideration

USAGE

1. Marty was **improvident**, never putting money aside for the future but spending it on decorating the interior of his home.

2. The **improvident** farmer spent his savings before the harvest.

Contrive

verb

/kənˈtraɪv/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

To pull off a plan or scheme, usually through skill or trickery

USAGE

1. Despite a low GPA, he **contrived** to get into college, going so far as to write his own glowing letters of recommendation.

2. She **contrived** to sit beside the speaker at dinner.

Persistent

adjective

/pərˈsɪstənt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Never-ceasing
2. Continually recurring to the mind
3. Retained; not shed

USAGE

1. **Persistent** leaves remain attached past maturity

2. The **persistent** gills of fishes

Leadership

noun

/ˈlidərˌʃɪp/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The activity of leading
2. The ability to lead
3. The body of people who lead a group

USAGE

1. His **leadership** inspired the team

2. He believed that **leadership** can be taught

Guarantee

noun / verb

/ˌgɛrənˈti/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

(verb) Promise to do or accomplish

USAGE

1. There is no **guarantee** that they are not lying

2. **Guarantee** to free the prisoners

Evaluate

verb

/ɪˈvælju˧eɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Form a critical opinion of
2. Evaluate or estimate the nature, quality, ability, extent, or significance of

USAGE

1. How do you **evaluate** this grant proposal?

2. The committee will **evaluate** each application carefully.

Prone

adjective

/proʊn/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Lying face downward
2. Having a tendency (to); often used in combination

USAGE

1. A child **prone** to mischief

2. The old bridge is **prone** to failure during storms.

Poverty

noun

/ˈpavərti/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

The state of having little or no money and few or no material possessions

USAGE

1. **Poverty** forced many families to leave the village.

2. Education can help people escape **poverty**.

Impractical

adjective

/ˌɪmˈpræktəkəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Not practical; not workable or not given to practical matters
2. Not practical or realizable; speculative

USAGE

1. Refloating the ship proved **impractical** because of the expense

2. He is intelligent but too **impractical** for commercial work

Morality

noun

/məˈræləti/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Motivation based on ideas of right and wrong

USAGE

1. The debate touched on questions of **morality** and justice.

2. Her **morality** guided every decision she made.

Derogatory

adjective

/dərˈɑgəˌtɔri/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Expressive of low opinion

USAGE

1. **Derogatory** comments

2. He made **derogatory** comments about the new employees.

Misinterpret

verb

/mɪsɪnˈtɜrprət/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Interpret in the wrong way
2. Interpret wrongly
3. Interpret falsely

USAGE

1. Don't **misinterpret** my comments as criticism

2. The teacher **misinterpreted** my question and answered the wrong thing.

Defy

verb

/dɪˈfaɪ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Challenge
2. Resist or confront with resistance
3. Elude, especially in a baffling way

USAGE

1. Few rebels dare to **defy** the order to surrender.

2. The tall tower seems to **defy** gravity in the photograph.

Valid

adjective

/ˈvælɪd/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Still legally acceptable
2. Well grounded in logic or truth or having legal force

USAGE

1. The license is still **valid**

2. A **valid** inference

Extraordinary

adjective

/ˌɛkstrəˈɔrdəˌnɛri/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Far more than usual or expected
2. Beyond what is ordinary or usual; highly unusual or exceptional or remarkable

USAGE

1. An **extraordinary** desire for approval

2. **Extraordinary** authority

Inanimate

adjective

/ˌɪˈnænəmət/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Appearing dead; not breathing or having no perceptible pulse
2. Not endowed with life
3. Belonging to the class of nouns denoting nonliving things

USAGE

1. An **inanimate** body

2. The inorganic world is **inanimate**

Ethics

noun

/ˈɛθɪks/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The philosophical study of moral values and rules
2. Motivation based on ideas of right and wrong

USAGE

1. The company's **ethics** policy forbids gifts from clients.

2. Doctors must follow strict **ethics** in their work.

Gratuitous

adjective

/grəˈtuətəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Without cause
2. Unnecessary and unwarranted
3. Costing nothing

USAGE

1. A **gratuitous** insult

2. The film included **gratuitous** violence that shocked the audience.

Productivity

noun

/ˌproʊdəkˈtɪvəti/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

The quality of being productive or having the power to produce

USAGE

1. **Productivity** rose after the factory adopted new machines.

2. Breaks can improve **productivity** during long shifts.

Digressive

adjective

/daɪˈgrɛsɪv/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Of superficial relevance if any

USAGE

1. Amusingly **digressive** with satirical thrusts at women's fashions among other things

2. A **digressive** allusion to the day of the week

Antiseptic

noun / adjective

/ˌæntəˈsɛptɪk/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (adjective) Devoid of objectionable language
2. (adjective) Clean and honest

USAGE

1. Lyrics as **antiseptic** as Sunday School

2. **Antiseptic** financial practices

Neophyte

noun

/ˈniəˌfaɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. A new convert being taught the principles of Christianity by a catechist
2. Any new participant in some activity
3. A plant that is found in an area where it had not been recorded previously

USAGE

1. The **neophyte** pilot made a few small mistakes on his first flight.

2. As a **neophyte**, she needed guidance from the senior staff.

Misanthrope

noun

/ˈmɪsənˌθroʊp/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

A hater of mankind

USAGE

1. Hamilton had been deceived so many times in his life that he hid behind the gruff exterior of a **misanthrope**, lambasting perfect strangers for no apparent reason.

2. The **misanthrope** avoided parties and rarely spoke to his neighbors.

Neutral

noun / adjective

/ˈnutrəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) One who does not side with any party in a war or dispute
2. (adjective) Having no net electric charge
3. (adjective) Having no hue

USAGE

1. **Neutral** colors like black or white

2. A **neutral** personality that made no impression whatever

Provoke

verb

/prəˈvoʊk/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Provide the needed stimulus for
2. Evoke or provoke to appear or occur
3. Call forth (emotions, feelings, and responses)

USAGE

1. Her behavior **provoked** a quarrel between the couple

2. The rude remark was meant to **provoke** a fight.

Authority

noun

/əˈθɔrəti/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Official permission or approval
2. The power or right to give orders or make decisions
3. Freedom from doubt; belief in yourself and your abilities

USAGE

1. **Authority** for the program was renewed several times

2. He has the **authority** to issue warrants

Restrict

verb

/risˈtrɪkt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Make more specific
2. Place limits on (extent or access)
3. Place restrictions on

USAGE

1. **Restrict** the use of this parking lot

2. The new rules **restrict** access to the old library.

Deform

verb

/ˌdiˈfɔrm/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Assume a different shape or form
2. Alter the shape of (something) by stress
3. Become misshapen

USAGE

1. His body was **deformed** by leprosy

2. The sidewalk **deformed** during the earthquake

Inappropriate

adjective

/ˌɪnəpˈroʊpriɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Not suitable for a particular occasion etc
2. Not in keeping with what is correct or proper

USAGE

1. Noise seems **inappropriate** at a time of sadness

2. **Inappropriate** shoes for a walk on the beach

Indifferent

adjective

/ˌɪnˈdɪfrənt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Showing no care or concern in attitude or action
2. (often followed by `to') Lacking importance; not mattering one way or the other
3. Marked by a lack of interest

USAGE

1. **Indifferent** to the sufferings of others

2. **Indifferent** to her plea

Irreparable

adjective

/ˌɪˈrɛpərəbəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Impossible to repair, rectify, or amend

USAGE

1. **Irreparable** harm

2. An **irreparable** mistake

Sanction

verb / noun

/ˈsæŋkʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (verb) Give authority or permission to
2. (noun) A legal penalty for a forbidden action

USAGE

1. The authorities have **sanctioned** the use of the wilderness reserve for public use; many expect to see hikers an campers enjoying the park in the coming months.

2. International **sanctions** have been placed on certain shipping lanes that were thought to be involved in human trafficking.

Restrain

verb

/risˈtreɪn/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Place limits on (extent or access)
2. Hold back
3. To close within bounds, limit or hold back from movement

USAGE

1. **Restrict** the use of this parking lot

2. The guard had to **restrain** the angry dog.

Expertise

noun

/ˌɛkspərˈtiz/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Skillfulness by virtue of possessing special knowledge

USAGE

1. Her **expertise** in finance helped the company avoid losses.

2. The team lacked the **expertise** to repair the machine.

Augur

noun / verb

/ˈɔgər/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (verb) Indicate by signs
2. (verb) Predict from an omen

USAGE

1. The dark clouds **augur** a difficult day ahead.

2. The early results **augur** well for the project.

Portend

verb

/pɔrˈtɛnd/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Indicate by signs

USAGE

1. The black clouds **portend** a storm.

2. The red sky seemed to **portend** a storm by morning.

Agitate

verb

/ˈædʒəˌteɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Change the arrangement or position of
2. Cause to be agitated, excited, or roused
3. Move or cause to move back and forth

USAGE

1. The news **agitated** the crowd, and people began to shout.

2. The loud noises **agitated** the nervous horse.

Innovation

noun

/ˌɪnəˈveɪʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The act of starting something for the first time; introducing something new
2. A creation (a new device or process) resulting from study and experimentation
3. The creation of something in the mind

USAGE

1. The company is known for its **innovation** in medical technology.

2. **Innovation** drives economic growth.

Dwindle

verb

/ˈdwɪndəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Become smaller or lose substance

USAGE

1. Her savings **dwindled** down

2. Our food supplies **dwindled** during the long winter.

Philosopher

noun

/fəˈlɑsəfər/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

A specialist in philosophy

USAGE

1. The **philosopher** wrote books about truth and justice.

2. Socrates is a famous ancient **philosopher**.

Subjective

adjective

/səbˈdʒɛktɪv/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Of a mental act performed entirely within the mind
2. Taking place within the mind and modified by individual bias

USAGE

1. A **subjective** judgment

2. Taste in music is highly **subjective**.

Coarse

adjective

/kɔrs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Lacking refinement or cultivation or taste
2. Of low or inferior quality or value

USAGE

1. He had **coarse** manners but a first-rate mind

2. **Coarse** meal

Indispensable

adjective

/ˌɪndɪsˈpɛnsəbəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Unavoidable
2. Not to be dispensed with; essential
3. Absolutely necessary; vitally necessary

USAGE

1. The routine but **indispensable** ceremonies of state

2. Foods **indispensable** to good nutrition

Mendacious

adjective

/mɛnˈdeɪʃəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Given to lying
2. Intentionally untrue

USAGE

1. A **mendacious** child

2. A **mendacious** statement

Anesthetic

noun / adjective

/ˌænəsˈθɛtɪk/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) A drug that causes temporary loss of bodily sensations
2. (adjective) Relating to or producing insensibility

USAGE

1. The dentist gave her an **anesthetic** before the operation.

2. The **anesthetic** numbed the patient's arm.

Subtle

adjective

/ˈsʌtəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Working or spreading in a hidden and usually injurious way
2. Difficult to detect or grasp by the mind or analyze
3. Able to make fine distinctions

USAGE

1. A **subtle** poison

2. His whole attitude had undergone a **subtle** change

Revelation

noun

/ˌrɛvəˈleɪʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. An enlightening or astonishing disclosure
2. Communication of knowledge to man by a divine or supernatural agency
3. The speech act of making something evident

USAGE

1. The diary was a **revelation** about the artist's private life.

2. The discovery was a **revelation** to the scientists.

Haphazard

adj.

/ˌhæpˈhæzərd/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Marked by great carelessness; dependent upon or characterized by chance

USAGE

1. Many golf courses are designed with great care, but the greens on the county golf course seem entirely **haphazard**.

2. The files were stacked in a **haphazard** pile on the desk.

Abstract

noun / verb / adjective

/æbsˈtrækt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) A concept or idea not associated with any specific instance
2. (noun) A sketchy summary of the main points of an argument or theory
3. (verb) Consider apart from a particular case or instance

USAGE

1. He loved her only in the **abstract--not** in person

2. Let's **abstract** away from this particular example

Divulge

verb

/dɪˈvʌldʒ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Make known to the public information that was previously known only to a few people or that was meant to be kept a secret

USAGE

1. The spy refused to **divulge** the names of his contacts.

2. She would not **divulge** the secret recipe.

Elusive

adj.

/ɪˈlusɪv/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Difficult to capture or difficult to remember

USAGE

1. Many first time skydivers say that describing the act of falling from the sky is **elusive**.

2. The **elusive** cat disappeared under the porch again.

Institute

noun / verb

/ˈɪnstəˌtut/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) An association organized to promote art or science or education
2. (verb) Advance or set forth in court;,
3. (verb) Set up or lay the groundwork for

USAGE

1. **Institute** proceedings

2. The school will **institute** a new reading program next year.

Warranted

adjective

/ˈwɔrəntɪd/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Justified or deserved by the circumstances
2. Guaranteed or certified as sound

USAGE

1. Their concern about the bridge seemed **warranted** after the inspection.

2. The extra security was **warranted** by the threats.

Rigorous

adjective

/ˈrɪgərəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Demanding strict attention to rules and procedures
2. Rigidly accurate; allowing no deviation from a standard

USAGE

1. **Rigorous** discipline

2. **Rigorous** application of the law

Transparent

adjective

/trænˈspɛrənt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Transmitting light; able to be seen through with clarity
2. Easily understood or seen through (because of a lack of subtlety)
3. Free of deceit

USAGE

1. **Transparent** crystal

2. A **transparent** explanation

Postpone

verb

/poʊsˈtpoʊn/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Hold back to a later time

USAGE

1. Let's **postpone** the exam

2. The match was **postponed** because of heavy rain.

Enhance

verb

/ɛnˈhæns/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Increase
2. Make better or more attractive

USAGE

1. This will **enhance** your enjoyment

2. This sauce will **enhance** the flavor of the meat

Experimentation

noun

/ɪkˌspɛrəmənˈteɪʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The act of conducting a controlled test or investigation
2. The testing of an idea

USAGE

1. Not all **experimentation** is done in laboratories

2. **Experimentation** with new recipes is part of the chef's job.

Champion

verb

/ˈtʃæmpiən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Protect or fight for as a champion

USAGE

1. Martin Luther King Jr. **championed** civil rights fiercely throughout his short life.

2. The lawyer **championed** the rights of tenants.

Compromise

noun / verb

/ˈkɑmprəˌmaɪz/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) A middle way between two extremes
2. (noun) An accommodation in which both sides make concessions
3. (verb) Settle by concession

USAGE

1. The newly elected congressmen rejected a **compromise** because they considered it `business as usual'

2. Nobody will get everything he wants; we all must **compromise**

Substitution

noun

/ˌsʌbstɪˈtuʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The act of putting one thing or person in the place of another:
2. An event in which one thing is substituted for another

USAGE

1. He sent Smith in for Jones but the **substitution** came too late to help

2. A **substitution** of sugar for honey changed the flavor of the cake.

Dent

noun / verb

/dɛnt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) An impression in a surface (as made by a blow)
2. (noun) An appreciable consequence (especially a lessening)
3. (noun) A depression scratched or carved into a surface

USAGE

1. It made a **dent** in my bank account

2. The bicycle **dented** my car

Contaminate

verb

/kənˈtæməˌneɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Make impure
2. Make radioactive by adding radioactive material

USAGE

1. Don't drink the water--it's **contaminated**

2. Floodwater **contaminated** the wells in the village.

Indelicate

adjective

/ˌɪnˈdɛlɪkət/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Verging on the indecent
2. Lacking propriety and good taste in manners and conduct
3. In violation of good taste even verging on the indecent

USAGE

1. An **indelicate** proposition

2. An **indelicate** remark

Ruthless

adjective

/ˈruθləs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Without mercy or pity

USAGE

1. An act of **ruthless** ferocity

2. The **ruthless** general ordered the attack despite the losses.

Antagonism

noun

/ænˈtægəˌnɪzəm/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. An actively expressed feeling of dislike and hostility
2. The relation between opposing principles or forces or factors
3. A state of deep-seated ill-will

USAGE

1. The inherent **antagonism** of capitalism and socialism

2. Years of rivalry created deep **antagonism** between the families.

Alter

verb

/ˈɔltər/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Remove the ovaries of
2. Cause to change; make different; cause a transformation
3. Insert words into texts, often falsifying it thereby

USAGE

1. The advent of the automobile may have **altered** the growth pattern of the city

2. This dress needs to be **altered**

Mundane

adj.

/mʌnˈdeɪn/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Repetitive and boring; not spiritual
2. Relating to the ordinary world

USAGE

1. Nancy found doing dishes a thorougly **mundane** task, although Peter found a kind of Zen pleasure in the chore.

2. Though we think of the pope as someone always dealing in holy matters, he is also concerned with **mundane** events, such as deciding when to set his alarm each morning.

Opaque

adj.

/oʊˈpeɪk/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Not clearly understood or expressed

USAGE

1. The meaning of the professor's new research was **opaque** to most people, so no one asked any questions.

2. The **opaque** instructions left everyone unsure of the next step.

Grave

noun / verb / adjective

/greɪv/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) A mark (`) placed above a vowel to indicate pronunciation
2. (noun) Death of a person
3. (verb) Carve, cut, or etch into a material or surface

USAGE

1. He put flowers on his mother's **grave**

2. He went to his **grave** without forgiving me

Proceed

verb

/prəˈsid/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Follow a certain course
2. Continue talking;he continued,
3. Move ahead; travel onward in time or space

USAGE

1. We **proceeded** towards Washington

2. Once the signal turns green, you may **proceed** across the bridge.

Capitulate

noun

/kəˈpɪtʃəˌleɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

To surrender (usually under agreed conditions)

USAGE

1. Paul, losing 19-0 in a ping-pong match against his nimble friend, basically **capitulated** when he played the last two points with his eyes closed.

2. After three weeks of siege, the garrison **capitulated**.

Day 03- 200 Words: Statute through Transient

Cards 401 to 600

Statute

noun

/ˈstætʃut/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

An act passed by a legislative body

USAGE

1. The **statute** makes it illegal to sell alcohol to minors.

2. A new **statute** was passed to protect tenants.

Pompous

adjective

/ˈpɑmpəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Puffed up with vanity
2. Characterized by pomp and ceremony and stately display

USAGE

1. A **pompous** speech

2. The **pompous** official lectured us for twenty minutes.

Conventional

adjective

/kənˈvɛnʃənəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Following accepted customs and proprieties
2. Unimaginative and conformist
3. (weapons) Using energy for propulsion or destruction that is not nuclear energy

USAGE

1. **Conventional** wisdom

2. She had strayed from the path of **conventional** behavior

Embellish

verb

/ɪmˈbɛlɪʃ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Make more attractive by adding ornament, colour, etc.; make more beautiful

USAGE

1. McCartney would write relatively straightforward lyrics, and Lennon would **embellish** them with puns and poetic images.

2. He **embellished** the story with details that were not true.

Personnel

noun

/ˌpərsəˈnɛl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Group of people willing to obey orders

USAGE

1. The hospital hired extra **personnel** for the night shift.

2. **Personnel** files are kept in a locked cabinet.

Prediction

noun

/priˈdɪkʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The act of predicting (as by reasoning about the future)
2. A statement made about the future

USAGE

1. His **prediction** that prices would rise came true.

2. The scientist made a bold **prediction** about the climate.

Plausible

adjective

/ˈplɔzəbəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Apparently reasonable and valid, and truthful
2. Given to or characterized by presenting specious arguments

USAGE

1. A **plausible** excuse

2. A **plausible** liar

Burgeon

verb

/ˈbɜrdʒən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Grow and flourish

USAGE

1. China's housing market is **burgeoning**, but some predict that the growth is merely a bubble and will burst, much like the U.S. real estate bubble of 2008.

2. The city's tech sector began to **burgeon** in the early 2000s.

Symmetry

noun

/ˈsɪmətri/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Balance among the parts of something

USAGE

1. The **symmetry** of the building pleased every visitor.

2. A snowflake shows a beautiful **symmetry**.

Accompany

verb

/əˈkʌmpəni/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Perform an accompaniment to
2. Go or travel along with
3. Be present or associated with an event or entity

USAGE

1. The nurse **accompanied** the old lady everywhere

2. Heart attacks are **accompanied** by distruction of heart tissue

Bellicose

adj.

/ˈbɛlɪkoʊs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Warlike; inclined to quarrel

USAGE

1. Known for their **bellicose** ways, the Spartans were once the most feared people from Peloponnesus to Persia.

2. The **bellicose** coach shouted insults at the referees.

Ambiguity

noun

/ˌæmbɪgˈjuəti/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Unclearness by virtue of having more than one meaning
2. An expression whose meaning cannot be determined from its context

USAGE

1. The **ambiguity** of the contract caused a lot of confusion.

2. There was no **ambiguity** about what she wanted.

Economical

adj.

/ˌɛkəˈnɑmɪkəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Avoiding waste; efficient

USAGE

1. Journalists favor an **economical** style of writing, in which no unnecessary words are used and every sentence is as short as possible.

2. The **economical** car runs on very little fuel.

Trivial

adjective

/ˈtrɪviəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (informal) Small and of little importance
2. Concerned with trivialities
3. Of little substance or significance

USAGE

1. A **trivial** young woman

2. A **trivial** mind

Revert

verb

/rɪˈvɜrt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Undergo reversion, as in a mutation
2. Go back to a previous state

USAGE

1. We **reverted** to the old rules

2. After the trial period, the price will **revert** to its old level.

Routine

noun / adjective

/ruˈtin/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) An unvarying or habitual method or procedure
2. (noun) A set sequence of steps, part of larger computer program
3. (noun) A short theatrical performance that is part of a longer program

USAGE

1. She had a catchy little **routine**

2. It was a **routine** day

Genuine

adjective

/ˈdʒɛnjəwən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Not fake or counterfeit
2. Not pretended; sincerely felt or expressed
3. Being or reflecting the essential or genuine character of something

USAGE

1. A **genuine** Picasso

2. **Genuine** leather

Corruption

noun

/kərˈʌpʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Moral perversion; impairment of virtue and moral principles

USAGE

1. He was held on charges of **corruption** and racketeering

2. **Corruption** of a minor

Preoccupation

noun

/priˌɑkjəˈpeɪʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The act of taking occupancy before someone else does
2. The mental state of being preoccupied by something
3. An idea that preoccupies the mind and holds the attention

USAGE

1. His **preoccupation** with money left no time for his family.

2. Her **preoccupation** with work worried her friends.

Manipulate

verb

/məˈnɪpjəˌleɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Treat manually, as with massage, for therapeutic purposed
2. Hold something in one's hands and move it
3. Control (others or oneself) or influence skillfully, usually to one's advantage

USAGE

1. She **manipulates** her boss

2. He **manipulated** public opinion in his favor

Gaudy

noun / adjective

/ˈgɔdi/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) (Britain) a celebratory reunion feast or entertainment held a college
2. (adjective) (used especially of clothes) marked by conspicuous display
3. (adjective) Tastelessly showy

USAGE

1. A **gaudy** costume

2. The **gaudy** necklace shone under the bright lights.

Imaginative

adjective

/ˌɪˈmædʒənətɪv/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

(used of persons or artifacts) Marked by independence and creativity in thought or action

USAGE

1. An **imaginative** use of material

2. The children made **imaginative** sculptures out of old boxes.

Distant

adjective

/ˈdɪstənt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Located far away spatially
2. Separate or apart in time
3. Separated in space or coming from or going to a distance

USAGE

1. **Distant** lands

2. **Distant** events

Industrial

adjective

/ˌɪnˈdʌstriəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Suitable to stand up to hard wear
2. Having highly developed industries
3. Employed in industry

USAGE

1. **Industrial** carpeting

2. The **industrial** revolution

Effective

adjective

/ɪˈfɛktɪv/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Existing in fact; not theoretical; real
2. Able to accomplish a purpose; functioning effectively
3. Exerting force or influence

USAGE

1. A decline in the **effective** demand

2. Confused increased equipment and expenditure with the quantity of **effective** work done

Subside

verb

/səbˈsaɪd/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Wear off or die down
2. Descend into or as if into some soft substance or place
3. Sink down or precipitate

USAGE

1. The pain **subsided**

2. She **subsided** into the chair

Forestall

verb

/fɔrˈstɔl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Keep from happening or arising; make impossible
2. Act in advance of; deal with ahead of time

USAGE

1. Early repairs can **forestall** bigger problems later.

2. The guards tried to **forestall** the protest.

Compatible

adjective

/kəmˈpætəbəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Able to exist and perform in harmonious or agreeable combination

USAGE

1. A **compatible** married couple

2. Her deeds were **compatible** with her ideology

Preamble

noun / verb

/priˈæmbəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

(verb) Make a preliminary introduction, usually to a formal document

USAGE

1. The **preamble** to the constitution explains its purpose.

2. The speech began with a long **preamble** about history.

Aberration

noun

/ˌæbəˈreɪʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

A deviation from what is normal or expected

USAGE

1. **Aberrations** in climate have become the norm: rarely a week goes by without some meteorological phenomenon making headlines.

2. A single cold summer was an **aberration**; the region usually stays warm.

Relevance

noun

/ˈrɛləvəns/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

The relation of something to the matter at hand

USAGE

1. The lawyer argued that the evidence had no **relevance** to the case.

2. The **relevance** of the study to our work is clear.

Provenance

noun

/ˈprɑvənəns/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Where something originated or was nurtured in its early existence

USAGE

1. The museum traced the **provenance** of the painting back to 1900.

2. Experts checked the **provenance** of the rare coin.

Durability

noun

/dərəˈbɪlɪti/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Permanence by virtue of the power to resist stress or force

USAGE

1. They advertised the **durability** of their products

2. The **durability** of the boots makes them good for hiking.

Abate

verb

/əˈbeɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Become less in amount or intensity
2. Make less active or intense

USAGE

1. The storm **abated**

2. The rain finally **abated** late in the afternoon.

Interchangeable

adjective

/ˌɪntərˈtʃeɪndʒəbəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

(mathematics, logic) Such that the arguments or roles can be interchanged

USAGE

1. **Interchangeable** electric outlets

2. **Interchangeable** parts

Acknowledge

verb

/ækˈnɑlɪdʒ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Accept (someone) to be what is claimed or accept his power and authority
2. Accept as legally binding and valid
3. Declare to be true or admit the existence or reality or truth of

USAGE

1. The Crown Prince was **acknowledged** as the true heir to the throne

2. **Acknowledge** the deed

Testimony

noun

/ˈtɛstəˌmoʊni/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Something that serves as evidence
2. An assertion offering firsthand authentication of a fact
3. A solemn statement made under oath

USAGE

1. His effort was **testimony** to his devotion

2. According to his own **testimony** he can't do it

Widen

verb

/ˈwaɪdən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Become broader or wider or more extensive
2. Make wider
3. Make (clothes) larger

USAGE

1. The road **widened**

2. **Widen** the road

Sequence

noun / verb

/ˈsikwəns/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) The action of following in order
2. (noun) A following of one thing after another in time
3. (noun) Several repetitions of a melodic phrase in different keys

USAGE

1. He played the trumps in **sequence**

2. The doctor saw a **sequence** of patients

Coincide

verb

/ˌkoʊɪnˈsaɪd/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Happen simultaneously
2. Be the same
3. Go with, fall together

USAGE

1. The two events **coincided**

2. Our views on this matter **coincided**

Disguise

noun / verb

/dɪsˈgaɪz/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) An outward semblance that misrepresents the true nature of something
2. (verb) Make unrecognizable

USAGE

1. He is a master of **disguise**

2. The theatrical notion of **disguise** is always associated with catastrophe in his stories

Disinclined

adjective

/ˌdɪsɪnˈklaɪnd/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Unwilling because of mild dislike or disapproval

USAGE

1. **Disinclined** to say anything to anybody

2. She was **disinclined** to accept the offer without more information.

Abandon

noun / verb

/əˈbændən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) A feeling of extreme emotional intensity
2. (verb) Stop maintaining or insisting on; of ideas or claims
3. (verb) Leave someone who needs or counts on you; leave in the lurch

USAGE

1. She danced with **abandon**

2. He **abandoned** the thought of asking for her hand in marriage

Belligerent

adj.

/bəˈlɪdʒərənt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Characteristic of one eager to fight

USAGE

1. Tom said that he was arguing the matter purely for philosophical reasons, but his **belligerent** tone indicated an underlying anger about the issue.

2. The **belligerent** driver shouted at everyone who passed him.

Perceive

verb

/pərˈsiv/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Become conscious of
2. To become aware of through the senses

USAGE

1. She finally **perceived** the futility of her protest

2. I could **perceive** the ship coming over the horizon

Absurd

noun / adjective

/əbˈsɜrd/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) A situation in which life seems irrational and meaningless;--Albert Camus
2. (adjective) Inconsistent with reason or logic or common sense
3. (adjective) Incongruous;inviting ridicule

USAGE

1. The **absurd** is the essential concept and the first truth

2. The **absurd** predicament of seeming to argue that virtue is highly desirable but intensely unpleasant

Practical

adjective

/ˈpræktəkəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Having or put to a practical purpose or use
2. Concerned with actual use or practice
3. Guided by practical experience and observation rather than theory

USAGE

1. **Practical** mathematics

2. **Practical** applications of calculus

Facade

noun

/fəˈsɑd/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The face or front of a building
2. A showy misrepresentation intended to conceal something unpleasant

USAGE

1. The building's stone **facade** was restored last year.

2. Her calm **facade** hid a deep sadness.

Addict

noun / verb

/əˈdɪkt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) Someone who is so ardently devoted to something that it resembles an addiction
2. (verb) To cause (someone or oneself) to become dependent (on something, especially a narcotic drug)
3. (noun) Someone who is physiologically dependent on a substance; abrupt deprivation of the substance produces withdrawal symptoms

USAGE

1. A golf **addict**

2. He is an **addict** who is trying to quit smoking.

Supersede

verb

/ˌsupərˈsid/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Take the place or move into the position of

USAGE

1. The new rules will **supersede** all earlier guidelines.

2. The new model will **supersede** the older version next year.

Concur

verb

/kənˈkɜr/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Happen simultaneously
2. Be in accord; be in agreement

USAGE

1. The judges **concur** that the law must be changed.

2. The doctors **concur** that rest is the best treatment.

Negligible

adj.

/ˈnɛglɪdʒəbəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

So small as to be meaningless; insignificant

USAGE

1. The GRE tests cumulative knowledge, so if you cram the night before it is, at best, likely to only have a **negligible** impact on your score.

2. The cost of the extra paper was **negligible** compared with the budget.

Constrain

verb

/kənsˈtreɪn/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Restrict
2. Hold back

USAGE

1. Tight budgets **constrain** what the team can achieve.

2. Strict rules **constrain** the freedom of the staff.

Expose

noun / verb

/ɪkˈspoʊz/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) The exposure of an impostor or a fraud
2. (verb) Abandon by leaving out in the open air

USAGE

1. He published an **expose** of the graft and corruption in city government

2. The infant was **exposed** by the teenage mother

Converge

verb

/kənˈvɜrdʒ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Come together so as to form a single product
2. Move or draw together at a certain location
3. Be adjacent or come together

USAGE

1. Social forces **converged** to bring the Fascists back to power

2. The crowd **converged** on the movie star

Impede

verb

/ɪmˈpid/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Be a hindrance or obstacle to

USAGE

1. Since the police sergeant had to train the pair of new hires, progress in his own case was **impeded**.

2. Fallen trees **impeded** the progress of the rescue team.

Promiscuous

adjective

/ˈproʊmɪskwəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Casual and unrestrained in sexual behavior
2. Not selective of a single class or person

USAGE

1. Clinton was criticized for his **promiscuous** solicitation of campaign money

2. The **promiscuous** use of antibiotics has led to resistant bacteria.

Equivocal

adj.

/ɪˈkwɪvəkəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Confusing or ambiguous

USAGE

1. The findings of the study were **equivocal--the** two researchers had different opinions on what the results signified.

2. His **equivocal** reply made it impossible to know whether he would attend.

Ubiquitous

adjective

/juˈbɪkwɪtəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Being present everywhere at once

USAGE

1. Smartphones have become **ubiquitous** in modern life.

2. Coffee shops are **ubiquitous** in the city center.

Intelligible

adjective

/ˌɪnˈtɛlədʒəbəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Capable of being apprehended or understood
2. Well articulated or enunciated, and loud enough to be heard distinctly

USAGE

1. **Intelligible** pronunciation

2. His speech was barely **intelligible** through the thick fog.

Discriminate

verb

/dɪˈskrɪməˌneɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Recognize or perceive the difference

USAGE

1. Sarah couldn't **discriminate** between a good wine and a bad wine, so she avoided wine tastings.

2. It is hard to **discriminate** between the two similar wines.

Equivocate

verb

/ɪˈkwɪvəˌkeɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

To speak vaguely, usually with the intention to mislead or deceive

USAGE

1. After Sharon brought the car home an hour after her curfew, she **equivocated** when her parents pointedly asked her where she had been.

2. The witness **equivocated** when asked about the timeline.

Repudiate

verb

/rɪˈpjudieɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Reject as untrue or unfounded

USAGE

1. Many in the public believed the rumors of a UFO crash outside town, so the chief of police did everything he could to **repudiate** the rumors.

2. The party **repudiated** the candidate's offensive remarks.

Redolent

adjective

/ˈrɛdələnt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Having a strong pleasant odor
2. Serving to bring to mind

USAGE

1. The pine woods were more **redolent**

2. Cannot forbear to close on this **redolent** literary note

Ambidextrous

adjective

/ˌæmbəˈdɛkstrəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Equally skillful with each hand

USAGE

1. An **ambidextrous** surgeon

2. The **ambidextrous** pitcher could throw with either arm.

Specify

verb

/ˈspɛsəˌfaɪ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Select something or someone for a specific purpose
2. Design or destine
3. Define clearly

USAGE

1. **Specify** the parameters

2. Could you please **specify** your criticism of my paper?

Decorum

noun

/dɪˈkɔrəm/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Propriety in manners and conduct

USAGE

1. You will obey the rules of **decorum** for this courtroom or spend the night in a jail cell, said the judge to the prosecutor.

2. **Decorum** requires that you stand when the anthem is played.

Polarize

verb

/ˈpoʊləˌaɪz/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Become polarized in a conflict or contrasting situation
2. Cause to concentrate about two conflicting or contrasting positions
3. Cause to vibrate in a definite pattern

USAGE

1. **Polarize** light waves

2. The debate **polarized** the community into two hostile camps.

Eliminate

verb

/ɪˈlɪməˌneɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Eliminate from the body
2. Kill in large numbers
3. Terminate, end, or take out

USAGE

1. Let's **eliminate** the course on Akkadian hieroglyphics

2. **Eliminate** my debts

Soliloquy

noun

/səˈlɪləkwi/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Speech you make to yourself

USAGE

1. In the play, the prince delivers a famous **soliloquy** about death.

2. The character's **soliloquy** revealed his hidden fears.

Falter

noun / verb

/ˈfɔltər/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) The act of pausing uncertainly
2. (verb) Speak haltingly
3. (verb) Walk unsteadily

USAGE

1. The speaker **faltered** when he saw his opponent enter the room

2. Their enthusiasm is **faltering**

Proclivity

noun

/proʊkˈlɪvəti/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

A natural inclination

USAGE

1. He has a **proclivity** for exaggeration

2. He has a **proclivity** for taking risks.

Substantive

noun / adjective

/ˈsʌbstəntɪv/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) Any word or group of words functioning as a noun
2. (adjective) Being on topic and prompting thought

USAGE

1. **Substantive** law

2. **Substantial** equivalents

Tenuous

adjective

/ˈtɛnjəwəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Lacking substance or significance; a fragile claim to fame"
2. Very thin in gauge or diameter
3. Having thin consistency

USAGE

1. A **tenuous** argument

2. A **tenuous** thread

Manufacture

noun / verb

/ˌmænjəˈfæktʃər/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) The organized action of making of goods and services for sale
2. (noun) The act of making something (a product) from raw materials
3. (verb) Make up something artificial or untrue

USAGE

1. An improvement in the **manufacture** of explosives

2. **Manufacturing** is vital to Great Britain

Plaintive

adjective

/ˈpleɪntɪv/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Expressing sorrow

USAGE

1. A **plaintive** cry came from the lost puppy.

2. Her **plaintive** voice begged for help.

Vociferous

adj.

/voʊˈsɪfərəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Conspicuously and offensively loud; given to vehement outcry

USAGE

1. In giving Marcia a particular **vociferous** response, Paul caused people at every other table in the restaurant to turn around an look at them angrily.

2. The **vociferous** crowd demanded an answer from the mayor.

Consistent

adjective

/kənˈsɪstənt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Marked by an orderly, logical, and aesthetically consistent relation of parts
2. (sometimes followed by `with') In agreement or consistent or reliable
3. The same throughout in structure or composition

USAGE

1. Testimony **consistent** with the known facts

2. I have decided that the course of conduct which I am following is **consistent** with my sense of responsibility as president in time of war

Camouflage

noun / verb

/ˈkæməfˌlɑʒ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) Device or stratagem for concealment or deceit
2. (noun) An outward semblance that misrepresents the true nature of something

USAGE

1. The troops **camouflaged** themselves before they went into enemy territory

2. The soldiers wore **camouflage** to blend into the forest.

Diffuse

verb / adjective

/dɪfˈjus/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (verb) Cause to become widely known
2. (verb) Spread or diffuse through
3. (verb) Move outward

USAGE

1. A large **diffuse** organization

2. A **diffuse** historical novel

Gambit

noun

/ˈgæmbɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

A manuveur or risk in a game or conversation, designed to secure an advantage

USAGE

1. Randy played a **gambit**, telling his boss that he would leave at the end of the week if he didn't get a raise.

2. Offering a free trial was a clever **gambit** to win customers.

Coincidental

adjective

/koʊˌɪnsəˈdɛntəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Occurring or operating at the same time

USAGE

1. A series of **coincident** events

2. The meeting was **coincidental**, since neither of us had planned it.

Interpretation

noun

/ˌɪnˌtərprɪˈteɪʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The act of interpreting something as expressed in an artistic performance
2. An explanation of something that is not immediately obvious
3. A mental representation of the meaning or significance of something

USAGE

1. The edict was subject to many **interpretations**

2. The report included his **interpretation** of the forensic evidence

Deteriorate

verb

/dɪˈtɪriəɹˌeɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Grow worse
2. Become worse or disintegrate

USAGE

1. Her condition **deteriorated**

2. His mind **deteriorated**

Deleterious

adj.

/ˌdɛləˈtɪəriəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Harmful to living things

USAGE

1. The BP oil spill in the Gulf of Mexico was **deleterious** to the fishing industry in the southern states.

2. Chronic lack of sleep has **deleterious** effects on memory.

Anticipate

verb

/ænˈtɪsəˌpeɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Be a forerunner of or occur earlier than
2. Regard something as probable or likely
3. Realize beforehand

USAGE

1. This composition **anticipates** Impressionism

2. We **anticipate** a large crowd at the opening ceremony.

Ensemble

noun

/ɑnˈsɑmbəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. A coordinated outfit (set of clothing)
2. A group of musicians playing or singing together
3. The chorus of a ballet company

USAGE

1. A string **ensemble**

2. The jazz **ensemble** performed three songs at the festival.

Decline

noun / verb

/dɪkˈlaɪn/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) A downward slope or bend
2. (noun) A gradual decrease; as of stored charge or current
3. (noun) Change toward something smaller or lower

USAGE

1. He **declined** to join the group on a hike

2. In many languages, speakers **decline** nouns, pronouns, and adjectives

Trenchant

adj.

/ˈtrɛntʃənt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Characterized by or full of force and vigor; having keenness and forcefulness and penetration in thought, expression, or intellect

USAGE

1. Jill presented a rather superficial treatment of sales in Asia, but her **trenchant** analysis of sales in Europe inspired a number of insights into how to proceed in that market.

2. Her **trenchant** analysis cut straight to the heart of the issue.

Obdurate

adj.

/ˈɑbdərət/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Stubbornly persistent in changing an opinion or action

USAGE

1. No number of pleas and bribes would get him to change his **obdurate** attitude.

2. The **obdurate** senator refused to change his vote.

Verification

noun

/ˌvɛrəfəˈkeɪʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (law) An affidavit attached to a statement confirming the truth of that statement
2. Additional proof that something that was believed (some fact or hypothesis or theory) is correct

USAGE

1. The bank requires **verification** of your address.

2. The **verification** of the signature took only a few minutes.

Superficial

adjective

/ˌsupərˈfɪʃəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Of little substance or significance
2. Of, affecting, or being on or near the surface

USAGE

1. **Superficial** similarities

2. A **superficial** mind

Incite

verb

/ˌɪnˈsaɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Provoke or stir up
2. Urge on; cause to act
3. Give an incentive for action

USAGE

1. **Incite** a riot

2. The speech **incited** the crowd to riot.

Consent

noun / verb

/kənˈsɛnt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) Permission to do something
2. (verb) Give an affirmative reply to; respond favorably to

USAGE

1. He indicated his **consent**

2. Doctors need your **consent** before any surgery.

Objective

noun / adjective

/əbˈdʒɛktɪv/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) The goal intended to be attained (and which is believed to be attainable)
2. (adjective) Belonging to immediate experience of actual things or events

USAGE

1. The sole **object** of her trip was to see her children

2. **Objective** benefits

Hostile

noun / adjective

/ˈhɑstəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) Troops belonging to the enemy's military forces
2. (adjective) Not belonging to your own country's forces or those of an ally
3. (adjective) Very unfavorable to life or growth

USAGE

1. The platoon ran into a pack of **hostiles**

2. **Hostile** takeover

Tout

verb

/taʊt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Advertize in strongly positive terms; show off

USAGE

1. At the conference, the CEO **touted** the extraordinary success of his company's Research & Development division.

2. The agency **touted** its new software as the best on the market.

Morose

adj.

/məˈroʊs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Ill-tempered and not inclined to talk; gloomy

USAGE

1. After Stanley found out he was no longer able to go on vacation with his friends, he sat in his room **morosely**.

2. The **morose** poet wrote only about loss and grief.

Procure

verb

/proʊkˈjʊr/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Arrange for sexual partners for others
2. Get by special effort

USAGE

1. He **procured** extra cigarettes even though they were rationed

2. The company will **procure** new equipment for the factory.

Confound

verb

/kənˈfaʊnd/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Be confusing or perplexing to
2. Mistake one thing for another

USAGE

1. Though Harry loved numbers, he found calculus **confounding**.

2. Americans often **confound** sweet potatoes with yams and refer to both vegetables by the same name.

Flounder

verb

/ˈflaʊndər/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Behave awkwardly; have difficulties

USAGE

1. Sylvia has excelled at advanced calculus, but ironically, when she has deal with taxes, she **flounders**.

2. The new manager **floundered** during her first month.

Climax

noun / verb

/ˈklaɪˌmæks/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) The moment of most intense pleasure in sexual intercourse
2. (noun) The decisive moment in a novel or play
3. (noun) Arrangement of clauses in ascending order of forcefulness

USAGE

1. The deathbed scene is the **climax** of the play

2. The **climax** of the artist's career

Outlandish

adjective

/aʊtˈlændɪʃ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Conspicuously or grossly unconventional or unusual

USAGE

1. The **outlandish** clothes of teenagers

2. His **outlandish** claims made the reporters laugh.

Conflict

noun / verb

/ˈkanflɪkt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) A hostile meeting of opposing military forces in the course of a war
2. (noun) An open clash between two opposing groups (or individuals);--Thomas Paine
3. (noun) An incompatibility of dates or events

USAGE

1. The harder the **conflict** the more glorious the triumph

2. He noticed a **conflict** in the dates of the two meetings

Confront

verb

/kənˈfrʌnt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Deal with (something unpleasant) head on
2. Present somebody with something, usually to accuse or criticize
3. Oppose, as in hostility or a competition

USAGE

1. You must **confront** your problems

2. We **confronted** him with the evidence

Ambiguous

adj.

/æmˈbɪgjuəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Open to more than one interpretation

USAGE

1. The coach told his team, "Move towards that side of the field"; because he did not point, his directions were **ambiguous**, and the team had no idea to which side he was referring.

2. The contract's **ambiguous** wording led to a lawsuit.

Adage

noun

/ˈædədʒ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

A condensed but memorable saying embodying some important fact of experience that is taken as true by many people

USAGE

1. An old **adage** says that time heals all wounds.

2. The **adage** 'slow and steady wins the race' is well known.

Implement

noun / verb

/ˈɪmpləmənt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) Instrumentation (a piece of equipment or tool) used to effect an end
2. (verb) Pursue to a conclusion or bring to a successful issue
3. (verb) Apply in a manner consistent with its purpose or design

USAGE

1. He **implemented** a new economic plan

2. **Implement** a procedure

Curtail

verb

/kərˈteɪl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Place restrictions on
2. Terminate or abbreviate before its intended or proper end or its full extent

USAGE

1. **Curtail** drinking in school

2. Personal freedom is **curtailed** in many countries

Affect

noun / verb

/əˈfɛkt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) The conscious subjective aspect of feeling or emotion
2. (verb) Act physically on; have an effect upon
3. (verb) Have an effect upon

USAGE

1. The medicine **affects** my heart rate

2. Will the new rules **affect** me?

Withhold

verb

/wɪθˈhoʊld/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Hold back; refuse to hand over or share
2. Retain and refrain from disbursing; of payments

USAGE

1. The father is **withholding** the allowance until the son cleans his room

2. My employer is **withholding** taxes

Aspersion

noun

/əsˈpɜrʒən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The act of sprinkling water in baptism (rare)
2. An abusive attack on a person's character or good name
3. A disparaging remark

USAGE

1. In the 19th century any reference to female sexuality was considered a vile **aspersion**

2. He cast **aspersions** on his rival's honesty during the debate.

Esteem

noun / verb

/əsˈtim/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) An attitude of admiration or esteem
2. (noun) A feeling of delighted approval and liking
3. (noun) The condition of being honored (esteemed or respected or well regarded)

USAGE

1. It is held in **esteem**

2. Her colleagues hold her in high **esteem**.

Legislature

noun

/ˈlɛdʒəsˌleɪtʃər/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Persons who make or amend or repeal laws

USAGE

1. The **legislature** passed a new budget on Friday.

2. The state **legislature** debated the new tax law.

Signify

verb

/ˈsɪgnəˌfaɪ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Denote or connote
2. Convey or express a meaning
3. Make known with a word or signal

USAGE

1. What does his strange behavior **signify**?

2. He **signified** his wish to pay the bill for our meal

Denigrate

verb

/ˈdɛnɪgreɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Charge falsely or with malicious intent; attack the good name and reputation of someone

USAGE

1. Count Rumford **denigrated** the new theory of heat, demonstrating that it was wholly inadequate to explain the observations.

2. The campaign ads **denigrated** the opponent's record.

Antique

noun / verb / adjective

/ænˈtik/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) An elderly man
2. (verb) Give an antique appearance to
3. (verb) Shop for antiques

USAGE

1. **Antique** furniture

2. We went **antiquing** on Saturday

Recapitulate

verb

/ˌrikəˈpɪtʃəˌleɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Summarize briefly
2. Repeat an earlier theme of a composition
3. Repeat stages of evolutionary development during the embryonic phase of life

USAGE

1. Let's **recapitulate** the main ideas

2. At the end of the lecture, she **recapitulated** the main points.

Deprive

verb

/dɪpˈraɪv/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Take away
2. Keep from having, keeping, or obtaining
3. Take away possessions from someone

USAGE

1. The drought **deprived** the farmers of their crops.

2. Prison **deprives** people of their freedom.

Controversial

adjective

/ˌkɑntrəˈvɜrʃəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Marked by or capable of arousing controversy

USAGE

1. The issue of the death penalty is highly **controversial**

2. Rushdie's **controversial** book

Lethargic

adj.

/ləˈθɑrdʒɪk/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Lacking energy

USAGE

1. Nothing can make a person more **lethargic** than a big turkey dinner.

2. The heat made the whole class feel **lethargic**.

Enticing

adjective

/ɛnˈtaɪsɪŋ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Highly attractive and able to arouse hope or desire

USAGE

1. Difficult to say no to an **enticing** advertisement

2. The smell of fresh bread was **enticing**.

Principle

noun

/ˈprɪnsəpəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

A basic truth or law or assumption

USAGE

1. The **principles** of internal-combustion engines

2. The **principles** of democracy

Compensation

noun

/ˌkɑmpənˈseɪʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

The act of compensating for service or loss or injury

USAGE

1. He received **compensation** for the injury he suffered at work.

2. The company offered generous **compensation** for the extra hours.

Wean

verb

/win/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Gradually deprive (infants and young mammals) of mother's milk
2. Detach the affections of

USAGE

1. She **weaned** her baby when he was 3 months old and started him on powdered milk

2. The kitten was **weaned** and fed by its owner with a bottle

Daunt

verb

/dɔnt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Cause to lose courage

USAGE

1. The huge mountain did not **daunt** the experienced climbers.

2. The long list of tasks **daunted** the new intern.

Decisive

adjective

/dɪˈsaɪsɪv/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Forming or having the nature of a turning point or crisis
2. Determining or having the power to determine an outcome
3. Characterized by decision and firmness

USAGE

1. Cast the **decisive** vote

2. Two factors had a **decisive** influence

Auction

noun / verb

/ˈɑkʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) The public sale of something to the highest bidder
2. (verb) Sell at an auction

USAGE

1. The rare painting was sold at **auction** for a record price.

2. They will **auction** the old car next week.

Flammable

adjective

/ˈflæməbəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Easily ignited

USAGE

1. Keep **flammable** liquids away from the stove.

2. The **flammable** material caught fire quickly.

Flourish

noun / verb

/ˈflɜrɪʃ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) (music) a short lively tune played on brass instruments
2. (noun) The act of waving
3. (noun) A display of ornamental speech or language

USAGE

1. He entered to a **flourish** of trumpets

2. She entered with a great **flourish**

Placate

verb

/ˈpleɪkeɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Cause to be more favorably inclined; gain the good will of

USAGE

1. I was able to **placate** the angry mob of students by promising to bring cookies on Monday.

2. The manager offered a discount to **placate** the frustrated customers.

Catalyst

noun

/ˈkætəlɪst/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Something that speeds up an event

USAGE

1. Rosa Park's refusal to give up her bus seat acted as a **catalyst** for the Civil Rights Movement, setting into motion historic changes for African-Americans.

2. The scandal was the **catalyst** for major reforms.

Apathetic

adj.

/ˌæpəˈθɛtɪk/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Marked by a lack of interest

USAGE

1. Mr. Thompson was so talented at teaching math that even normally **apathetic** students took interest.

2. The **apathetic** crowd barely clapped after the performance.

Revolt

noun / verb

/rɪˈvoʊlt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (verb) Cause aversion in; offend the moral sense of
2. (verb) Fill with distaste
3. (verb) Make revolution

USAGE

1. The people **revolted** when bread prices tripled again

2. The soldiers **revolted** against their harsh commander.

Eschew

verb

/ɪsˈtʃuː/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Avoid and stay away from deliberately; stay clear of

USAGE

1. Politicians are the masters of **eschewing** morals; academics are the masters of eschewing clarity.

2. Many doctors **eschew** fad diets in favor of balanced meals.

Ambivalent

adj.

/æmˈbɪvələnt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Mixed or conflicting emotions about something

USAGE

1. Sam was **ambivalent** about studying for the exam because doing so ate up a lot of his time, yet he was able to improve his analytical skills.

2. She felt **ambivalent** about the job offer: it paid well but required moving across the country.

Scrutinize

verb

/ˈskrutəˌnaɪz/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Examine carefully for accuracy with the intent of verification
2. To look at critically or searchingly, or in minute detail

USAGE

1. He **scrutinized** his likeness in the mirror

2. The editor **scrutinized** every line of the manuscript.

Untoward

adj.

/ʌnˈtɔrd/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Unfavorable; inconvenient

USAGE

1. Some professors find teaching **untoward** as having to prepare for lectures and conduct office hours prevents them from focusing on their research.

2. Nothing **untoward** happened during the flight.

Legitimate

verb / adjective

/ləˈdʒɪtəmət/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (verb) Show or affirm to be just and legitimate
2. (verb) Make legal
3. (adjective) Authorized, sanctioned by, or in accordance with law

USAGE

1. They **legitimized** their natural child

2. A **legitimate** government

Altruism

noun

/ˈæltruˌɪzəm/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

The quality of unselfish concern for the welfare of others

USAGE

1. Albert Schweitzer spent most of his life doing missionary work as a doctor in Africa, seeking no reward, apparently motivated only by **altruism**.

2. Her **altruism** led her to donate a kidney to a stranger.

Intricate

adjective

/ˈɪntrəkət/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Having many complexly arranged elements; elaborate

USAGE

1. **Intricate** lacework

2. The **intricate** design of the lace took months to make.

Redundant

adjective

/rɪˈdʌndənt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Repetition of same sense in different words
2. More than is needed, desired, or required

USAGE

1. At the risk of being **redundant** I return to my original proposition

2. Yet another book on heraldry might be thought **redundant**

Redemptive

adjective

/rɪˈdɛmptɪv/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Bringing about salvation or redemption from sin
2. Of or relating to or resulting in redemption

USAGE

1. **Redemptive** (or redeeming) love

2. A **redemptive** theory about life

Historical

adjective

/hɪsˈtɔrɪkəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Belonging to the past; of what is important or famous in the past
2. Of or relating to the study of history

USAGE

1. **Historic** victories

2. **Historical** (or historic) times

Plummet

noun / verb

/ˈplʌmət/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) The metal bob of a plumb line
2. (verb) Drop sharply

USAGE

1. The stock market **plummeted**

2. The stock price began to **plummet** after the announcement.

Devoid

adjective

/dɪˈvɔɪd/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Completely wanting or lacking

USAGE

1. The sentence was **devoid** of meaning

2. The room was **devoid** of furniture and decoration.

Anachronistic

adjective

/əˌnækrəˈnɪstɪk/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Chronologically misplaced

USAGE

1. English public schools are **anachronistic**

2. The film's **anachronistic** costumes were out of place for the period.

Abstain

verb

/əbˈsteɪn/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Choose not to consume or take part in (particularly something enjoyable)

USAGE

1. Considered a health nut, Jessica **abstained** from anything containing sugar, even chocolate.

2. She **abstains** from caffeine after noon so she can sleep well.

Impervious

adj.

/ɪmˈpɜrviəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Not admitting of passage or capable of being affected

USAGE

1. I am not **impervious** to your insults; they cause me great pain.

2. The waxed coat was **impervious** to the rain.

Synonymous

adjective

/səˈnɑnəməs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

(of words) Meaning the same or nearly the same

USAGE

1. For many people, luxury is **synonymous** with comfort.

2. Her name has become **synonymous** with honesty.

Overture

noun

/ˈoʊvərtʃər/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Orchestral music played at the beginning of an opera or oratorio
2. A tentative suggestion designed to elicit the reactions of others
3. Something that serves as a preceding event or introduces what follows

USAGE

1. Drinks were the **overture** to dinner

2. The orchestra began with a stirring **overture**.

Precipitate

adj. / verb

/prɪˈsɪpɪtət/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (adj.) Hasty or rash
2. (verb) To cause to happen

USAGE

1. Instead of conducting a thorough investigation after the city hall break-in, the governor acted **precipitately**, accusing his staff of aiding and abetting the criminals.

2. The government's mishandling the hurricane's aftermath **precipitated** a widespread outbreak of looting and other criminal activity.

Obstacle

noun

/ˈɑbstəkəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Something immaterial that stands in the way and must be circumvented or surmounted
2. An obstruction that stands in the way (and must be removed or surmounted or circumvented)

USAGE

1. Lack of imagination is an **obstacle** to one's advancement

2. The poverty of a district is an **obstacle** to good education

Odorous

adjective

/ˈoʊdərəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Having a natural fragrance
2. Emitting an odor
3. Having odor or a characteristic odor

USAGE

1. **Odoriferous** spices

2. The **odorous** air of the orchard

Antagonize

verb

/ænˈtægəˌnaɪz/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Provoke the hostility of
2. Act in opposition to

USAGE

1. Don't **antagonize** your boss

2. Harsh criticism can **antagonize** the people you want to win over.

Pervasive

adjective

/pərˈveɪsɪv/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Spreading or spread throughout

USAGE

1. The **pervasive** odor of garlic

2. An error is **pervasive** if it is material to more than one conclusion

Substantial

adjective

/səbˈstænʃəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Fairly large
2. Having substance or capable of being treated as fact; not imaginary
3. Of good quality and condition; solidly built

USAGE

1. Won by a **substantial** margin

2. The **substantial** world

Asset

noun

/ˈæˌsɛt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

A useful or valuable quality

USAGE

1. Her language skills are a valuable **asset** to the company.

2. The house is his most valuable **asset**.

Arrogant

adjective

/ˈɛrəgənt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Having or showing feelings of unwarranted importance out of overbearing pride

USAGE

1. An **arrogant** official

2. **Arrogant** claims

Chary

adj.

/ˈtʃɛri/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Cautious

USAGE

1. Jack was wary of GRE words that looked similar, because they usually had different definitions; not so with **chary**, a word that he began to use interchangeably with wary.

2. He was **chary** of signing any contract he had not read.

Undercut

noun / verb

/ˈʌndərˌkʌt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) A cut made underneath to remove material
2. (noun) (sports) a stroke that puts reverse spin on the ball
3. (noun) The tender meat of the loin muscle on each side of the vertebral column

USAGE

1. **Undercut** a vein of ore

2. Cheap imports **undercut** the prices of local shops.

Fragile

adjective

/ˈfrædʒəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Vulnerably delicate
2. Easily broken or damaged or destroyed
3. Lacking substance or significance; a fragile claim to fame"

USAGE

1. She has the **fragile** beauty of youth

2. **Fragile** porcelain plates

Confident

adjective

/ˈkɑnfədənt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Not liable to error in judgment or action
2. Having or marked by confidence or assurance

USAGE

1. A **confident** speaker

2. A **confident** reply

Complacent

adj.

/kəmˈpleɪsənt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Contented to a fault with oneself or one's actions

USAGE

1. After the water polo team won their sixth championship, they became **complacent** and didn't even make it to the playoffs the next year.

2. **Complacent** after years of success, the company missed the new trend.

Democracy

noun

/dɪˈmɑkrəsi/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The political orientation of those who favor government by the people or by their elected representatives
2. The doctrine that the numerical majority of an organized group can make decisions binding on the whole group
3. A political system in which the supreme power lies in a body of citizens who can elect people to represent them

USAGE

1. **Democracy** depends on free elections and a free press.

2. Citizens in a **democracy** can vote for their leaders.

Ephemeral

adj.

/ɪˈfɛmərəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Lasting a very short time

USAGE

1. The lifespan of a mayfly is **ephemeral**, lasting from a few hours to a couple of days.

2. The joy of a viral video is often **ephemeral**.

Abuse

noun / verb

/əbˈjus/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) Cruel or inhumane treatment
2. (noun) Improper or excessive use
3. (noun) A rude expression intended to offend or hurt

USAGE

1. The child showed signs of physical **abuse**

2. Alcohol **abuse**

Attribute

noun / verb

/ˈætrəbˌjut/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) An abstraction belonging to or characteristic of an entity
2. (noun) A construct whereby objects or individuals can be distinguished
3. (verb) Attribute or credit to

USAGE

1. We **attributed** this quotation to Shakespeare

2. Patience is one of her best **attributes**.

Intimidate

verb

/ˌɪnˈtɪmɪˌdeɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Make timid or fearful
2. To compel or deter by or as if by threats

USAGE

1. Her boss **intimidates** her

2. The gang tried to **intimidate** the witnesses into silence.

Abridge

verb

/əbˈrɪdʒ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Lessen, diminish, or curtail
2. Reduce in scope while retaining essential elements

USAGE

1. The new law might **abridge** our freedom of expression

2. The publisher **abridged** the novel for younger readers.

Prestige

noun

/prɛsˈtiʒ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

A high standing achieved through success or influence or wealth etc.

USAGE

1. He wanted to achieve power and **prestige**

2. The university has great **prestige** around the world.

Diffident

adj.

/ˈdɪfɪdənt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Showing modest reserve; lacking self-confidence

USAGE

1. As a young girl she was **diffident** and reserved, but now as an adult, she is confident and assertive.

2. The **diffident** student rarely spoke up in class.

Inclination

noun

/ˌɪnkləˈneɪʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The act of inclining; bending forward
2. The property possessed by a line or surface that departs from the vertical
3. An attitude of mind especially one that favors one alternative over others

USAGE

1. An **inclination** of his head indicated his agreement

2. The alkaline **inclination** of the local waters

Prolong

verb

/prəˈlɔŋ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Lengthen in time; cause to be or last longer
2. Lengthen or extend in duration or space

USAGE

1. We **prolonged** our stay

2. **Prolong** the treatment of the patient

Instinctive

adjective

/ˌɪnˈstɪŋktɪv/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Unthinking; prompted by (or as if by) instinct

USAGE

1. Offering to help was as **instinctive** as breathing

2. Her **instinctive** reaction was to step back from the edge.

Misrepresent

verb

/mɪsˌrɛprəˈzɛnt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Represent falsely
2. Tamper, with the purpose of deception

USAGE

1. This statement **misrepresents** my intentions

2. The report **misrepresented** the results of the survey.

Sporadic

adj.

/spəˈrædɪk/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Recurring in scattered and irregular or unpredictable instances

USAGE

1. The signals were at first **sporadic**, but now we detect a clear, consistent pattern of electromagnetic radiation eminating from deep space.

2. **Sporadic** showers fell throughout the afternoon.

Avert

verb

/əˈvɜrt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Turn away
2. Ward off or prevent

USAGE

1. Afraid to see the aftermath of the car crash, I **averted** my eyes as we drove by.

2. The struggling videogame company put all of its finances into one final, desperate project to **avert** bankrupcy.

Erratic

adj.

/ɪˈrætɪk/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Unpredictable; strange and unconventional

USAGE

1. It came as no surprise to pundits that the President's attempt at re-election floundered; even during his term, support for his policies was **erratic**, with an approval rating jumping anywhere from 30 to 60 percent.

2. The **erratic** bus schedule made commuting impossible.

Casual

adjective

/ˈkæʒəwəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Hasty and without attention to detail; not thorough
2. Marked by blithe unconcern
3. Not showing effort or strain

USAGE

1. A **casual** (or cursory) inspection failed to reveal the house's structural flaws

2. An ability to interest **casual** students

Pastoral

adj.

/ˈpæstərəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Relating to the countryside in a pleasant sense

USAGE

1. Those who imagine America's countryside as a **pastoral** region are often disappointed to learn that much of rural U.S. is filled with cornfields extending as far as the eye can see.

2. The painter loved **pastoral** scenes of cows and green hills.

Inelegant

adjective

/ɪnˈɛləgənt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Lacking in refinement or grace or good taste

USAGE

1. The **inelegant** solution worked, but it looked clumsy.

2. His **inelegant** handwriting was hard to read.

Implication

noun

/ˌɪmpləˈkeɪʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Something that is inferred (deduced or entailed or implied)
2. A meaning that is not expressly stated but can be inferred
3. An accusation that brings into intimate and usually incriminating connection

USAGE

1. His resignation had political **implications**

2. The expectation was spread both by word and by **implication**

Ploy

noun

/plɔɪ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

A clever plan to turn a situation to one's advantage

USAGE

1. Dennis arranged an elaborate **ploy**, involving 14 different people lying for him in different situations, so that it could appear that he was meeting Mary completely by chance at the wedding reception.

2. The offer of free samples was a **ploy** to attract customers.

Publicity

noun

/pəbˈlɪsəti/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

The quality of being open to public view

USAGE

1. The **publicity** of the court room

2. The actor's arrest brought the film a lot of **publicity**.

Detain

verb

/dɪˈteɪn/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Cause to be slowed down or delayed
2. Stop or halt
3. Deprive of freedom; take into confinement

USAGE

1. Police **detained** three men for questioning.

2. The flight was **detained** by bad weather.

Noxious

adjective

/ˈnɑkʃəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Injurious to physical or mental health

USAGE

1. **Noxious** chemical wastes

2. **Noxious** ideas

Constitute

verb

/ˈkɑnstəˌtut/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Set up or lay the groundwork for
2. Create and charge with a task or function
3. Form or compose

USAGE

1. These **constitute** my entire belonging

2. Three votes **constitute** a majority on the committee.

Ornament

noun / verb

/ˈɔrnəmənt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) Something used to beautify
2. (verb) Make more attractive by adding ornament, colour, etc.
3. (verb) Be an ornament to

USAGE

1. Stars **ornamented** the Christmas tree

2. The old house was decorated with carved wooden **ornaments**.

Judgment

noun

/ˈdʒʌdʒmənt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The act of judging or assessing a person or situation or event
2. The mental ability to understand and discriminate between relations

USAGE

1. They criticized my **judgment** of the contestants

2. He was reluctant to make his **judgment** known

Dissent

noun / verb

/dɪˈsɛnt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) A difference of opinion
2. (noun) (law) the difference of one judge's opinion from that of the majority
3. (verb) Withhold assent

USAGE

1. He expressed his **dissent** in a contrary opinion

2. Several Republicans **dissented**

Incoherent

adjective

/ˌɪnkoʊˈhɪrənt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Unable to express yourself clearly or fluently
2. (physics) Of waves having no stable definite or stable phase relation
3. Without logical or meaningful connection

USAGE

1. **Incoherent** with grief

2. A turgid **incoherent** presentation

Capricious

adj.

/kəˈprɪʃəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Determined by chance, impulse, or whim rather than by necessity or reason

USAGE

1. Nearly every month our **capricious** CEO had a new plan to turn the company around, and none of them worked because we never gave them the time they needed to succeed.

2. The **capricious** weather ruined our picnic plans three times this month.

Quarrelsome

adjective

/ˈkwɔrəlsəm/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Given to quarreling

USAGE

1. **Quarrelsome** when drinking

2. The **quarrelsome** neighbors argued about the fence every week.

Inherit

verb

/ˌɪnˈhɛrət/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Obtain from someone after their death
2. Receive by genetic transmission
3. Receive from a predecessor

USAGE

1. I **inherited** a castle from my French grandparents

2. I **inherited** my good eyesight from my mother

Authorize

verb

/ˈɔθərˌaɪz/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Grant authorization or clearance for
2. Give or delegate power or authority to

USAGE

1. The rock star never **authorized** this slanderous biography

2. She **authorized** her assistant to sign the papers

Favorable

adjective

/ˈfeɪvərəbəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Presaging or likely to bring good luck
2. Occurring at a convenient or suitable time
3. (of winds or weather) Tending to promote or facilitate

USAGE

1. A **favorable** time to ask for a raise

2. The days were fair and the winds were **favorable**

Commencement

noun

/kəˈmɛnsmənt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The act of starting something
2. An academic exercise in which diplomas are conferred
3. The time at which something is supposed to begin

USAGE

1. The **commencement** speech inspired the graduating class.

2. The **commencement** of the project was delayed by a month.

Consummate

adj. / verb

/ˈkɑnsəmət/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (adj.) Having or revealing supreme mastery or skill
2. (verb) To make perfect and complete in every respect

USAGE

1. Tyler was the **consummate** musician: he was able to play the guitar, harmonica, and the drum at the same time.

2. The restoration of the ancient church was only **consummated** after a twenty years of labor.

Transient

adj.

/ˈtrænʃənt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Lasting a very short time

USAGE

1. The unpredictable and **transient** nature of deja vu makes it a very difficult phenomenon to study properly.

2. **Transient** jobs filled the summer months but offered no security.

Day 04- 200 Words: Dissident through Monotonous

Cards 601 to 800

Dissident

noun / adjective

/ˈdɪsədənt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) A person who dissents from some established policy
2. (adjective) Disagreeing, especially with a majority
3. (adjective) Characterized by departure from accepted beliefs or standards

USAGE

1. The **dissident** wrote articles criticizing the government.

2. **Dissident** voices were silenced by the regime.

Debutante

noun

/ˈdɛbjəˈtɑnt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

A young woman making her debut into society

USAGE

1. The **debutante** wore a white gown to the ball.

2. The **debutante** was introduced to society at the grand ball.

Jeopardize

verb

/ˈdʒɛpərˌdaɪz/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Put at risk
2. Pose a threat to; present a danger to

USAGE

1. Careless driving can **jeopardize** your life and others'.

2. The scandal could **jeopardize** the whole project.

Embody

verb

/ɪmˈbadi/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Represent, as of a character on stage
2. Represent in bodily form
3. Represent or express something abstract in tangible form

USAGE

1. She **embodies** the spirit of the team.

2. The statue **embodies** the courage of the soldiers.

Rashness

noun

/ˈræʃnəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The trait of giving little thought to danger
2. The trait of acting rashly and without prudence

USAGE

1. His **rashness** led him to invest all his savings in one stock.

2. His **rashness** cost the team the championship.

Dependence

noun

/dɪˈpɛndəns/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

The state of relying on or being controlled by someone or something else

USAGE

1. Her **dependence** on her parents ended when she got a job.

2. Her **dependence** on coffee made her feel tired without it.

Sentimental

adj.

/ˌsɛntɪˈmɛntəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Effusively or insincerely emotional, especially in art, music, and literature

USAGE

1. I don't like romanticism for the same reason I don't like melodramatic acting and soap operas--overly **sentimental**.

2. The **sentimental** song made the couple cry.

Hubris

noun

/ˈhjubrɪs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Overbearing pride or presumption

USAGE

1. Bill Clinton was criticized for his **hubris**, since he believed he could get away with anything once in the White House.

2. His **hubris** made him ignore every warning about the storm.

Prerogative

noun

/prɪˈrɑgətɪv/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

A right reserved exclusively by a particular person or group (especially a hereditary or official right)

USAGE

1. Suffrage was the **prerogative** of white adult males

2. It is the king's **prerogative** to pardon prisoners.

Utilitarian

noun / adjective

/juˌtɪləˈtɛriən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) Someone who believes that the value of a thing depends on its utility
2. (adjective) Having a useful function
3. (adjective) Having utility often to the exclusion of values

USAGE

1. **Utilitarian** steel tables

2. Plain **utilitarian** kitchenware

Asperity

noun

/æˈspɛrɪti/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Harshness of manner

USAGE

1. The editor was known for his **asperity**, often sending severe letters of rejection to amateur writers.

2. She answered with an **asperity** that surprised her friends.

Wary

adjective

/ˈwɛri/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Marked by keen caution and watchful prudence
2. Openly distrustful and unwilling to confide

USAGE

1. They were **wary** in their movements

2. A **wary** glance at the black clouds

Augment

verb

/ɔgˈmɛnt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Enlarge or increase; improve

USAGE

1. Ideally, the restaurant's **augmented** menu will expand its clientele and increase its profits.

2. The team hired extra staff to **augment** its sales force.

Lucid

adj.

/ˈluːsɪd/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

(of language) Transparently clear; easily understandable

USAGE

1. Though Walters writes about physics and time travel, his writing is always **lucid**, so readers with little scientific training can understand difficult concepts.

2. Her **lucid** explanation made the difficult theory simple.

Deceive

verb

/dɪˈsiv/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Cause someone to believe an untruth
2. Be false to; be dishonest with

USAGE

1. The insurance company **deceived** me when they told me they were covering my house

2. The salesman tried to **deceive** customers with false claims.

Deference

noun

/ˈdɛfərəns/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. A courteous expression (by word or deed) of esteem or regard
2. A disposition or tendency to yield to the will of others
3. Courteous regard for people's feelings

USAGE

1. His **deference** to her wishes was very flattering

2. In **deference** to your wishes

Fortuitous

adj.

/fɔrˈtjuːɪtəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Occurring by happy chance; having no cause or apparent cause

USAGE

1. While the real objects are vastly different sizes in space, the sun and the moon seem to have the same **fortuitous** size in the sky.

2. A **fortuitous** meeting on the train led to her first job.

Implicit

adjective

/ˌɪmˈplɪsət/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Being without doubt or reserve
2. Implied though not directly expressed; inherent in the nature of something

USAGE

1. **Implicit** trust

2. An **implicit** agreement not to raise the subject

Impunity

noun

/ˌɪmˈpjunɪti/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Exemption from punishment or loss

USAGE

1. The criminals acted with **impunity** because no one stopped them.

2. Corrupt officials often escape punishment with **impunity**.

Cunning

noun / adjective

/ˈkʌnɪŋ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) Crafty artfulness (especially in deception)
2. (noun) Shrewdness as demonstrated by being skilled in deception
3. (adjective) Showing inventiveness and skill

USAGE

1. The **cunning** maneuvers leading to his success

2. **Cunning** men often pass for wise

Comprehend

verb

/ˌkɑmpriˈhɛnd/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Get the meaning of something
2. To become aware of through the senses

USAGE

1. Do you **comprehend** the meaning of this letter?

2. It took me hours to **comprehend** the new theory.

Identical

adjective

/aɪˈdɛntɪkəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (of twins) Derived from a single egg or ovum
2. Coinciding exactly when superimposed
3. Having properties with uniform values along all axes

USAGE

1. **Identical** twins are monovular

2. **Identical** triangles

Espouse

verb

/ɪˈspaʊz/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

To adopt or support an idea or cause

USAGE

1. As a college student, Charlie **espoused** Marxism, growing his beard out and railing against the evils of the free-market.

2. She has long **espoused** the value of public libraries.

Listlessness

noun

/ˈlɪstləsnəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Inactivity resulting from lethargy and lack of vigor or energy
2. A feeling of lack of interest or energy

USAGE

1. Her **listlessness** worried the doctor.

2. The heat brought a feeling of **listlessness** to the whole class.

Obeisance

noun

/oʊˈbeɪsəns/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The act of obeying; dutiful or submissive behavior with respect to another person
2. Bending the head or body or knee as a sign of reverence or submission or shame or greeting

USAGE

1. The servants bowed in **obeisance** to the queen.

2. The guests paid **obeisance** to the emperor as he entered.

Prose

noun

/proʊz/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Ordinary writing as distinguished from verse
2. Matter of fact, commonplace, or dull expression

USAGE

1. The novel is written in clear and simple **prose**.

2. The poem was turned into **prose** for the children.

Formidable

adjective

/ˈfɔrmədəbəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Inspiring fear
2. Extremely impressive in strength or excellence

USAGE

1. The **formidable** prospect of major surgery

2. A **formidable** opponent

Fatuous

adjective

/ˈfætʃəwəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Devoid of intelligence

USAGE

1. His **fatuous** remarks made the meeting embarrassing.

2. The **fatuous** advertisement insulted the audience.

Effrontery

noun

/ɪˈfrʌntəri/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Audacious (even arrogant) behavior that you have no right to

USAGE

1. The skateboarders acted with **effrontery**, skating through the church grounds and spray-painting signs warning trespassers.

2. He had the **effrontery** to ask for a raise on his first day.

Uneasiness

noun

/ˌʌˈnizinəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Inability to rest or relax or be still
2. The trait of seeming ill at ease
3. Embarrassment deriving from the feeling that others are critically aware of you

USAGE

1. A sense of **uneasiness** spread through the crowd.

2. A growing **uneasiness** filled the room as the lights went out.

Blithe

adjective

/blaɪð/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Carefree and happy and lighthearted
2. Lacking or showing a lack of due concern

USAGE

1. Was loved for her **blithe** spirit

2. A merry **blithesome** nature

Cynical

adjective

/ˈsɪnɪkəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Believing the worst of human nature and motives; having a sneering disbelief in e.g. selflessness of others

USAGE

1. Years of broken promises made him **cynical** about politics.

2. The **cynical** reporter did not believe a word of the speech.

Subsidize

verb

/ˈsʌbsɪˌdaɪz/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Support through subsidies
2. Secure the assistance of by granting a subsidy, as of nations or military forces

USAGE

1. The arts in Europe are heavily **subsidized**

2. The government will **subsidize** the cost of electric cars.

Mere

noun

/mɪr/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

A small pond of standing water

USAGE

1. The **mere** sound of thunder made the dog hide.

2. The **mere** thought of the exam made her nervous.

Castigation

noun

/ˌkæstɪˈgeɪʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Verbal punishment
2. A severe scolding

USAGE

1. The coach's **castigation** of the team lasted the whole half-time break.

2. The newspaper printed a harsh **castigation** of the mayor.

Solicitousness

noun

/səˈlɪsɪtəsnəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

A feeling of excessive concern

USAGE

1. Her **solicitousness** made the sick patient feel cared for.

2. Her **solicitousness** toward her patients earned their trust.

Dissipate

verb

/ˈdɪsəˌpeɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Squander or spend money frivolously
2. To disperse or scatter

USAGE

1. The recent graduates **dissipated** their earnings on trips to Las Vegas and cruises in Mexico.

2. Kathleen's perfume was overwhelming in the cramped apartment, but once we stepped outside the smell **dissipated** and we could breathe once again.

Lend

verb

/lɛnd/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Give temporarily; let have for a limited time
2. Bestow a quality on

USAGE

1. I will **lend** you my car

2. Her presence **lends** a certain cachet to the company

Bridle

verb

/ˈbraɪdəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The act of restraining power or action or limiting excess
2. Anger or take offense

USAGE

1. New curfew laws have **bridled** people's tendency to go out at night.

2. The hostess **bridled** at the tactless dinner guests who insisted on eating before everybody had gotten their food.

Council

noun

/ˈkaʊnsəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. A meeting of people for consultation
2. A body serving in an administrative capacity

USAGE

1. Emergency **council**

2. Student **council**

Debate

noun / verb

/dəˈbeɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (verb) Argue with one another
2. (verb) Have an argument about something

USAGE

1. We **debated** the question of abortion

2. John **debated** Mary

Dubious

adjective

/ˈdubiəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Fraught with uncertainty or doubt
2. Not convinced
3. Open to doubt or suspicion

USAGE

1. **Dubious** about agreeing to go

2. They admitted the force of my argument but remained **dubious**

Enlighten

verb

/ˌɛnˈlaɪtən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Make free from confusion or ambiguity; make clear
2. Give spiritual insight to; in religion
3. Make understand

USAGE

1. Can you **enlighten** me--I don't understand this proposal

2. The professor's lecture **enlightened** the entire class.

Inevitable

noun / adjective

/ˌɪˈnɛvətəbəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) An unavoidable event
2. (adjective) Incapable of being avoided or prevented
3. (adjective) Invariably occurring or appearing

USAGE

1. Don't argue with the **inevitable**

2. The **inevitable** result

Tirade

noun

/taɪˈreɪd/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

An angry speech

USAGE

1. In terms of political change, a **tirade** oftentimes does little more than make the person speaking red in the face.

2. The angry customer launched into a **tirade** about the late delivery.

Evince

verb

/ɪˈvɪns/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Give expression to

USAGE

1. The child's drawings **evince** a real talent for color.

2. His calm voice **evinced** no fear.

Approbation

noun

/ˌæprəˈbeɪʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Official recognition or approval
2. Official approval

USAGE

1. The judge's **approbation** pleased the young lawyer.

2. The teacher's **approbation** gave the shy student confidence.

Continuous

adjective

/kənˈtɪnjuəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Continuing in time or space without interruption
2. Of a function or curve; extending without break or irregularity

USAGE

1. A **continuous** rearrangement of electrons in the solar atoms results in the emission of light

2. A **continuous** bout of illness lasting six months

Persuade

verb

/pərsˈweɪd/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Win approval or support for

USAGE

1. You can't **persuade** me to buy this ugly vase!

2. They tried to **persuade** the manager to change the schedule.

Astute

adjective

/əsˈtut/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Marked by practical hardheaded intelligence

USAGE

1. An **astute** tenant always reads the small print in a lease

2. The **astute** investor sold his shares before the crash.

Chortle

verb

/ˈtʃɔrtəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

To chuckle; laugh merrily

USAGE

1. Walking past the bar, I could hear happy, **chortling** people and the blast of horns from a jazz band.

2. He **chortled** at his own joke before anyone else laughed.

Connoisseur

noun

/ˌkɑnəˈsɜr/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

An expert able to appreciate a field; especially in the fine arts

USAGE

1. The **connoisseur** could tell the wines apart by taste.

2. A true **connoisseur** of art visits the gallery every month.

Superfluous

adj.

/suˈpɜrfluəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Serving no useful purpose
2. More than is needed, desired, or required

USAGE

1. How can we hope to stay open if we don't eliminate all **superfluous** spending, like catered meetings and free acupucture Tuesday?

2. Everything in this closet is **superfluous** and can be given to charity.

Entrepreneur

noun

/ˌɑntrəprəˈnɜr/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Someone who organizes a business venture and assumes the risk for it

USAGE

1. The young **entrepreneur** started a company in her garage.

2. The **entrepreneur** sold the business for millions.

Generous

adjective

/ˈdʒɛnərəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. More than adequate
2. Willing to give and share unstintingly
3. Not petty in character and mind

USAGE

1. A **generous** portion

2. A **generous** donation

Ironic

adjective

/aɪˈrɑnɪk/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Humorously sarcastic or mocking

USAGE

1. Madness, an **ironic** fate for such a clear thinker

2. It was **ironical** that the well-planned scheme failed so completely

Sincerity

noun

/sɪnˈsɛrəti/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The trait of being serious
2. A quality of naturalness and simplicity
3. The quality of being open and truthful; not deceitful or hypocritical

USAGE

1. The simple **sincerity** of folk songs

2. His **sincerity** inspired belief

Assure

verb

/əˈʃʊr/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Be careful or certain to do something; make certain of something
2. Make a promise or commitment
3. Make certain of

USAGE

1. I **assured** him that traveling to Cambodia was safe

2. The doctor **assured** the family that the surgery was safe.

Specimen

noun

/ˈspɛsəmən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. A bit of tissue or blood or urine that is taken for diagnostic purposes
2. An example regarded as typical of its class

USAGE

1. They collected a urine **specimen** for urinalysis

2. The biologist examined a rare insect **specimen** under the microscope.

Disinterested

adj.

/dɪsˈɪntrəstɪd/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Unbiased; neutral

USAGE

1. The potential juror knew the defendant, and therefore could not serve on the jury, which must consist only of **disinterested** members.

2. We asked a **disinterested** party to review the contract.

Articulate

verb / adjective

/ɑrˈtɪkjəˌleɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (verb) Express or state clearly
2. (verb) Speak, pronounce, or utter in a certain way
3. (verb) Put into words or an expression

USAGE

1. The ankle bone **articulates** with the leg bones to form the ankle bones

2. **Articulate** speech

Conservation

noun

/ˌkɑnsərˈveɪʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The preservation and careful management of the environment and of natural resources
2. An occurrence of improvement by virtue of preventing loss or injury or other change
3. (physics) The maintenance of a certain quantities unchanged during chemical reactions or physical transformations

USAGE

1. **Conservation** of wildlife is a priority for the park.

2. The **conservation** of rainforests is important for the planet.

Comprehensive

noun / adjective

/ˌkɑmpriˈhɛnsɪv/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (adjective) Including all or everything
2. (adjective) Broad in scope

USAGE

1. **Comprehensive** coverage

2. A **comprehensive** history of the revolution

Intellectual

noun / adjective

/ˌɪntəˈlɛktʃuəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) A person who uses the mind creatively
2. (adjective) Appealing to or using the intellect
3. (adjective) Of or associated with or requiring the use of the mind

USAGE

1. Satire is an **intellectual** weapon

2. **Intellectual** workers engaged in creative literary or artistic or scientific labor

Corridor

noun

/ˈkɔrədər/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

An enclosed passageway; rooms usually open onto it

USAGE

1. The long **corridor** led to the principal's office.

2. The long **corridor** was lined with portraits of old kings.

Farther

adjective / adverb

/ˈfɑrðər/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (adjective) More distant in especially space or time
2. (adjective) More distant in especially degree

USAGE

1. They live in the **farther** house

2. **Farther** from the truth

Laconic

adj.

/ləˈkɑnɪk/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

One who says very few words

USAGE

1. While Martha always swooned over the hunky, **laconic** types in romantic comedies, her boyfriends inevitably were very talkative--and not very hunky.

2. Her **laconic** reply, just 'Fine,' ended the conversation.

Mettle

noun

/ˈmɛtəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

The courage to carry on

USAGE

1. The young boxer showed his **mettle** in the final round.

2. The young soldier proved his **mettle** in the difficult battle.

Exhibit

noun / verb

/ɪgˈzɪbɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) Something shown to the public
2. (verb) Walk ostentatiously
3. (verb) To show, make visible or apparent

USAGE

1. The museum had many **exhibits** of oriental art

2. The Metropolitan Museum is **exhibiting** Goya's works this month

Inscrutable

adj.

/ɪnˈskruːtəbəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Not easily understood; unfathomable

USAGE

1. His speech was so dense and confusing that many in the audience found it **inscrutable**.

2. The judge's **inscrutable** expression revealed nothing about her verdict.

Incentive

noun

/ˌɪnˈsɛntɪv/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

A positive motivational influence

USAGE

1. The bonus is an **incentive** for workers to finish on time.

2. The company offered a bonus as an **incentive** to work harder.

Barrier

noun

/ˈbæriər/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. A structure or object that impedes free movement
2. Anything serving to maintain separation by obstructing vision or access

USAGE

1. Intolerance is a **barrier** to understanding

2. A high wall was a **barrier** between the two gardens.

Foppish

adjective

/ˈfɑpɪʃ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Affecting extreme elegance in dress and manner

USAGE

1. The **foppish** young man spent hours on his hair.

2. The **foppish** young man was always dressed in the latest fashion.

Default

noun / verb

/dɪˈfɔlt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) Loss due to not showing up
2. (noun) Loss resulting from failure of a debt to be paid
3. (noun) Act of failing to meet a financial obligation

USAGE

1. He lost the game by **default**

2. If you do not pay, the company will consider the loan in **default**.

Apprise

verb

/əpˈraɪz/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Increase the value of
2. Gain in value
3. Make aware of

USAGE

1. The Germans want to **appreciate** the Deutsche Mark

2. The yen **appreciated** again!

Eclectic

adj.

/ɪˈklɛktɪk/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Comprised of a variety of styles

USAGE

1. Joey was known for his **eclectic** tastes in music, one moment dancing to disco, the next "air conducting" along to Beethoven's 9th Symphony.

2. The restaurant's **eclectic** decor mixed antiques with modern art.

Skeptical

adjective

/ˈskɛptəkəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Denying or questioning the tenets of especially a religion
2. Marked by or given to doubt

USAGE

1. A **skeptical** approach to the nature of miracles

2. A **skeptical** attitude

Serenity

noun

/sərˈɛnəti/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. A disposition free from stress or emotion
2. The absence of mental stress or anxiety

USAGE

1. The **serenity** of the lake calmed everyone who visited.

2. The **serenity** of the garden made it a perfect place to read.

Disagreeable

adjective

/ˌdɪsəgˈriəbəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Not to your liking
2. Not agreeing with your tastes or expectations
3. Unpleasant to interact with

USAGE

1. A **disagreeable** situation

2. Found the task **disagreeable** and decided to abandon it

Gainsay

verb

/geɪnˈseɪ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Deny or contradict; speak against or oppose

USAGE

1. I can't **gainsay** a single piece of evidence James has presented, but I still don't trust his conclusion.

2. No one could **gainsay** the evidence that the bridge was unsafe.

Kindle

verb

/ˈkɪndəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Call forth (emotions, feelings, and responses)
2. Cause to start burning
3. Catch fire

USAGE

1. The setting sun **kindled** the sky with oranges and reds

2. The dried grass of the prairie **kindled**, spreading the flames for miles

Adulation

noun

/ˌædʒəˈleɪʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Servile flattery; exaggerated and hypocritical praise

USAGE

1. The singer enjoyed the **adulation** of her fans.

2. The actor was overwhelmed by the **adulation** of the crowd.

Generic

noun / adjective

/dʒəˈnɛrɪk/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) Any product that can be sold without a brand name
2. (adjective) Applicable to an entire class or group
3. (adjective) (of drugs) not protected by trademark

USAGE

1. Is there a **generic** Asian mind?

2. `Acetaminophen' is the **generic** form of the proprietary drug `Tylenol'

Intransigent

adj.

/ɪnˈtrænsədʒənt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Unwilling to change one's beliefs or course of action

USAGE

1. Despite many calls for mercy, the judge remained **intransigent**, citing strict legal precedence.

2. The **intransigent** union refused to accept any compromise.

Lavish

verb / adjective

/ˈlævɪʃ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (verb) Expend profusely; also used with abstract nouns
2. (adjective) Very generous
3. (adjective) Characterized by extravagance and profusion

USAGE

1. Distributed gifts with a **lavish** hand

2. The critics were **lavish** in their praise

Oration

noun

/ɔˈreɪʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

An instance of oratory

USAGE

1. He delivered an **oration** on the decline of family values

2. The mayor delivered a moving **oration** at the memorial.

Universal

noun / adjective

/ˌjunəˈvɜrsəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

(noun) (logic) a proposition that asserts something of all members of a class

USAGE

1. In motor vehicles a **universal** joint allows the driveshaft to move up and down as the vehicle passes over bumps

2. Some form of religion seems to be a human **universal**

Adamant

adj.

/ˈædəmənt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Refusing to change one's mind

USAGE

1. Civil rights icon Rosa Parks will forever be remembered for **adamantly** refusing to give up her seat on a public bus, even after the bus driver insisted; she remained rooted in place.

2. Our coach was **adamant** that we practice every morning, rain or shine.

Unique

adjective

/juˈnik/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Highly unusual or rare but not the single instance
2. Radically distinctive and without equal
3. The single one of its kind

USAGE

1. Spoke with a **unique** accent

2. Had **unique** ability in raising funds

Philistine

adj.

/ˈfɪləˌstɪn/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Smug and ignorant towards artistic and cultural values

USAGE

1. Jane considered Al completely **philistine**, because he talked almost exclusive about video games; she was entirely unaware of how well read he really was.

2. The **philistine** critic dismissed every painting he did not understand.

Contempt

noun

/kənˈtɛmpt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. A manner that is generally disrespectful and contemptuous
2. Open disrespect for a person or thing
3. Lack of respect accompanied by a feeling of intense dislike

USAGE

1. He was held in **contempt**

2. She looked at him with **contempt** after the lie was revealed.

Borrow

verb

/ˈbɑˌroʊ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Get temporarily
2. Take up and practice as one's own

USAGE

1. May I **borrow** your lawn mower?

2. May I **borrow** your pen for a minute?

Discredit

noun / verb

/dɪsˈkrɛdət/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) The state of being held in low esteem
2. (verb) Reject as false; refuse to accept
3. (verb) Cause to be distrusted or disbelieved

USAGE

1. Your actions will bring **discredit** to your name

2. The paper **discredited** the politician with its nasty commentary

Imminent

adjective

/ˈɪmənənt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Close in time; about to occur

USAGE

1. In **imminent** danger

2. Rain is **imminent**, so bring an umbrella.

Provincial

adj.

/prəˈvɪnʃəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Characteristic of the a limited perspective; not fashionable or sophisticated

USAGE

1. Maggie's enthusiasm about her high school teams seemed **provincial** to her college classmates, all of whom were following a nationally ranked college team.

2. Her **provincial** attitudes made her wary of big-city ideas.

Submission

noun

/səbˈmɪʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The act of submitting; usually surrendering power to another
2. An agreement between parties in a dispute to abide by the decision of an arbiter

USAGE

1. Several of his **submissions** were rejected by publishers

2. What was the date of **submission** of your proposal?

Hoard

noun / verb

/hɔrd/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) A secret store of valuables or money
2. (verb) Get or gather together
3. (verb) Save up as for future use

USAGE

1. Squirrels **hoard** nuts for the winter.

2. He began to **hoard** food during the crisis.

Transitory

adj.

/ˈtrænsɪˌtɔri/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Lasting a very short time

USAGE

1. If we lived forever and life was not **transitory**, do you think we would appreciate life less or more?

2. **Transitory** fame faded almost as quickly as it arrived.

Breach

noun / verb

/britʃ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) A failure to perform some promised act or obligation
2. (noun) A personal or social separation (as between opposing factions)
3. (noun) An opening (especially a gap in a dike or fortification)

USAGE

1. The company was accused of a **breach** of contract.

2. The **breach** in the wall let the water flood the basement.

Temper

noun / verb

/ˈtɛmpər/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) A disposition to exhibit uncontrolled anger
2. (noun) A sudden outburst of anger
3. (noun) A characteristic (habitual or relatively temporary) state of feeling

USAGE

1. His **temper** was well known to all his employees

2. His **temper** sparked like damp firewood

Gullible

adjective

/ˈgʌləbəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Easily tricked because of being too trusting
2. Naive and easily deceived or tricked

USAGE

1. **Gullible** tourists taken in by the shell game

2. At that early age she had been **gullible** and in love

Confrontation

noun

/ˌkɑnfrənˈteɪʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. A focussed comparison; bringing together for a careful comparison
2. The act of hostile groups opposing each other
3. A hostile disagreement face-to-face

USAGE

1. The government was not ready for a **confrontation** with the unions

2. The meeting ended in a tense **confrontation** between the two managers.

Fragment

noun / verb

/ˈfrægmənt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) A broken piece of a brittle artifact
2. (noun) An incomplete piece
3. (noun) A piece broken off or cut off of something else

USAGE

1. **Fragments** of a play

2. A **fragment** of rock

Symmetrical

adjective

/səˈmɛtrɪkəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Having similarity in size, shape, and relative position of corresponding parts

USAGE

1. The garden has **symmetrical** beds on each side of the path.

2. Her **symmetrical** features made her face memorable.

Scruple

noun / verb

/ˈskrupəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) An ethical or moral principle that inhibits action
2. (noun) Uneasiness about the fitness of an action
3. (noun) A unit of apothecary weight equal to 20 grains

USAGE

1. He lied and did not even **scruple** about it

2. The man **scrupled** to perjure himself

Complement

noun / verb

/ˈkɑmpləmənt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) Something added to complete or embellish or make perfect
2. (noun) Either of two parts that mutually complete each other
3. (noun) A word or phrase used to complete a grammatical construction

USAGE

1. A fine wine is a perfect **complement** to the dinner

2. A full **complement** of workers

Persevere

verb

/pərsəˈvɪr/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Be persistent, refuse to stop

USAGE

1. Despite many failures, she **persevered** until she succeeded.

2. Students who **persevere** often achieve their goals.

Emphasis

noun

/ˈɛmfəsəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Intensity or forcefulness of expression
2. Special and significant stress by means of position or repetition e.g.
3. Special importance or significance

USAGE

1. His **emphasis** on civil rights

2. The red light gave the central figure increased **emphasis**

Appreciate

verb

/əpˈriʃiˌeɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Increase the value of
2. Gain in value
3. Be fully aware of; realize fully

USAGE

1. The Germans want to **appreciate** the Deutsche Mark

2. The yen **appreciated** again!

Feign

verb

/feɪn/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Make believe with the intent to deceive
2. Make a pretence of

USAGE

1. He **feigned** that he was ill

2. He **feigned** sleep

Brevity

noun

/ˈbrɛvəti/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The attribute of being brief or fleeting
2. The use of brief expressions

USAGE

1. The **brevity** of the speech pleased the audience.

2. The **brevity** of his reply surprised everyone who expected a long speech.

Forebode

verb

/fɔrˈboʊd/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Make a prediction about; tell in advance

USAGE

1. The dark clouds **forebode** a storm.

2. The silence seemed to **forebode** bad news.

Circumspect

adjective

/ˈsɜrkəmˌspɛkt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Heedful of potential consequences

USAGE

1. **Circumspect** actions

2. Physicians are now more **circumspect** about recommending its use

Bane

noun

/beɪn/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Something causing misery or death

USAGE

1. The **bane** of my life

2. Noise is the **bane** of my existence.

Profitable

adjective

/ˈprɑfətəbəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Yielding material gain or profit

USAGE

1. **Profitable** speculation on the stock market

2. The new product proved very **profitable** for the company.

Deter

verb

/dɪˈtɜr/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Turn away from by persuasion
2. Try to prevent; show opposition to

USAGE

1. His mother tried to **deter** him from joing the army, but he was too intoxicated with the idea of war to listen.

2. The government's primary job should invlove **deterring** paths to war, not finding ways to start them.

Notorious

adjective

/noʊˈtɔriəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Known widely and usually unfavorably

USAGE

1. A **notorious** gangster

2. The tenderloin district was **notorious** for vice

Prescient

adjective

/ˈprɛsiənt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Perceiving the significance of events before they occur

USAGE

1. Extraordinarily **prescient** memoranda on the probable course of postwar relations

2. Her **prescient** warning about the market was correct.

Heterodox

adjective

/ˈhɛtərəˌdɑks/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Characterized by departure from accepted beliefs or standards

USAGE

1. His **heterodox** views shocked the traditional scholars.

2. The **heterodox** theory challenged the old beliefs.

Originality

noun

/ərˌɪdʒəˈnælɪti/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The quality of being new and original (not derived from something else)
2. The ability to think and act independently

USAGE

1. The **originality** of her design won first prize.

2. Her poems show great **originality**.

Nomadic

adjective

/noʊˈmædɪk/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Migratory

USAGE

1. The **nomadic** habits of the Bedouins

2. The **nomadic** tribe moved with the herds every season.

Accessible

adjective

/ækˈsɛsəbəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Capable of being reached
2. Easy to get along with or talk to; friendly
3. Easily obtained

USAGE

1. A town **accessible** by rail

2. An **accessible** and genial man

Doctrinaire

noun / adjective

/ˌdɑktrəˈnɛr/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

(noun) A stubborn person of arbitrary or arrogant opinions

USAGE

1. The **doctrinaire** manager refused to consider any new ideas.

2. The **doctrinaire** politician would not compromise.

Affluent

adj.

/ˈæfluənt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Wealthy

USAGE

1. The center of the city had sadly become a pit of penury, while, only five miles away, multi-million dollar homes spoke of **affluence**.

2. The **affluent** neighborhood has wide streets and large gardens.

Affection

noun

/əˈfɛkʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

A positive feeling of liking

USAGE

1. He had trouble expressing the **affection** he felt

2. She felt great **affection** for her old teacher.

Compassion

noun

/kəmˈpæʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

A deep awareness of and sympathy for another's suffering

USAGE

1. The nurse treated every patient with **compassion**.

2. **Compassion** for the poor drove her work.

Seethe

verb

/sið/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Boil vigorously
2. Foam as if boiling
3. Be in an agitated emotional state

USAGE

1. He **seethed** with anger after the unfair decision.

2. The crowd **seethed** as the verdict was read.

Amateur

noun / adjective

/ˈæməˌtər/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) Someone who pursues a study or sport as a pastime
2. (noun) An athlete who does not play for pay
3. (adjective) Engaged in as a pastime

USAGE

1. An **amateur** painter

2. Gained valuable experience in **amateur** theatricals

Aver

verb

/ˈeɪvər/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. To declare or affirm solemnly and formally as true
2. Report or maintain

USAGE

1. The witness **averred** that she had seen the car leave.

2. He **averred** his innocence to the court.

Marginal

adjective

/ˈmɑrdʒənəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. At or constituting a border or edge
2. Of questionable or minimal quality
3. Producing at a rate that barely covers production costs

USAGE

1. The **marginal** strip of beach

2. **Marginal** writing ability

Inane

adjective

/ˌɪˈneɪn/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Devoid of intelligence

USAGE

1. The **inane** conversation bored everyone at the table.

2. The **inane** comments did not help the discussion.

Beneficiary

noun / adjective

/ˌbɛnəˈfɪʃiˌɛri/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) The recipient of funds or other benefits
2. (adjective) Having or arising from a benefice

USAGE

1. A **beneficiary** baron

2. The student was the **beneficiary** of a generous scholarship.

Prodigality

noun

/ˈprɑdɪˌgæləti/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Excessive spending
2. The trait of spending extravagantly

USAGE

1. His **prodigality** soon left him with no money at all.

2. The **prodigality** of the king emptied the treasury.

Decorative

adjective

/ˈdɛkrətɪv/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Serving an esthetic rather than a useful purpose

USAGE

1. The buildings were utilitarian rather than **decorative**

2. The **decorative** tiles added color to the hallway.

Flagrant

adjective

/ˈfleɪgrənt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Conspicuously and outrageously bad or reprehensible

USAGE

1. **Flagrant** violation of human rights

2. The judge was angry at the **flagrant** disregard of the rules.

Humility

noun

/hjuˈmɪlɪti/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. A disposition to be humble; a lack of false pride
2. A humble feeling

USAGE

1. Not everyone regards **humility** as a virtue

2. He was filled with **humility** at the sight of the Pope

Insipid

adj.

/ɪnˈsɪpɪd/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Dull and uninteresting

USAGE

1. The movie director was known for hiring beautiful actors in order to deflect attention away from the **insipid** scripts he would typically use.

2. The **insipid** soup needed salt and pepper.

Hypothesis

noun

/haɪˈpɑθəsəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. A message expressing an opinion based on incomplete evidence
2. A proposal intended to explain certain facts or observations

USAGE

1. A scientific **hypothesis** that survives experimental testing becomes a scientific theory

2. The scientist tested her **hypothesis** with a series of experiments.

Vital

adjective

/ˈvaɪtəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Manifesting or characteristic of life
2. Full of spirit
3. Performing an essential function in the living body

USAGE

1. A **vital**, living organism

2. **Vital** signs

Modesty

noun

/ˈmɑdəsti/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Formality and propriety of manner
2. Freedom from vanity or conceit

USAGE

1. Her **modesty** made her reluctant to accept praise.

2. Her **modesty** stopped her from talking about her achievements.

Tractable

adj.

/ˈtræktəbəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Readily reacting to suggestions and influences; easily managed (controlled or taught or molded)

USAGE

1. Compared to middle school students, who have an untamed wildness about them, high school students are somewhat more **tractable**.

2. A **tractable** student, she adapted quickly to new methods.

Frustration

noun

/frəsˈtreɪʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. An act of hindering someone's plans or efforts
2. A feeling of annoyance at being hindered or criticized

USAGE

1. Her constant complaints were the main source of his **frustration**

2. Her **frustration** grew each time the printer jammed.

Novice

noun

/ˈnɑvəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Someone new to a field or activity
2. Someone who has entered a religious order but has not taken final vows

USAGE

1. The **novice** cook burned the first batch of cookies.

2. A **novice** needs practice before becoming an expert.

Conserve

noun / verb

/kənˈsɜrv/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) Fruit preserved by cooking with sugar
2. (verb) Preserve with sugar
3. (verb) Use cautiously and frugally

USAGE

1. Mom always **conserved** the strawberries we grew in the backyard

2. **Conserve** your energy for the ascent to the summit

Awe

noun / verb

/ɑ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) An overwhelming feeling of wonder or admiration
2. (noun) A feeling of profound respect for someone or something
3. (verb) Inspire awe in

USAGE

1. He stared over the edge with a feeling of **awe**

2. The famous professor **awed** the undergraduates

Reiterate

verb

/riˈɪtərˌeɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

To say, state, or perform again

USAGE

1. She kept **reiterating** her request

2. The manager **reiterated** the deadline at the end of the meeting.

Initiate

noun / verb

/ˌɪˈnɪʃiˌeɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) Someone who has been admitted to membership in a scholarly field
2. (noun) Someone new to a field or activity
3. (verb) Set in motion, start an event or prepare the way for

USAGE

1. It is very familiar to the **initiate**

2. He **initiated** a new program

Commission

noun / verb

/kəˈmɪʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) A special assignment that is given to a person or group
2. (noun) The act of committing a crime
3. (noun) The act of granting authority to undertake certain functions

USAGE

1. He works on **commission**

2. Put the ships into **commission**

Contrast

noun / verb

/ˈkɑntræst/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) The act of distinguishing by comparing differences
2. (noun) The perceptual effect of the juxtaposition of very different colors
3. (noun) A conceptual separation or distinction

USAGE

1. In **contrast** to

2. By **contrast**

Fidget

noun / verb

/ˈfɪdʒɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) A feeling of agitation expressed in continual motion
2. (verb) Move restlessly

USAGE

1. He's got the **fidgets**

2. The child is always **fidgeting** in his seat

Consternation

noun

/ˌkɑnstərˈneɪʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Fear resulting from the awareness of danger

USAGE

1. The sudden news caused **consternation** among the staff.

2. To her **consternation**, the train was cancelled.

Inimical

adj.

/ɪˈnɪmɪkəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Hostile (usually describes conditions or environments)

USAGE

1. Venus, with a surface temperature that would turn rubber to liquid, is **inimical** to any form of life.

2. Harsh winters are **inimical** to tropical plants.

Vague

adjective

/veɪg/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Not clearly understood or expressed
2. Not precisely limited, determined, or distinguished
3. Lacking clarity or distinctness

USAGE

1. Their descriptions of human behavior become **vague**, dull, and unclear

2. **Vague**…forms of speech…have so long passed for mysteries of science

Prejudice

noun / verb

/ˈprɛdʒədɪs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (verb) Influence (somebody's) opinion in advance
2. (verb) Disadvantage by prejudice

USAGE

1. **Prejudice** against newcomers made the village unwelcoming.

2. The judge tried to avoid any **prejudice** in the trial.

Discourse

noun / verb

/ˈdɪskɔrs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) Extended verbal expression in speech or writing
2. (verb) Talk at length and formally about a topic

USAGE

1. The scholars engaged in a lively **discourse** about history.

2. The professor's **discourse** on ethics was thought-provoking.

Execute

verb

/ˈɛksəkˌjut/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Sign in the presence of witnesses
2. Put in effect
3. Carry out or perform an action

USAGE

1. The President **executed** the treaty

2. **Execute** the decision of the people

Prosperous

adjective

/ˈprɑspərəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Presaging or likely to bring good luck
2. Marked by peace and prosperity
3. In fortunate circumstances financially; moderately rich

USAGE

1. A **prosperous** moment to make a decision

2. A **prosperous** family

Modest

adjective

/ˈmɑdəst/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Limited in size or scope
2. Not large but sufficient in size or amount
3. Not offensive to sexual mores in conduct or appearance

USAGE

1. A newspaper with a **modest** circulation

2. A **modest** salary

Disabuse

verb

/ˌdɪsəˈbjuz/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

To persuade somebody that his/her belief is not valid

USAGE

1. As a child, I was quickly **disabused** of the notion that Santa Claus was a rotund benefactor of infinite largess--one night I saw my mother diligently wrapping presents and storing them under our Christmas tree.

2. The evidence **disabused** him of his belief in the plan.

Diatribe

noun

/ˈdaɪəˌtraɪb/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

A strong verbal attack against a person or institution

USAGE

1. Steve's mom launched into a **diatribe** during the PTA meeting, contending that the school was little more than a daycare in which students stare at the wall and teachers stare at the chalkboard.

2. The senator delivered a **diatribe** against the new bill.

Exploit

noun / verb

/ˈɛksˌplɔɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) A notable achievement
2. (verb) Use or manipulate to one's advantage
3. (verb) Draw from; make good use of

USAGE

1. He **exploit** the new taxation system

2. We must **exploit** the resources we are given wisely

Bias

noun / verb / adjective

/ˈbaɪəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (verb) Cause to be biased
2. (verb) Influence in an unfair way

USAGE

1. You are **biasing** my choice by telling me yours

2. A **bias** fold

Qualm

noun

/kwɑm/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Uneasiness about the fitness of an action

USAGE

1. While he could articulate no clear reason why Harkner's plan would fail, he neverless felt **qualms** about committing any resources to it.

2. He had no **qualms** about lying to protect the secret.

Garrulous

adj.

/ˈgærələs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Full of trivial conversation

USAGE

1. Lynne was **garrulous**: once, she had a fifteen minute conversation with a stranger before she realized the woman didn't speak English.

2. The **garrulous** taxi driver talked nonstop about his grandchildren.

Incident

noun / adjective

/ˈɪnsədənt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) A single distinct event
2. (noun) A public disturbance
3. (adjective) Falling or striking of light rays on something

USAGE

1. The police investigated an **incident** at the bus station

2. **Incidental** expenses

Realistic

adjective

/ˌriəˈlɪstɪk/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Aware or expressing awareness of things as they really are
2. Representing what is real; not abstract or ideal
3. Of or relating to the philosophical doctrine of realism

USAGE

1. A **realistic** description

2. A **realistic** view of the possibilities

Ostentatious

adj.

/ˌɑstənˈteɪʃəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Intended to attract notice and impress others; tawdry or vulgar

USAGE

1. Matt wanted to buy stone lions for front of the house, but Cynthia convinced him that such a display would be too **ostentatious** for a modest house in an unassuming neighborhood.

2. His **ostentatious** gold watch was meant to impress everyone in the room.

Eulogy

noun

/ˈjuləʤi/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. A formal expression of praise
2. A formal expression of praise for someone who has died recently

USAGE

1. Her brother gave a moving **eulogy** at the funeral.

2. The **eulogy** praised the teacher's kindness.

Tedious

adjective

/ˈtidiəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Using or containing too many words
2. So lacking in interest as to cause mental weariness

USAGE

1. **Tedious** days on the train

2. Filing papers all day is a **tedious** job.

Distraught

adjective

/dɪsˈtrɔt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Deeply agitated especially from emotion

USAGE

1. **Distraught** with grief

2. The **distraught** mother searched for her missing son.

Artistry

noun

/ˈɑrtɪstri/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

A superior skill that you can learn by study and practice and observation

USAGE

1. The dancers showed great **artistry** in every movement.

2. Her **artistry** is clear in every portrait.

Imply

verb

/ˌɪmˈplaɪ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Express or state indirectly
2. Suggest as a logically necessary consequence; in logic
3. Have as a logical consequence

USAGE

1. Her silence seemed to **imply** that she disagreed.

2. Her tone seemed to **imply** that she did not trust him.

Dilemma

noun

/dɪˈlɛmə/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

State of uncertainty or perplexity especially as requiring a choice between equally unfavorable options

USAGE

1. She faced a **dilemma**: take the job or stay with her family.

2. The team was in a **dilemma** about the new contract.

Temperance

noun

/ˈtɛmpərəns/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

The trait of avoiding excesses

USAGE

1. Welles wasn't known for his **temperance--he** usually ate enough for two and drank enough for three.

2. **Temperance** in diet and exercise leads to better long-term health.

Boundary

noun

/ˈbaʊndəri/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The greatest possible degree of something
2. The line or plane indicating the limit or extent of something
3. A line determining the limits of an area

USAGE

1. What he did was beyond the **bounds** of acceptable behavior

2. The river forms the **boundary** between the two countries.

Judicious

adjective

/dʒuˈdɪʃəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Marked by the exercise of good judgment or common sense in practical matters

USAGE

1. **Judicious** use of one's money

2. The **judicious** use of funds kept the charity running for years.

Generosity

noun

/ˌdʒɛnərˈɑsəti/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Acting generously
2. The trait of being willing to give your money or time

USAGE

1. The family's **generosity** helped many people in need.

2. Her **generosity** was legendary in the town.

Censure

verb

/ˈsɛnʃər/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

To express strong disapproval

USAGE

1. After being caught in bed with a mistress, the mayor was quickly **censured** by the city council.

2. The board voted to **censure** the director for misusing funds.

Fallible

adjective

/ˈfæləbəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Likely to fail or make errors

USAGE

1. Everyone is **fallible** to some degree

2. I'm only a **fallible** human

Inflexible

adjective

/ˌɪnˈflɛksəbəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Resistant to being bent
2. Incapable of change
3. Not making concessions

USAGE

1. An **inflexible** iron bar

2. An **inflexible** knife blade

Tarnish

verb

/ˈtɑrnɪʃ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Make dirty or spotty, as by exposure to air; also used metaphorically

USAGE

1. Pete Rose was one of the best baseball players of his generation, but his involvement with gambling on baseball games has **tarnished** his image in the eyes of many.

2. Years of neglect **tarnished** the silver candlesticks.

Aspiration

noun

/ˌæspərˈeɪʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The act of inhaling; the drawing in of air (or other gases) as in breathing
2. A will to succeed
3. A manner of articulation involving an audible release of breath

USAGE

1. Her **aspiration** was to become a famous author.

2. His **aspiration** was to become a pilot one day.

Yield

noun / verb

/jild/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) Production of a certain amount
2. (noun) An amount of a product

USAGE

1. The door **yielded** to repeated blows with a battering ram

2. This year's crop **yielded** 1,000 bushels of corn

Sensible

adjective

/ˈsɛnsəbəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Aware intuitively or intellectually of something sensed
2. Readily perceived by the senses
3. Showing reason or sound judgment

USAGE

1. Made **sensible** of his mistakes

2. I am **sensible** that the mention of such a circumstance may appear trifling

Functional

adjective

/ˈfʌŋkʃənəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Designed for or capable of a particular function or use
2. (of e.g. a machine) Performing or capable of performing
3. Involving or affecting function rather than physiology

USAGE

1. A style of writing in which every word is **functional**

2. **Functional** architecture

Illiterate

noun / adjective

/ˌɪˈlɪtərət/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) A person unable to read
2. (adjective) Lacking culture, especially in language and literature
3. (adjective) Not able to read or write

USAGE

1. He is musically **illiterate**

2. The **illiterate** farmer could not read the letter.

Reservoir

noun

/ˈrɛzəvˌwɑr/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Tank used for collecting and storing a liquid (as water or oil)
2. Lake used to store water for community use
3. A large or extra supply of something

USAGE

1. An infectious agent depends on a **reservoir** for its survival

2. A **reservoir** of talent

Digression

noun

/daɪgˈrɛʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Wandering from the main path of a journey
2. A turning aside (of your course or attention or concern)
3. A message that departs from the main subject

USAGE

1. A **digression** into irrelevant details

2. The speaker's **digression** about his childhood lasted ten minutes.

Vexation

noun

/vɛkˈseɪʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The act of troubling or annoying someone
2. Something or someone that causes anxiety; a source of unhappiness
3. Anger produced by some annoying irritation

USAGE

1. To her **vexation**, the car would not start.

2. To her **vexation**, the printer broke again just before the deadline.

Frugal

adj.

/ˈfruːgəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Not spending much money (but spending wisely)

USAGE

1. Monte was no miser, but was simply **frugal**, wisely spending the little that he earned.

2. Her **frugal** habits let her save for a house in five years.

Enterprise

noun

/ˈɛntərpˌraɪz/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Readiness to embark on bold new ventures
2. An organization created for business ventures

USAGE

1. He had doubts about the whole **enterprise**

2. A growing **enterprise** must have a bold leader

Intact

adjective

/ˌɪnˈtækt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Undamaged in any way
2. (of a woman) Having the hymen unbroken
3. (used of domestic animals) Sexually competent

USAGE

1. Fought to keep the union **intact**

2. The vase remained **intact** despit rough handling

Assert

verb

/əˈsɜrt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Assert to be true
2. To declare or affirm solemnly and formally as true
3. State categorically

USAGE

1. The letter **asserts** a free society

2. Women should **assert** themselves more!

Assuage

verb

/əˈsweɪdʒ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Make something intense less severe

USAGE

1. Her fear that the new college would be filled with unknown faces was **assuaged** when she recognized her childhood friend standing in line.

2. Cold water helped **assuage** the burn of the spicy curry.

Dispassionate

adj.

/dɪˈspæʃənət/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Unaffected by strong emotion or prejudice

USAGE

1. A good scientist should be **dispassionate**, focusing purely on what the evidence says, without personal attachment.

2. The doctor gave a **dispassionate** account of the risks.

Prosaic

adj.

/proʊˈzeɪɪk/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Dull and lacking imagination

USAGE

1. Unlike the talented artists in his workshop, Paul had no such bent for the visual medium, so when it was time for him to make a stained glass painting, he ended up with a **prosaic** mosaic.

2. His **prosaic** description of the sunset lacked any poetry.

Dismiss

verb

/dɪsˈmɪs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Declare void
2. Bar from attention or consideration
3. Cease to consider; put out of judicial consideration

USAGE

1. She **dismissed** his advances

2. This case is **dismissed**!

Laud

verb

/lɔd/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Praise, glorify, or honor

USAGE

1. The critics **lauded** the new novel as a masterpiece.

2. The teacher **lauded** the students' hard work.

Admonish

verb

/ədˈmɑnɪʃ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

To warn strongly, even to the point of reprimanding

USAGE

1. Before the concert began, security personnel **admonished** the crowd not to come up on stage during the performance.

2. The teacher **admonished** the class for talking during the test.

Monotonous

adjective

/məˈnɑtənəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Tediously repetitious or lacking in variety
2. Sounded or spoken in a tone unvarying in pitch

USAGE

1. Nothing is so **monotonous** as the sea

2. The owl's faint **monotonous** hooting

Day 05- 200 Words: Outmoded through Retreat

Cards 801 to 1000

Outmoded

adjective

/ˌaʊtˈmoʊdɪd/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Out of fashion

USAGE

1. Demode (or **outmoded**) attire

2. **Outmoded** ideas

Wares

noun

/wɛrz/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Goods or products offered for sale
2. A person's skills or talents, shown to others (informal)

USAGE

1. The street vendor displayed his **wares** on a wooden table.

2. The shop had a wide selection of pottery **wares**.

Debilitate

verb

/dəˈbɪləˌteɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Make weak

USAGE

1. The long illness **debilitated** him for months.

2. Heat can **debilitate** even fit athletes.

Therapeutic

noun / adjective

/ˌθɛrəpˈjutɪk/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) A medicine or therapy that cures disease or relieve pain
2. (adjective) Tending to cure or restore to health
3. (adjective) Relating to or involved in therapy

USAGE

1. A **therapeutic** agent

2. **Therapeutic** diets

Repugnance

noun

/rɪˈpʌgnəns/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Intense aversion
2. The relation between propositions that cannot both be true at the same time

USAGE

1. She felt **repugnance** at the thought of eating insects.

2. He felt **repugnance** at the cruel treatment of the animals.

Irascible

adj.

/ɪˈræsəbəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Quickly aroused to anger

USAGE

1. If Arthur's dog is not fed adequately, he becames highly **irascible**, even growling at his own shadow.

2. The **irascible** old man yelled at the children to stay off his lawn.

Forge

noun / verb

/fɔrdʒ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) A workplace where metal is worked by heating and hammering
2. (verb) Make a copy of with the intent to deceive

USAGE

1. She **forged** a Green Card

2. **Forge** a pair of tongues

Swarthy

adjective

/ˈswɔrði/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Naturally having skin of a dark color

USAGE

1. A smile on his **swarthy** face

2. `**swart'** is archaic

Profound

adjective

/proʊˈfaʊnd/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (of sleep) Deep and complete
2. Coming from deep within one
3. Of the greatest intensity; complete

USAGE

1. The **profound** depths of the sea

2. Fell into a **profound** sleep

Partial

noun / adjective

/ˈpɑrʃəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (adjective) Being or affecting only a part; not total
2. (adjective) Showing favoritism

USAGE

1. A **partial** description of the suspect

2. **Partial** collapse

Intolerant

adjective

/ˌɪnˈtɑlərənt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Narrow-minded about cherished opinions
2. Unwilling to tolerate difference of opinion

USAGE

1. The **intolerant** ruler punished anyone who disagreed with him.

2. Some groups were **intolerant** of other faiths.

Inclined

adjective

/ˌɪnˈklaɪnd/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

At an angle to the horizontal or vertical position

USAGE

1. An **inclined** plane

2. He is **inclined** to sleep late on weekends.

Allocate

verb

/ˈælə˧keɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Distribute according to a plan or set apart for a special purpose

USAGE

1. I am **allocating** a loaf of bread to everyone on a daily basis

2. I'm **allocating** the rations for the camping trip

Mediocre

adjective

/ˌmidiˈoʊkər/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Poor to middling in quality
2. Lacking exceptional quality or ability
3. Moderate to inferior in quality

USAGE

1. There have been good and **mediocre** and bad artists

2. The caliber of the students has gone from **mediocre** to above average

Covet

verb

/ˈkʌvət/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Wish, long, or crave for (something, especially the property of another person)

USAGE

1. She **covets** her sister's house

2. He **coveted** his neighbor's new car.

Affirm

verb

/əˈfɜrm/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Establish or strengthen as with new evidence or facts
2. To declare or affirm solemnly and formally as true
3. Say yes to

USAGE

1. The court **affirmed** the lower court's decision.

2. She **affirmed** her support for the plan.

Tepid

adjective

/ˈtɛpɪd/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Feeling or showing little interest or enthusiasm
2. Moderately warm

USAGE

1. **Tepid** bath water

2. The **tepid** soup did little to warm us up.

Culminate

verb

/ˈkʌlməneɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Reach the highest or most decisive point

USAGE

1. Beethoven's musical genius **culminated** in the 9th Symphony, which many consider his greatest work.

2. Years of research **culminated** in a groundbreaking discovery.

Abundance

noun

/əˈbʌndəns/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

The property of a more than adequate quantity or supply

USAGE

1. An age of **abundance**

2. The garden produced an **abundance** of tomatoes this year.

Subdue

verb

/səbˈdu/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Correct by punishment or discipline
2. To put down by force or authority
3. Make subordinate, dependent, or subservient

USAGE

1. **Subdue** one's appetites

2. The police **subdued** the angry crowd with tear gas.

Alienate

verb

/ˈeɪljəˌneɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Make withdrawn or isolated or emotionally dissociated
2. Transfer property or ownership

USAGE

1. She **alienated** her friends when she became fanatically religious

2. The boring work **alienated** his employees

Conspire

verb

/kənˈspaɪər/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Engage in plotting or enter into a conspiracy, swear together
2. Act in unison or agreement and in secret towards a deceitful or illegal purpose

USAGE

1. They **conspired** to overthrow the government

2. The two companies **conspired** to cause the value of the stock to fall

Perfunctory

adj.

/pərˈfʌŋktəri/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Done routinely and with little interest or care

USAGE

1. The short film examines modern **perfunctory** cleaning rituals such as washing dishes, doing laundry and tooth-brushing.

2. The guard gave our tickets a **perfunctory** glance.

Renege

verb

/rɪˈnɛg/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Fail to fulfill a promise or obligation

USAGE

1. We will no longer work with that vendor since it has **reneged** on nearly every agreement.

2. The buyer **reneged** on the deal at the last minute.

Elaborate

adj. / verb

/ɪˈlæbərət/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (adj.) Marked by complexity and richness of detail
2. (verb) Explain in more detail

USAGE

1. Thomas, on returning from Morocco, replaced his dirty gray carpet with an **elaborate** one he'd brought back with him.

2. Most high school physics teachers find themselves **elaborating** the same point over and over again, since many concepts confuse students.

Refute

verb

/rɪˈfjut/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Prove to be false or incorrect

USAGE

1. No one could **refute** his theories or propositions, and that is why he was esteemed by all his colleagues in the philosophy department.

2. The lab results **refute** the claim that the drug causes side effects.

Spurn

verb

/spɜrn/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Reject with contempt

USAGE

1. She **spurned** all his flattery and proposals, and so he walked off embarrassed and sad.

2. She **spurned** his offer of a ride home.

Aloof

adjective / adverb

/əˈluf/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (adjective) Remote in manner
2. (adverb) In an aloof manner

USAGE

1. Stood apart with **aloof** dignity

2. The local gentry and professional classes had held **aloof** for the school had accepted their sons readily enough

Solitary

noun / adjective

/ˈsɑləˌtɛri/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) One who lives in solitude
2. (noun) Confinement of a prisoner in isolation from other prisoners
3. (adjective) Devoid of creatures

USAGE

1. He was held in **solitary**

2. A **solitary** retreat

Tranquil

adjective

/ˈtræŋkwəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (of a body of water) Free from disturbance by heavy waves
2. Not agitated; without losing self-possession

USAGE

1. A lake of **tranquil** blue water reflecting a tranquil blue sky

2. She became more **tranquil**

Audition

noun / verb

/ɑˈdɪʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) A test of the suitability of a performer
2. (noun) The ability to hear; the auditory faculty
3. (verb) Perform in order to get a role

USAGE

1. She **auditioned** for a role on Broadway

2. She will **audition** for the lead role next week.

Custody

noun

/ˈkʌstədi/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Holding by the police
2. A state of being confined (usually for a short time)

USAGE

1. Your guests are now in my **custody**

2. The mother was awarded **custody** of the children

Suspend

verb

/səsˈpɛnd/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Cause to be held in suspension in a fluid
2. Stop a process or a habit by imposing a freeze on it
3. Make inoperative or stop

USAGE

1. **Suspend** the particles

2. **Suspend** the aid to the war-torn country

Whimsical

adj.

/ˈwɪmzɪkəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Determined by impulse or whim rather than by necessity or reason

USAGE

1. Adults look to kids and envy their **whimsical** nature at times, wishing that they could act without reason and play without limitation.

2. The **whimsical** design included a clock shaped like a fish.

Abeyance

noun

/əˈbeɪəns/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Temporary cessation or suspension

USAGE

1. The project was held in **abeyance** until funding arrived.

2. The court's decision was held in **abeyance** until the new evidence arrived.

Circumlocution

noun

/ˌsɜrkəmloʊˈkjuʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. An indirect way of expressing something
2. A style that involves indirect ways of expressing things

USAGE

1. His **circumlocution** made the simple answer hard to find.

2. The speech was full of **circumlocution**.

Device

noun

/dɪˈvaɪs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Any clever maneuver
2. An instrumentality invented for a particular purpose
3. An emblematic design (especially in heraldry)

USAGE

1. He would stoop to any **device** to win a point

2. The **device** is small enough to wear on your wrist

Verbose

adjective

/vɜrˈboʊs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Using or containing too many words

USAGE

1. **Verbose** and ineffective instructional methods

2. The **verbose** lawyer used three paragraphs to say one thing.

Dense

adjective

/dɛns/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Slow to learn or understand; lacking intellectual acuity
2. Having high relative density or specific gravity
3. Hard to pass through because of dense growth

USAGE

1. So **dense** he never understands anything I say to him

2. **Dense** as lead

Insidious

adj.

/ɪnˈsɪdiəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Working in a subtle but destructive way

USAGE

1. Plaque is **insidious**: we cannot see it, but each day it eats away at our enamel, causing cavities and other dental problems.

2. The **insidious** rumor spread through the office, eroding trust.

Impetuous

adj.

/ɪmˈpɛtʃuəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Characterized by undue haste and lack of thought or deliberation

USAGE

1. Herbert is rarely **impetuous**, but on the spur of the moment, he spent thousands of dollars on a motorcycle today.

2. His **impetuous** decision to quit his job surprised everyone.

Lewd

adjective

/lud/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Suggestive of or tending to moral looseness
2. Driven by lust; preoccupied with or exhibiting lustful desires

USAGE

1. **Lewd** whisperings of a dirty old man

2. The **lewd** jokes made the guests uncomfortable.

Banal

adj.

/bəˈnæl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Repeated too often; overfamiliar through overuse

USAGE

1. The professor used such **banal** expressions that many students either fell asleep from boredom or stayed awake to complete his sentences and amuse friends.

2. Their conversation was **banal**, covering only the weather and traffic.

Acute

noun / adjective

/əkˈjut/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) A mark (') placed above a vowel to indicate pronunciation
2. (adjective) Having or experiencing a rapid onset and short but severe course
3. (adjective) Of critical importance and consequence

USAGE

1. **Acute** appendicitis

2. The **acute** phase of the illness

Boisterous

adjective

/ˈbɔɪstərəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Violently agitated and turbulent
2. Noisy and lacking in restraint or discipline
3. Full of rough and exuberant animal spirits

USAGE

1. **Boisterous** winds and waves

2. A **boisterous** crowd

Candid

adj.

/ˈkændɪd/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

A straightforward and honest look at something

USAGE

1. Even with a perfect stranger, Charles was always **candid** and would rarely hold anything back.

2. The **candid** interview revealed the director's doubts about the film.

Confine

verb

/kənˈfaɪn/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Place limits on (extent or access)
2. Restrict or confine,
3. To close within bounds, limit or hold back from movement

USAGE

1. Heavy rain **confined** us to the house all afternoon.

2. The patient was **confined** to bed for two weeks.

Solely

adverb

/ˈsoʊəli/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Without any others being included or involved

USAGE

1. Did it **solely** for money

2. The fire was caused **solely** by careless smoking.

Fickle

adj.

/ˈfɪkəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Liable to sudden unpredictable change, esp. in affections or attachments

USAGE

1. She was so **fickle** in her politics, it was hard to pinpoint her beliefs; one week she would embrace a side, and the next week she would denounce it.

2. **Fickle** fans abandoned the team after one bad season.

Discipline

noun / verb

/ˈdɪsəplən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) Training to improve strength or self-control
2. (noun) The act of punishing
3. (noun) The trait of being well behaved

USAGE

1. The offenders deserved the harsh **discipline** they received

2. He insisted on **discipline** among the troops

Pique

noun / verb

/pik/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) Tightly woven fabric with raised cords
2. (noun) A sudden outburst of anger
3. (verb) Cause to feel resentment or indignation

USAGE

1. Her remark **piqued** my curiosity.

2. His rude reply **piqued** her anger.

Cite

noun / verb

/saɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) A short note recognizing a source of information or of a quoted passage
2. (verb) Call in an official matter, such as to attend court
3. (verb) Advance evidence for

USAGE

1. He was **cited** for his outstanding achievements

2. Please **cite** your sources at the end of the essay.

Deduce

verb

/dɪˈdus/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Reason by deduction; establish by deduction
2. Conclude by reasoning; in logic

USAGE

1. From the footprints, the detective **deduced** that two people had passed.

2. From the muddy boots, she **deduced** that he had walked through the field.

Portable

noun / adjective

/ˈpɔrtəbəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) A small light typewriter; usually with a case in which it can be carried
2. (adjective) Of a motor designed to be attached to the outside of a boat's hull
3. (adjective) Easily or conveniently transported

USAGE

1. A **portable** outboard motor

2. A **portable** television set

Validation

noun

/ˌvælə'deɪʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The act of validating; finding or testing the truth of something
2. The cognitive process of establishing a valid proof

USAGE

1. The **validation** of the test results took several weeks.

2. The **validation** of the software took several days of testing.

Constrict

verb

/kənsˈtrɪkt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Become tight or as if tight
2. Squeeze or press together

USAGE

1. Her throat **constricted**

2. Tight bandages can **constrict** the blood flow to the hand.

Misreading

noun

/mɪsˈridɪŋ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Misinterpretation caused by inaccurate reading

USAGE

1. The **misreading** of the map sent us the wrong way.

2. A **misreading** of the instructions led to the error.

Timid

noun / adjective

/ˈtɪmɪd/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) People who are fearful and cautious
2. (adjective) Showing fear and lack of confidence
3. (adjective) Lacking conviction or boldness or courage

USAGE

1. Whitewater rafting is not for the **timid**

2. Problems that call for bold not **timid** responses

Instruct

verb

/ˌɪnsˈtrʌkt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Give instructions or directions for some task
2. Impart skills or knowledge to
3. Make aware of

USAGE

1. She **instructed** the students to work on their pronunciation

2. He **instructed** me in building a boat

Antiquated

adj.

/ˈæntɪˌkweɪtɪd/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Old-fashioned; belonging to an earlier period in time

USAGE

1. Aunt Betty had **antiquated** notions about marriage, believing that a man should court a woman for at least a year before receiving a kiss.

2. The office still used **antiquated** filing cabinets from the 1960s.

Betray

verb

/bɪˈtreɪ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

To reveal or make known something, usually unintentionally

USAGE

1. With the gold medal at stake, the gymnast awaited his turn, his quivering lip **betraying** his intense emotions.

2. Her shaky voice **betrayed** how nervous she was.

Solemn

adjective

/ˈsɑləm/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Characterized by a firm and humorless belief in the validity of your opinions
2. Dignified and somber in manner or character and committed to keeping promises

USAGE

1. A film with a **solemn** social message

2. A **solemn** promise

Perilous

adjective

/ˈpɛrələs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Fraught with danger

USAGE

1. A **perilous** voyage across the Atlantic in a small boat

2. The climbers faced a **perilous** path across the ice.

Debacle

noun

/dəˈbɑkəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. A sudden and violent collapse
2. A sound defeat

USAGE

1. The launch was a complete **debacle** that cost millions.

2. The party was a **debacle**, with no food and no music.

Indefensible

adjective

/ˌɪndɪˈfɛnsəbəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Incapable of being justified or explained
2. (of theories etc) Incapable of being defended or justified
3. Not able to be protected against attack

USAGE

1. The company's behavior was **indefensible**.

2. His rude remarks were **indefensible**.

Categorical

adjective

/ˌkætəˈgɑrɪkəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Not modified or restricted by reservations
2. Relating to or included in a category or categories

USAGE

1. A **categorical** denial

2. She gave a **categorical** denial of the rumor.

Conviction

noun

/kənˈvɪkʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

An unshakable belief in something without need for proof or evidence

USAGE

1. The **conviction** came as no surprise

2. He spoke with a **conviction** that surprised the audience.

Luxurious

adjective

/ləgˈʒɜriəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Displaying luxury and furnishing gratification to the senses
2. Rich and superior in quality

USAGE

1. Enjoyed a **luxurious** suite with a crystal chandelier and thick oriental rugs

2. They stayed in a **luxurious** hotel by the sea.

Cosmic

adjective

/ˈkazmɪk/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Inconceivably extended in space or time
2. Of or from or pertaining to or characteristic of the cosmos or universe

USAGE

1. **Cosmic** laws

2. **Cosmic** catastrophe

Conform

verb

/kənˈfɔrm/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Adapt or conform oneself to new or different conditions
2. Be similar, be in line with

USAGE

1. Students must **conform** to the school's dress code.

2. Some people feel pressure to **conform** to their friends.

Accept

verb

/ækˈsɛpt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Tolerate or accommodate oneself to
2. Consider or hold as true
3. Be sexually responsive to, used of a female domesticated mammal

USAGE

1. I shall have to **accept** these unpleasant working conditions

2. I cannot **accept** the dogma of this church

Chronology

noun

/krəˈnɑlədʒi/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The determination of the actual temporal sequence of past events
2. A record of events in the order of their occurrence
3. An arrangement of events in time

USAGE

1. The **chronology** of the battles is shown on the map.

2. The book follows the **chronology** of his life.

Proximity

noun

/prɑkˈsɪməti/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The property of being close together
2. The region close around a person or thing

USAGE

1. The **proximity** of the school made it easy to walk there.

2. Their house was close in **proximity** to the station.

Surmount

verb

/sərˈmaʊnt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Be or do something to a greater degree
2. Get on top of; deal with successfully
3. Reach the highest point of

USAGE

1. The scarf **surmounted** the gown

2. The team **surmounted** every obstacle in the race.

Delirious

adjective

/dɪˈlɪriəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Marked by uncontrolled excitement or emotion
2. Experiencing delirium

USAGE

1. A crowd of **delirious** baseball fans

2. With a fever, he became **delirious** and confused.

Restraint

noun

/rɪsˈtreɪnt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The act of controlling by restraining someone or something
2. A device that retards something's motion
3. Lack of ornamentation

USAGE

1. The unlawful **restraint** of trade

2. The car did not have proper **restraints** fitted

Repetitive

adjective

/rɪˈpɛtɪtɪv/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Repetitive and persistent
2. Characterized by repetition

USAGE

1. **Repetitive** movement

2. The **repetitive** tasks on the factory line were boring.

Surrogate

noun / adjective

/ˈsɜrəgət/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) A person appointed to represent or act on behalf of others
2. (noun) Someone who takes the place of another person

USAGE

1. **Surrogate** father

2. The **surrogate** parent cared for the child during the illness.

Vindicate

verb

/ˈvɪndɪkeɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

To clear of accusation, blame, suspicion, or doubt with supporting arguments or proof

USAGE

1. Even seven Tour de France wins cannot **vindicate** Lance Armstrong in the eyes of the public--that the athlete used performance enhancing drugs invalidates all those wins.

2. The new evidence **vindicated** the scientist who had been ridiculed.

Preservation

noun

/ˌprɛzərˈveɪʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The activity of protecting something from loss or danger
2. A process that saves organic substances from decay
3. The condition of being (well or ill) preserved

USAGE

1. The **preservation** of old buildings is important to the town.

2. The **preservation** of the ancient manuscript took years.

Raucous

adjective

/ˈrɔkəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Unpleasantly loud and harsh
2. Disturbing the public peace; loud and rough

USAGE

1. A **raucous** party

2. The **raucous** crowd cheered at every goal.

Rash

adj.

/ræʃ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Marked by defiant disregard for danger or consequences; imprudently incurring risk

USAGE

1. Although Bruce was able to make the delivery in time with a nightime motorcycle ride in the rain, Susan criticized his actions as **rash**.

2. A **rash** decision can cost a company its reputation.

Unfettered

adjective

/ənˈfɛtərd/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Not bound by shackles and chains

USAGE

1. The artist worked with **unfettered** creativity.

2. The press enjoyed **unfettered** access to the event.

Sumptuous

adjective

/ˈsʌmptʃwəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Rich and superior in quality

USAGE

1. The king hosted a **sumptuous** feast for his guests.

2. The hotel's **sumptuous** rooms were filled with silk.

Fascinate

verb

/ˈfæsəˌneɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Attract; cause to be enamored
2. To render motionless, as with a fixed stare or by arousing terror or awe
3. Cause to be interested or curious

USAGE

1. The snake charmer **fascinates** the cobra

2. The old map **fascinated** the young historian.

Acquaint

verb

/əkˈweɪnt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Inform
2. Make familiar or conversant with
3. Cause to come to know personally

USAGE

1. Please **acquaint** your colleagues of your plans to move

2. You should **acquaint** yourself with your new computer

Pensive

adjective

/ˈpɛnsɪv/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Showing pensive sadness
2. Deeply or seriously thoughtful

USAGE

1. She sat by the window, looking **pensive** and quiet.

2. The **pensive** boy stared at the stars all night.

Reserved

adjective

/rɪˈzɜrvd/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Marked by self-restraint and reticence
2. Set aside for the use of a particular person or party

USAGE

1. Was habitually **reserved** in speech, withholding her opinion

2. He is **reserved** and rarely speaks in meetings.

Yearn

verb

/jɜrn/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Have affection for; feel tenderness for
2. Have a desire for something or someone who is not present
3. Desire strongly or persistently

USAGE

1. She **yearned** to travel the world after school.

2. He **yearned** for the quiet of his childhood home.

Mill

noun / verb

/mɪl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) The act of grinding to a powder or dust
2. (noun) Machinery that processes materials by grinding or crushing

USAGE

1. **Mill** grain

2. **Mill** a coin

Deliberate

verb

/dɪˈlɪbəreɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Think about carefully; weigh the pros and cons of an issue

USAGE

1. Emergency situations such as this call for immediate action and leave no room to **deliberate** over options.

2. The jury **deliberated** for three days before reaching a verdict.

Arcane

adj.

/ɑrˈkeɪn/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Requiring secret or mysterious knowledge

USAGE

1. Most college fraternities are known for **arcane** rituals that those hoping to join the fraternity must learn.

2. Tax law can seem **arcane** to ordinary citizens.

Bashful

adjective

/ˈbæʃfəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Disposed to avoid notice; (`blate' is a Scottish term for bashful)
2. Self-consciously timid

USAGE

1. They considered themselves a tough outfit and weren't **bashful** about letting anybody know it

2. I never laughed, being **bashful**; lowering my head, I looked at the wall

Purify

verb

/ˈpjʊrəˌfaɪ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Make pure or free from sin or guilt
2. Become clean or pure or free of guilt and sin

USAGE

1. **Purify** the water

2. The hippies came to the ashram in order to **purify**

Subsequent

adjective

/ˈsʌbsəkwənt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Following in time or order

USAGE

1. **Subsequent** developments

2. The **subsequent** investigation revealed several errors.

Squelch

verb

/skwɛltʃ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Suppress or crush completely

USAGE

1. After the dictator consolidated his power, he took steps to **squelch** all criticism, often arresting any journalist who said anything that could be interpreted as negative about his regime.

2. The teacher **squelched** the rumors before they spread.

Dogmatic

adj.

/dɔgˈmætɪk/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Highly opinionated; not accepting that your belief may not be correct

USAGE

1. Bryan is **dogmatic** in his belief that the earth is flat, claiming that all pictures of a spherical earth are computer generated.

2. Her **dogmatic** views left no room for compromise.

Pertinent

adj.

/ˈpɜrtɪnənt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Having precise or logical relevance to the matter at hand

USAGE

1. While the salaries of the players might draw attention in the media, such monetary figures are not **pertinent** to the question of who plays the best on the field.

2. Please include only the **pertinent** details in your report.

Dilute

verb / adjective

/daɪˈlut/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (verb) Lessen the strength or flavor of a solution or mixture
2. (adjective) Reduced in strength or concentration or quality or purity

USAGE

1. **Diluted** alcohol

2. A **dilute** solution

900 / 1400

Moral

noun / adjective

/ˈmɔrəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) The significance of a story or event
2. (adjective) Psychological rather than physical or tangible in effect

USAGE

1. The **moral** of the story is to love thy neighbor

2. **Moral** sense

Prudent

adjective

/ˈprudənt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Careful and sensible; marked by sound judgment

USAGE

1. A **prudent** manager

2. **Prudent** rulers

Pliant

adjective

/ˈplaɪənt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Capable of being bent or flexed or twisted without breaking
2. Able to adjust readily to different conditions
3. Capable of being shaped or bent or drawn out

USAGE

1. A **pliant** young tree

2. **Pliant** molten glass

Ignorance

noun

/ˈɪgnərəns/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

The lack of knowledge or education

USAGE

1. Her **ignorance** of the law got her into trouble.

2. **Ignorance** of the rules is no excuse.

Arduous

adj.

/ˈɑrdʒuəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Demanding considerable mental effort and skill; testing powers of endurance

USAGE

1. In order to deal with the **arduous** cross-country journey, truck drivers often survive on a string of caffeinated drinks, staying awake for up to 30 hours at a time.

2. The **arduous** climb to the summit took nine hours.

Respectful

adjective

/rɪsˈpɛktfəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Full of or exhibiting respect
2. Feeling or manifesting veneration

USAGE

1. **Respectful** behavior

2. A **respectful** glance

Definitive

adjective

/dɪˈfɪnɪtɪv/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Supplying or being a final or conclusive settlement
2. Clearly defined or formulated
3. Of recognized authority or excellence

USAGE

1. A **definitive** verdict

2. The **definitive** work on Greece

Flamboyant

noun / adjective

/flæmˈbɔɪənt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (adjective) Elaborately or excessively ornamented
2. (adjective) Marked by ostentation but often tasteless

USAGE

1. **Flamboyant** handwriting

2. The **flamboyant** singer wore a sparkling suit on stage.

Irrevocable

adj.

/ɪˈrɛvəkəbəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Incapable of being retracted or revoked

USAGE

1. Once you enter your plea to the court, it is **irrevocable** so think carefully about what you will say.

2. Once the contract is signed, the decision is **irrevocable**.

Savor

noun / verb

/ˈseɪvər/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) The taste experience when a savoury condiment is taken into the mouth
2. (verb) Derive or receive pleasure from; get enjoyment from; take pleasure in
3. (verb) Taste appreciatively

USAGE

1. **Savor** the soup

2. He **savored** every bite of the chocolate cake.

Appease

verb

/əˈpiːz/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Pacify by acceding to the demands of

USAGE

1. Neville Chamberlain, the British prime minister during WWII, tried to **appease** Hitler, and in doing so sent a clear message: you can walk all over us.

2. The company raised wages to **appease** the angry workers.

Sever

verb

/ˈsɛvər/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Cut off from a whole
2. Set or keep apart

USAGE

1. His head was **severed** from his body

2. **Sever** a relationship

Hierarchy

noun

/ˈhaɪərˌɑrki/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The organization of people at different ranks in an administrative body
2. A series of ordered groupings of people or things within a system

USAGE

1. Put honesty first in her **hierarchy** of values

2. The army has a clear **hierarchy** of ranks.

Foment

verb

/foʊˈmɛnt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Try to stir up public opinion

USAGE

1. After having his pay cut, Phil spread vicious rumors about his boss, hoping to **foment** a general feeling of discontent.

2. The leaked documents **fomented** anger among the voters.

Imbue

verb

/ˌɪmˈbju/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Suffuse with color
2. Fill, soak, or imbue totally
3. Spread or diffuse through

USAGE

1. The teacher **imbued** her students with a love of reading.

2. Her paintings are **imbued** with warmth.

Panacea

noun

/ˌpænəˈsiə/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Hypothetical remedy for all ills or diseases; a universal solution

USAGE

1. While the company credit card has made most large purchases easier, it is no **panacea**: some smaller basic transactions still must be conducted in cash.

2. Many people wrongly believe that exercise is a **panacea** for every ailment.

Devise

noun / verb

/dɪˈvaɪz/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) (law) a gift of real property by will
2. (noun) A will disposing of real property
3. (verb) Arrange by systematic planning and united effort

USAGE

1. **Devise** a plan to take over the director's office

2. The engineers **devised** a new system for the bridge.

Perpetrate

verb

/ˈpɜrpətˌreɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Perform an act, usually with a negative connotation

USAGE

1. **Perpetrate** a crime

2. The gang **perpetrated** a series of robberies across the city.

Translation

noun

/trænˈzleɪʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The act of uniform movement
2. The act of changing in form or shape or appearance
3. Rewording something in less technical terminology

USAGE

1. A photograph is a **translation** of a scene onto a two-dimensional surface

2. Her **translation** of the poem captured its rhythm.

Unmitigated

adjective

/ənˈmɪtəˌgeɪtɪd/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Not diminished or moderated in intensity or severity; sometimes used as an intensifier

USAGE

1. **Unmitigated** suffering

2. An **unmitigated** horror

Ingenious

adjective

/ˌɪnˈdʒinjəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Showing inventiveness and skill

USAGE

1. An **ingenious** solution to the problem

2. The inventor came up with an **ingenious** way to save water.

Benefactor

noun

/ˈbɛnəˌfæktər/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

A person who helps people or institutions (especially with financial help)

USAGE

1. The **benefactor** paid for the new library.

2. A generous **benefactor** funded the children's hospital.

Convey

verb

/kənˈveɪ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Make known; pass on, of information
2. Serve as a means for expressing something
3. Go or come after and bring or take back

USAGE

1. She **conveyed** the message to me

2. The sign **conveyed** a warning to the drivers.

Acid

noun / adjective

/ˈæsəd/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) Street name for lysergic acid diethylamide
2. (adjective) Having the characteristics of an acid
3. (adjective) Harsh or corrosive in tone

USAGE

1. An **acid** reaction

2. A barrage of **acid** comments

Adorn

verb

/əˈdɔrn/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Make more attractive by adding ornament, colour, etc.
2. Furnish with power or authority; of kings or emperors
3. Be beautiful to look at

USAGE

1. Flowers **adorned** the tables everywhere

2. Flowers **adorned** every table at the wedding.

Liberate

verb

/ˈlɪˌbərˌeɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Grant freedom to; free from confinement
2. Grant freedom to
3. Give equal rights to; of women and minorities

USAGE

1. The students **liberated** their slaves upon graduating from the university

2. The soldiers **liberated** the village after months of occupation.

Remarkable

adjective

/rɪˈmɑrkəbəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Unusual or striking
2. Worthy of notice

USAGE

1. A **remarkable** sight

2. A **remarkable** achievement

Paragon

noun

/ˈpærəˌgɑn/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Model of excellence or perfection of a kind; one having no equal
2. An ideal instance; a perfect embodiment of a concept

USAGE

1. Even with the rise of Kobe Bryant, many still believe that Michael Jordon is the **paragon** for basketball players.

2. Some say that Athens was the **paragon** of democracy, but these people often forget that slaves and women were still not allowed to vote.

Stratagem

noun

/ˈstrætədʒəm/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. A maneuver in a game or conversation
2. An elaborate or deceitful scheme contrived to deceive or evade

USAGE

1. The general's **stratagem** tricked the enemy into a trap.

2. The chess player used a clever **stratagem** to win.

Acclaim

noun / verb

/əkˈleɪm/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) Enthusiastic approval
2. (verb) Praise vociferously
3. (verb) Clap one's hands or shout after performances to indicate approval

USAGE

1. The book met with modest **acclaim**

2. The new play received wide **acclaim** from the critics.

Painstaking

adjective

/ˈpeɪnˌsteɪkɪŋ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Characterized by extreme care and great effort

USAGE

1. **Painstaking** research

2. The **painstaking** restoration took years to finish.

Admonishment

noun

/ædˈmɑnɪʃmɛnt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

A firm rebuke

USAGE

1. The teacher's **admonishment** made the boy blush.

2. A stern **admonishment** was all the thief received.

Precedent

noun

/ˈprɛsɪdənt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

An example that is used to justify similar occurrences at a later time

USAGE

1. The principal explained that even though one student had done modelling work outside of school, the outfits that student wore in those photographs in no way established a **precedent** for what could be worn at school dances.

2. The judge's decision set a **precedent** for similar cases.

Coalesce

verb

/ˌkoʊəˈlɛs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Fuse or cause to grow together

USAGE

1. Over time, the various tribes **coalesced** into a single common culture with one universal language.

2. The small groups **coalesced** into a single political movement.

Unruly

adj.

/ʌnˈruli/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

(of persons) Noisy and lacking in restraint or discipline; unwilling to submit to authority

USAGE

1. Walk in to any preschool and I am sure that you will find an **unruly** and chaotic scene--unless it's nap time.

2. The **unruly** crowd shouted over the speaker.

Volatile

noun / adjective

/ˈvɑlətəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (adjective) Tending to vary often or widely
2. (adjective) Marked by erratic changeableness in affections or attachments
3. (adjective) Liable to lead to sudden change or violence

USAGE

1. It was heated to evaporate the **volatiles**

2. **Volatile** stocks

Accolade

noun

/ˈækəleɪd/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

An award or praise granted as a special honor

USAGE

1. Jean Paul-Sartre was not a fan of **accolades**, and as such, he refused to accept the Nobel Prize for Literature in 1964.

2. The novel earned **accolades** from critics around the world.

Schematic

noun / adjective

/skɪˈmætɪk/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) Diagram of an electrical or mechanical system
2. (adjective) Represented in simplified or symbolic form

USAGE

1. The engineer drew a **schematic** of the electrical circuit.

2. The **schematic** diagram shows how the pipes connect.

Compelling

adjective

/kəmˈpɛlɪŋ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Tending to persuade by forcefulness of argument
2. Driving or forcing

USAGE

1. New and **compelling** evidence

2. **Compelling** ambition

Principal

noun

/ˈprɪnsəpəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The educator who has executive authority for a school
2. An actor who plays a principal role

USAGE

1. She sent unruly pupils to see the **principal**

2. The **principal** of the school spoke at the assembly.

Chivalrous

adj.

/ˈʃɪvəlrəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Being attentive to women like an ideal knight

USAGE

1. Marco's **chivalrous** ways, like opening doors and pulling out chairs, was much appreciated by his date.

2. The **chivalrous** knight rescued the princess from the tower.

Simplify

verb

/ˈsɪmplə˩faɪ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Make simpler or easier or reduce in complexity or extent

USAGE

1. We had to **simplify** the instructions

2. This move will **simplify** our lives

Improvisation

noun

/ˌɪmprɑvɪˈzeɪʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. A performance given extempore without planning or preparation
2. An unplanned expedient

USAGE

1. The jazz band's **improvisation** delighted the audience.

2. Her speech was pure **improvisation**.

Boycott

noun / verb

/ˈbɔɪˌkɑt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

(verb) Refuse to sponsor; refuse to do business with

USAGE

1. Customers decided to **boycott** the store over its policies.

2. The union called a **boycott** of the factory.

Voracious

adj.

/voʊˈreɪʃəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Very hungry; approaching an activity with gusto

USAGE

1. Steven was a **voracious** reader, sometimes finishing two novels in the same day.

2. The **voracious** reader finished three novels in a week.

Audacious

adj.

/ɔˈdeɪʃəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Willing to be bold in social situations or to take risks

USAGE

1. As all of the other campers cowered in their tents, Bill, armed only with a flashlight, **audaciously** tracked down the bear that had raided their food.

2. She made an **audacious** proposal that stunned the board.

Juggernaut

noun

/ˈdʒʌgərˌnɔt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

A force that cannot be stopped

USAGE

1. Napoleon was considered a **juggernaut** until he decided to invade Russia in winter; after which, his once indomitable army was decimated by cold and famine.

2. The company became a **juggernaut** of the software industry.

Thoughtful

adjective

/ˈθɔtfəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Considerate of the feelings or well-being of others
2. Taking heed; giving close and thoughtful attention
3. Having intellectual depth

USAGE

1. A deeply **thoughtful** essay

2. A **thoughtful** paper

Placid

adj.

/ˈplæsɪd/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Not easily irritated

USAGE

1. Doug is normally **placid**, so we were all shocked to see him yelling at the television when the Mets lost the game.

2. The **placid** lake reflected the mountains without a ripple.

Dedication

noun

/ˌdɛdəˈkeɪʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Complete and wholehearted fidelity
2. A message that makes a pledge

USAGE

1. Her **dedication** to research earned her a major award.

2. His **dedication** to the team never wavered.

Cultivate

verb

/ˈkʌltəˌveɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Adapt (a wild plant or unclaimed land) to the environment
2. Prepare for crops
3. Foster the growth of

USAGE

1. **Cultivate** the land

2. **Cultivate** your musical taste

Confiscate

verb / adjective

/ˈkɑnfəsˌkeɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (verb) Take temporary possession of as a security, by legal authority
2. (adjective) Surrendered as a penalty

USAGE

1. The police **confiscated** the stolen artwork

2. The teacher **confiscated** the phone during the test.

Reaction

noun

/riˈækʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Doing something in opposition to another way of doing it that you don't like
2. An idea evoked by some experience
3. Extreme conservatism in political or social matters

USAGE

1. His style of painting was a **reaction** against cubism

2. A bad **reaction** to the medicine

Pirate

noun / verb

/ˈpaɪrət/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) A ship that is manned by pirates
2. (noun) Someone who uses another person's words or ideas as if they were his own
3. (verb) Take arbitrarily or by force

USAGE

1. The **pirate** hid his treasure on a remote island.

2. They **pirate** films and sell them online.

Contact

noun / verb

/ˈkɑnˌtækt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) Close interaction
2. (noun) The act of touching physically

USAGE

1. They kept in daily **contact**

2. They claimed that they had been in **contact** with extraterrestrial beings

Facetious

adj.

/fəˈsiʃəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Cleverly amusing in tone

USAGE

1. **Facetious** behavior will not be tolerated during sex eduation class; it's time for all of you to treat these matters like mature adults.

2. His **facetious** reply made the serious meeting feel silly.

Aesthetics

noun

/ɛsˈθɛtɪks/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

(art) The branch of philosophy dealing with beauty and taste (emphasizing the evaluative criteria that are applied to art)

USAGE

1. Traditional **aesthetics** assumed the existence of universal and timeless criteria of artistic value

2. The **aesthetics** of the new building were praised by critics.

Apathy

noun

/ˈæpəθi/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

An absence of emotion or enthusiasm

USAGE

1. Widespread **apathy** among voters led to a very small turnout on election day.

2. The team's **apathy** after three losses was obvious to every fan.

Avarice

noun

/ˈævərɪs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Greed (one of the seven deadly sins)

USAGE

1. The Spanish conquistadors were known for their **avarice**, plundering Incan land and stealing Incan gold.

2. His **avarice** led him to cheat his partners.

Compliment

noun / verb

/ˈkɑmpləmɛnt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) A remark (or act) expressing praise and admiration
2. (verb) Say something to someone that expresses praise
3. (verb) Express respect or esteem for

USAGE

1. He **complimented** her on her last physics paper

2. She received a **compliment** on her presentation.

Deport

verb

/dɪˈpɔrt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Expel from a country
2. Hand over to the authorities of another country
3. Behave in a certain manner

USAGE

1. The government will **deport** anyone who is living there illegally.

2. The government plans to **deport** the foreign students who broke the law.

Subordination

noun

/səˌbɔrdəˈneɪʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The act of mastering or subordinating someone
2. The quality of obedient submissiveness
3. The grammatical relation of a modifying word or phrase to its head

USAGE

1. Her **subordination** to the manager kept her from speaking up.

2. The **subordination** of the junior staff to their bosses is clear in the company's rules.

Rejoice

verb

/rɪˈdʒɔɪs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. To express great joy
2. Feel happiness or joy
3. Be ecstatic with joy

USAGE

1. The villagers **rejoiced** when the rain finally came.

2. We **rejoiced** at the news of their safe return.

Appall

verb

/əˈpɔl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Fill with apprehension or alarm; cause to be unpleasantly surprised
2. Strike with disgust or revulsion

USAGE

1. The cruelty of the attack **appalled** the entire country.

2. His rude behavior **appalled** his guests.

Salubrious

adjective

/səˈlubriəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Promoting health; healthful
2. Favorable to health of mind or body

USAGE

1. The **salubrious** mountain air and water

2. Not the most **salubrious** campsite

Recalcitrant

adjective

/rɪˈkælsɪtrənt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Marked by stubborn resistance to authority
2. Stubbornly resistant to authority or control

USAGE

1. The University suspended the most **recalcitrant** demonstrators

2. The **recalcitrant** child refused to eat his vegetables.

Colonize

verb

/ˈkɑləˌnaɪz/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Settle as colonists or establish a colony (in)
2. Settle as a colony; of countries in the developing world

USAGE

1. The British **colonized** the East Coast

2. Europeans **colonized** Africa in the 17th century

Distract

verb

/dɪsˈtrækt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Disturb in mind or make uneasy or cause to be worried or alarmed
2. Draw someone's attention away from something

USAGE

1. The thief **distracted** the bystanders

2. The loud music **distracted** the students from their work.

Treacherous

adj.

/ˈtrɛtʃərəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Tending to betray
2. Dangerously unstable and unpredictable

USAGE

1. Even though Jesse James was an outlaw, his killer, Robert Ford, is remembered more for his **treacherous** actions than for eliminating a criminal and murder.

2. The bridge built from twine and vine is **treacherous** to walk across, and so I think I will stay put right here.

Benign

adj.

/bɪˈnaɪn/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Kind
2. (medicine) Not dangerous to health; not recurrent or progressive

USAGE

1. I remember my grandfather's face was wrinkled, **benign**, and calm.

2. The tumor located in your ear lobe seems to be **benign** and should not cause you any trouble.

Renovate

verb

/ˈrɛnəˌveɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Give new life or energy to
2. Make brighter and prettier
3. Restore to a previous or better condition

USAGE

1. This will **renovate** my spirits

2. My wife wants us to **renovate**

Adept

noun / adjective

/əˈdɛpt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) Someone who is dazzlingly skilled in any field
2. (adjective) Having or showing knowledge and skill and aptitude

USAGE

1. **Adept** in handicrafts

2. An **adept** juggler

Abstruse

adj.

/æbˈstruːs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Difficult to understand; incomprehensible

USAGE

1. Physics textbooks can seem so **abstruse** to the uninitiated that readers feel as though they are looking at hieroglyphics.

2. The lawyer's **abstruse** explanation of the contract left the client more confused than before.

Admiration

noun

/ˌædməˈeɪʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. A favorable judgment
2. A feeling of delighted approval and liking
3. The feeling aroused by something strange and surprising

USAGE

1. A small token in **admiration** of your works

2. Her **admiration** for her teacher grew every year.

Caricature

noun / verb

/ˈkɛrəkətʃər/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) A representation of a person that is exaggerated for comic effect
2. (verb) Represent in or produce a caricature of

USAGE

1. The drawing **caricatured** the President

2. The cartoonist drew a **caricature** of the president.

Curb

noun / verb

/kɜrb/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) The act of restraining power or action or limiting excess
2. (noun) A stock exchange in New York
3. (noun) A horse's bit with an attached chain or strap to check the horse

USAGE

1. **Curb** your dogs

2. The city wants to **curb** the number of cars downtown.

Impudent

adj.

/ˈɪmpjədənt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Improperly forward or bold

USAGE

1. In an **impudent** move, the defendant spoke out of order to say terribly insulting things to the judge.

2. The **impudent** waiter laughed at the customer's complaint.

Meditative

adjective

/ˈmɛdəˌteɪtɪv/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Deeply or seriously thoughtful

USAGE

1. The **meditative** music helped her relax after work.

2. He sat in a **meditative** silence by the lake.

Expel

verb

/ɪkˈspɛl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Eliminate (a substance)
2. Cause to flee
3. Remove from a position or office

USAGE

1. He was **expelled** from his native country

2. The school **expelled** the student for cheating.

Rehearsal

noun

/rɪˈhɜrsəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. A practice session in preparation for a public performance (as of a play or speech or concert)
2. (psychology) A form of practice; repetition of information (silently or aloud) in order to keep it in short-term memory

USAGE

1. He missed too many **rehearsals**

2. A **rehearsal** will be held the day before the wedding

Spontaneous

adjective

/spɑnˈteɪniəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Said or done without having been planned or written in advance
2. Happening or arising without apparent external cause

USAGE

1. **Spontaneous** laughter

2. **Spontaneous** combustion

Repent

verb

/rɪˈpɛnt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Feel remorse for; feel sorry for; be contrite about
2. Turn away from sin or do penitence

USAGE

1. He **repented** of his cruel words and apologized.

2. The thief **repented** and returned every stolen coin.

Cherish

verb

/ˈtʃɛrɪʃ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Be fond of; be attached to

USAGE

1. She **cherishes** the letters her grandmother wrote to her.

2. Grandparents often **cherish** time spent with their grandchildren.

Distinction

noun

/dɪsˈtɪŋkʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. A distinguishing difference
2. A distinguishing quality
3. A discrimination between things as different and distinct

USAGE

1. He learned the **distinction** between gold and lead

2. It has the **distinction** of being the cheapest restaurant in town

Oppress

verb

/əpˈrɛs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Come down on or keep down by unjust use of one's authority
2. Cause to suffer

USAGE

1. The government **oppresses** political activists

2. The regime **oppressed** its citizens for decades.

Consign

verb

/kənˈsaɪn/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Give over to another for care or safekeeping
2. Commit forever; commit irrevocably
3. Send to an address

USAGE

1. **Consign** your baggage

2. The old furniture was **consigned** to the dump.

Devious

adjective

/ˈdiviəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Deviating from a straight course
2. Indirect in departing from the accepted or proper way; misleading
3. Characterized by insincerity or deceit; evasive

USAGE

1. A scenic but **devious** route

2. Used **devious** means to achieve success

Illusion

noun

/ˌɪˈluʒən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. An illusory feat; considered magical by naive observers
2. The act of deluding; deception by creating illusory ideas
3. Something many people believe that is false

USAGE

1. They have the **illusion** that I am very wealthy

2. The mirrors created an **illusion** of a much larger room.

Accompaniment

noun

/əˈkʌmpnɪmənt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The act of accompanying someone or something in order to protect them
2. Something added to complete or embellish or make perfect

USAGE

1. Wild rice was served as an **accompaniment** to the main dish

2. The soup was served with a simple salad as an **accompaniment**.

Provocation

noun

/ˌprɑvəˈkeɪʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Unfriendly behavior that causes anger or resentment
2. Needed encouragement
3. Something that incites or provokes; a means of arousing or stirring to action

USAGE

1. The result was a **provocation** of vigorous investigation

2. The protesters acted without **provocation** from the police.

Precision

noun

/priˈsɪʒən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

The quality of being reproducible in amount or performance

USAGE

1. He handled it with the **preciseness** of an automaton

2. Note the meticulous **precision** of his measurements

Cordial

noun / adjective

/ˈkɔrdʒəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) Strong highly flavored sweet liquor usually drunk after a meal
2. (adjective) Diffusing warmth and friendliness
3. (adjective) Sincerely or intensely felt

USAGE

1. **Cordial** relations

2. A **cordial** greeting

Covert

noun / adjective

/ˈkoʊvərt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) A covering that serves to conceal or shelter something
2. (noun) A flock of coots
3. (adjective) (of a wife) being under the protection of her husband

USAGE

1. The brush provided a **covert** for game

2. **Covert** actions by the CIA

Defective

adjective

/dɪˈfɛktɪv/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Not working properly
2. Markedly subnormal in structure or function or intelligence or behavior
3. Having a defect

USAGE

1. A **defective** appliance

2. **Defective** speech

Aptitude

noun

/ˈæptəˌtud/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Inherent ability

USAGE

1. She has a natural **aptitude** for languages.

2. He showed an **aptitude** for music at a very young age.

Appropriation

noun

/əpˌroʊpriˈeɪʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Incorporation by joining or uniting
2. Money set aside (as by a legislature) for a specific purpose

USAGE

1. The necessary funds were obtained by the government's **appropriation** of the company's operating unit

2. A person's **appropriation** of property belonging to another is dishonest

Exhort

verb

/ɪgˈzɔrt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

To strongly urge on; encourage

USAGE

1. Nelson's parents **exhorted** him to study medicine, urging him to choose a respectable profession; intransigent, Nelson left home to become a graffiti artist.

2. The coach **exhorted** the players to play harder in the second half.

Versatile

adjective

/ˈvɜrsətəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Able to move freely in all directions
2. Competent in many areas and able to turn with ease from one thing to another
3. Changeable or inconstant

USAGE

1. An owl's **versatile** toe can move backward and forward

2. An insect's **versatile** antennae can move up and down or laterally

Dismay

noun / verb

/dɪsˈmeɪ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) Fear resulting from the awareness of danger
2. (noun) The feeling of despair in the face of obstacles
3. (verb) Fill with apprehension or alarm; cause to be unpleasantly surprised

USAGE

1. To her **dismay**, the concert was cancelled.

2. He looked at the messy room in **dismay**.

Amuse

verb

/əmˈjuz/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Make (somebody) laugh
2. Occupy in an agreeable, entertaining or pleasant fashion

USAGE

1. The clown **amused** the children

2. The play **amused** the ladies

Retreat

noun / verb

/rit'rit/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) Withdrawal for prayer and study and meditation
2. (noun) An area where you can be alone

USAGE

1. The religious **retreat** is a form of vacation activity

2. The disorderly **retreat** of French troops

Day 06- 200 Words: Insatiable through Admissible

Cards 1001 to 1200

Insatiable

adjective

/ˌɪnˈseɪʃəbəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Impossible to satisfy

USAGE

1. An **insatiate** appetite

2. An **insatiable** demand for old buildings to restore

Frivolous

adj.

/ˈfrɪvələs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Not serious in content or attitude or behavior

USAGE

1. Compared to Juliet's passionate concern for human rights, Jake's non-stop concern about football seems somewhat **frivolous**.

2. Spending the whole budget on decorations was **frivolous**.

Cacophony

noun

/kæˈkɑfəni/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Loud confusing disagreeable sounds
2. A loud harsh or strident noise

USAGE

1. The **cacophony** of car horns filled the crowded street.

2. The orchestra tuned up in a **cacophony** of sounds.

Integrity

noun

/ˌɪnˈtɛgrəti/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Moral soundness
2. An undivided or unbroken completeness or totality with nothing wanting

USAGE

1. He expects to find in us the common honesty and **integrity** of men of business

2. They admired his scrupulous professional **integrity**

Unpretentious

adjective

/ˌʌnpriˈtɛnʃəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Not ostentatious
2. Lacking pretension or affectation
3. Exhibiting restrained good taste

USAGE

1. An **unpretentious** country church

2. Her quiet **unpretentious** demeanor

Berate

verb

/bɪˈreɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Censure severely or angrily

USAGE

1. The coach **berated** the players for their poor play.

2. The angry boss **berated** the team for missing the deadline.

Dowdy

noun / adjective

/ˈdaʊdi/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) Deep-dish apple dessert covered with a rich crust
2. (adjective) Primly out of date
3. (adjective) Lacking in smartness or taste

USAGE

1. A **dowdy** grey outfit

2. A clean and sunny but completely **dowdy** room

Fabricate

verb

/ˈfæbrəˌkeɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Make up something artificial or untrue

USAGE

1. The company **fabricates** plastic chairs

2. The reporter was fired for **fabricating** his sources.

Imprecise

adjective

/ˈɪmprəˌsaɪs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Not precise

USAGE

1. **Imprecise** astronomical observations

2. The terms he used were **imprecise** and emotional

Infertile

adjective

/ˌɪnˈfɜrtəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Incapable of reproducing

USAGE

1. An **infertile** couple

2. The **infertile** soil could not support any crops.

Dictate

noun / verb

/dɪkˈteɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) A guiding principle
2. (noun) An authoritative rule
3. (verb) Say out loud for the purpose of recording

USAGE

1. The **dictates** of reason

2. He **dictated** a report to his secretary

Gloat

noun / verb

/gloʊt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) Malicious satisfaction
2. (verb) Dwell on with satisfaction

USAGE

1. He tried not to **gloat** when his rival lost.

2. She could not resist the urge to **gloat** over her win.

Facilitate

verb

/fəˈsɪləˌteɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Make easier
2. Increase the likelihood of (a response)
3. Be of use

USAGE

1. You could **facilitate** the process by sharing your knowledge

2. The stimulus **facilitates** a delayed impulse

Intrinsic

adjective

/ˌɪnˈtrɪnsɪk/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Situated within or belonging solely to the organ or body part on which it acts
2. Belonging to a thing by its very nature

USAGE

1. **Intrinsic** muscles

2. Form was treated as something **intrinsic**, as the very essence of the thing

Resplendent

adjective

/risˈplɛndənt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Having great beauty and splendor

USAGE

1. The bride looked **resplendent** in her gown.

2. The bride looked **resplendent** in her silver gown.

Delimit

verb

/dɪˈlɪmɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Set, mark, or draw the boundaries of something
2. Determine the essential quality of
3. Be opposite to; of angles and sides, in geometry

USAGE

1. The border **delimits** the two districts.

2. The fence was built to **delimit** the boundary of the farm.

Venerate

verb

/ˈvɛnəreɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

To respect deeply

USAGE

1. The professor, despite his soporific lectures, was **venerated** amongst his colleagues, publishing more papers yearly than all of his peers combined.

2. Many cultures **venerate** their elders.

Ornate

adj.

/ɔrˈneɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Marked by elaborate rhetoric and elaborated with decorative details

USAGE

1. The **ornate** Victorian and Edwardian homes spread throughout San Francisco are my favorite part of the city.

2. The **ornate** cathedral had gold leaf on every column.

Induce

verb

/ˌɪnˈdus/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Reason or establish by induction
2. Cause to do; cause to act in a specified manner
3. Cause to arise

USAGE

1. The ads **induced** me to buy a VCR

2. **Induce** a crisis

Disarm

verb

/dɪˈsɑrm/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Remove offensive capability from
2. Take away the weapons from; render harmless
3. Make less hostile; win over

USAGE

1. Her charm **disarmed** the prosecution lawyer completely

2. The soldiers **disarmed** the rebels after a short fight.

Detract

verb

/dɪtˈrækt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Take away a part from; diminish

USAGE

1. His bad manners **detract** from his good character

2. The loud noise **detracted** from the beauty of the concert.

Abet

verb

/əˈbɛt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Assist or encourage, usually in some wrongdoing

USAGE

1. He was charged with **abetting** the robbery.

2. The accountant was accused of **abetting** the fraud.

Disdain

noun / verb

/dɪsˈdeɪn/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) Lack of respect accompanied by a feeling of intense dislike
2. (verb) Reject with contempt
3. (verb) Look down on with disdain

USAGE

1. She looked at the cheap food with **disdain**.

2. He **disdained** anyone who did not read books.

Nullify

verb

/ˈnʌləˌfaɪ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Make ineffective by counterbalancing the effect of
2. Show to be invalid
3. Declare invalid

USAGE

1. The judge **nullified** the contract because of fraud.

2. The new law will **nullify** the earlier agreement.

Figurative

adjective

/ˈfɪgjərətɪv/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (used of the meanings of words or text) Not literal; using figures of speech
2. Consisting of or forming human or animal figures

USAGE

1. **Figurative** language

2. The **figurative** art of the humanistic tradition

Hallow

verb

/ˈhæloʊ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Render holy by means of religious rites

USAGE

1. The temple was built to **hallow** the holy site.

2. The old stones were said to **hallow** the ground around the temple.

Grievance

noun

/ˈgrivəns/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

A resentment strong enough to justify retaliation

USAGE

1. The workers presented their **grievances** to the manager.

2. The employees filed a **grievance** about unpaid overtime.

Acquire

verb

/əkˈwaɪər/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Come to have or undergo a change of (physical features and attributes)
2. Take on a certain form, attribute, or aspect
3. Gain through experience

USAGE

1. I **acquired** a strong aversion to television

2. Children **acquire** language at an amazing rate

Unconvincing

adjective

/ˌʌnkənˈvɪnsɪŋ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Not convincing
2. Having a probability too low to inspire belief

USAGE

1. **Unconvincing** argument

2. As **unconvincing** as a forced smile

Felon

noun

/ˈfɛlən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Someone who has committed a crime or has been legally convicted of a crime

USAGE

1. The **felon** was released from prison after ten years.

2. The **felon** was barred from voting after his conviction.

Harmonious

adjective

/hɑrˈmoʊniəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Existing together in harmony
2. Suitable and fitting
3. Musically pleasing

USAGE

1. **Harmonious** family relationships

2. The tailored clothes were **harmonious** with her military bearing

Idiosyncrasy

noun

/ˌɪdiəˈsɪŋkrəsi/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

A behavioral attribute that is distinctive and peculiar to an individual

USAGE

1. Peggy's numerous **idiosyncrasies** include wearing mismatched shoes, laughing loudly to herself, and owning a pet aardvark.

2. Tapping his pen three times is one of his **idiosyncrasies**.

Discomfit

verb

/dɪsˈkʌmfɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Cause to lose one's composure

USAGE

1. The sudden question **discomfited** the nervous speaker.

2. Her blunt question **discomfited** the nervous candidate.

Inadvertent

adj.

/ˌɪnədˈvɜrtənt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Happening by chance or unexpectedly or unintentionally

USAGE

1. Although Prohibition was rooted in noble ideals, the **inadvertent** and costly consequences of making alcohol illegal in the U.S. led its the repeal.

2. The **inadvertent** deletion of the file caused a long delay.

Choreography

noun

/ˌkɔriˈɑgrəfi/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. A show involving artistic dancing
2. A notation used by choreographers
3. The representation of dancing by symbols as music is represented by notes

USAGE

1. The **choreography** of the dance was stunning.

2. The **choreography** of the musical was praised by critics.

Portion

noun / verb

/ˈpɔrʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) The allotment of some amount by dividing something
2. (noun) Something less than the whole of a human artifact
3. (noun) An individual quantity of food or drink taken as part of a meal

USAGE

1. His **portion** was larger than hers

2. I read a **portion** of the manuscript

Serf

noun

/sɜrf/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

(Middle Ages) A person who is bound to the land and owned by the feudal lord

USAGE

1. The **serf** worked the land for his lord.

2. The **serf** spent his life working on the lord's estate.

Unsophisticated

adjective

/ˌʌnsəˈfɪstɪˌkeɪtɪd/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Awkwardly simple and provincial
2. Lacking complexity
3. Not wise in the ways of the world

USAGE

1. The nightlife of Montmartre awed the **unsophisticated** tourists

2. An **unsophisticated** machine

Incapacitate

verb

/ˌɪnkəˈpæsɪˌteɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Injure permanently
2. Make unable to perform a certain action

USAGE

1. The injury **incapacitated** him for several months.

2. The power outage **incapacitated** the entire city for hours.

Expand

verb

/ɪkˈspænd/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Become larger in size or volume or quantity
2. Exaggerate or make bigger
3. Grow vigorously

USAGE

1. His business **expanded** rapidly

2. **Expand** the house by adding another wing

Fallacious

adj.

/fəˈleɪʃəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Of a belief that is based on faulty reasoning

USAGE

1. The widespread belief that Eskimos have forty different words for snow is **fallacious**, based on one false report.

2. His **fallacious** claim that the bridge was safe was disproven by engineers.

Demolish

verb

/dɪˈmalɪʃ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Defeat soundly
2. Destroy completely
3. Humiliate or depress completely

USAGE

1. The home team **demolished** the visitors

2. The wrecking ball **demolished** the building

Irresolute

adj.

/ɪˈrɛzəˌlut/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Uncertain how to act or proceed

USAGE

1. He stood **irresolute** at the split in the trail, not sure which route would lead back to the camp.

2. **Irresolute** about the job offer, she asked for more time.

Lay

noun / verb / adjective

/leɪ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) A narrative poem of popular origin
2. (noun) A narrative song with a recurrent refrain
3. (verb) Put into a certain place or abstract location

USAGE

1. **Lay** the books on the table

2. **Lay** the patient carefully onto the bed

Astrology

noun

/əsˈtrɑlədʒi/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

A pseudoscience claiming divination by the positions of the planets and sun and moon

USAGE

1. She reads her horoscope in **astrology** magazines.

2. She reads her horoscope each morning, although she does not believe in **astrology**.

Eminent

adj.

/ˈɛmɪnənt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Standing above others in quality or position

USAGE

1. Shakespeare is an **eminent** author in the English language, but I find his writing uninteresting and melodramatic.

2. The **eminent** scientist received an award for her research.

Discretion

noun

/dɪsˈkrɛʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The trait of judging wisely and objectively
2. The power of making free choices unconstrained by external agencies
3. Knowing how to avoid embarrassment or distress

USAGE

1. The servants showed great tact and **discretion**

2. The manager used **discretion** when deciding who got the job.

Impenetrable

adjective

/ˌɪmˈpɛnətrəbəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Impossible to understand
2. Not admitting of penetration or passage into or through
3. Permitting little if any light to pass through because of denseness of matter

USAGE

1. **Impenetrable** jargon

2. An **impenetrable** fortress

Prolix

adjective

/proʊˈlɪks/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Tediously prolonged or tending to speak or write at great length

USAGE

1. Editing a **prolix** manuscript

2. A **prolix** lecturer telling you more than you want to know

1050 / 1400

Sordid

adj.

/ˈsɔrdɪd/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Involving ignoble actions and motives; arousing moral distaste and contempt; foul and run-down and repulsive

USAGE

1. The nightly news simply announced that the senator had had an affair, but the tabloid published all the **sordid** details of the interaction.

2. The newspaper reported the **sordid** details of the scandal.

Adapt

verb

/əˈdæpt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Adapt or conform oneself to new or different conditions
2. Make fit for, or change to suit a new purpose

USAGE

1. **Adapt** our native cuisine to the available food resources of the new country

2. Animals **adapt** to their surroundings to survive.

Revere

noun / verb

/rɪˈvɪr/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) A lapel on a woman's garment; turned back to show the reverse side
2. (verb) Love unquestioningly and uncritically or to excess; venerate as an idol

USAGE

1. Many people **revere** the old philosopher as a wise teacher.

2. The villagers **revere** their elders.

Fundamental

noun / adjective

/ˌfʌndəˈmɛntəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) The lowest tone of a harmonic series
2. (adjective) Serving as an essential component
3. (adjective) Being or involving basic facts or principles

USAGE

1. **Fundamentals** include a company's growth, revenues, earnings, management, and capital structure

2. An example that was **fundamental** to the argument

Florid

adjective

/ˈflɔrəd/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Inclined to a healthy reddish color often associated with outdoor life
2. Elaborately or excessively ornamented

USAGE

1. The senator's **florid** speech

2. His **florid** speech was full of long, colorful words.

Naive

adjective

/ˌnaɪˈiv/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Not initiated; deficient in relevant experience
2. Lacking information or instruction
3. Inexperienced

USAGE

1. He took part in the experiment as a **naive** subject

2. A teenager's **naive** ignorance of life

Inert

adjective

/ˌɪˈnɜrt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Slow and apathetic
2. Unable to move or resist motion
3. Having only a limited ability to react chemically; chemically inactive

USAGE

1. She was fat and **inert**

2. **Inert** matter

Din

noun / verb

/dɪn/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) The act of making a noisy disturbance
2. (noun) A loud harsh or strident noise
3. (verb) Instill (into a person) by constant repetition

USAGE

1. He **dinned** the lessons into his students

2. The **din** of the factory made it hard to talk.

Fetter

noun / verb

/ˈfɛtər/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) A shackle for the ankles or feet
2. (verb) Restrain with fetters

USAGE

1. The prisoner was held in **fetters**.

2. Rules can **fetter** creativity.

Philosophy

noun

/fəˈlɑsəfi/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Any personal belief about how to live or how to deal with a situation
2. The rational investigation of questions about existence and knowledge and ethics

USAGE

1. Self-indulgence was his only **philosophy**

2. My father's **philosophy** of child-rearing was to let mother do it

Advice

noun

/ædˈvaɪs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

A proposal for an appropriate course of action

USAGE

1. My doctor gave me good **advice** about my diet.

2. My grandmother's **advice** has guided me for years.

Elated

adjective

/ɪˈleɪtəd/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Exultantly proud and joyful; in high spirits
2. Full of high-spirited delight

USAGE

1. The **elated** winner

2. Felt **elated** and excited

Ornamental

noun / adjective

/ˌɔrnəˈmɛntəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) Any plant grown for its beauty or ornamental value
2. (adjective) Serving an esthetic rather than a useful purpose

USAGE

1. The garden has **ornamental** trees and flowering bushes.

2. The **ornamental** vase sits on the mantelpiece.

Euphemistic

adjective

/ˌjufəˈmɪstɪk/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Substituting a mild term for a harsher or distasteful one

USAGE

1. `peepee' is a common **euphemistic** term

2. Calling the failed plan a learning experience was **euphemistic**.

Desperate

noun / adjective

/ˈdɛsprɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) A person who is frightened and in need of help
2. (adjective) Fraught with extreme danger; nearly hopeless

USAGE

1. They prey on the hopes of the **desperate**

2. Made a last **desperate** attempt to reach the climber

Mythology

noun

/məˈθɑləˌdʒi/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

The study of myths

USAGE

1. Greek **mythology** is full of gods and heroes.

2. The story of the flood appears in the **mythology** of many cultures.

Epitome

noun

/ɪˈpɪtəmi/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. A standard or typical example
2. A brief abstract (as of an article or book)

USAGE

1. He is the **epitome** of a gentleman.

2. She is the **epitome** of kindness and patience.

Permeability

noun

/pərˌmiəˈbɪlɪti/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

The property of something that can be pervaded by a liquid (as by osmosis or diffusion)

USAGE

1. The **permeability** of the rock allows water to flow through.

2. The **permeability** of the soil determines how fast water drains.

Loquacious

adjective

/loʊkˈweɪʃəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Full of trivial conversation

USAGE

1. The **loquacious** guide told us stories all the way up the hill.

2. Her **loquacious** nature made her a good host.

Totality

noun

/toʊˈtæləti/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The whole amount
2. The quality of being complete and indiscriminate
3. The state of being total and complete

USAGE

1. The **totality** of war and its consequences

2. The all-embracing **totality** of the state

Rancid

adjective

/ˈrænsɪd/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Smelling of fermentation or staleness

USAGE

1. **Rancid** butter

2. **Rancid** bacon

Excel

verb

/ɪkˈsɛl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Distinguish oneself

USAGE

1. She **excelled** in math

2. She **excels** at mathematics and science.

Invigorate

verb

/ˌɪnˈvɪgərɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Impart vigor, strength, or vitality to
2. Make lively
3. Give life or energy to

USAGE

1. Exercise is **invigorating**

2. The cold water **invigorated** him

Cursory

adjective

/ˈkɜrsəri/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Hasty and without attention to detail; not thorough

USAGE

1. A casual (or **cursory**) inspection failed to reveal the house's structural flaws

2. The inspector gave the building a **cursory** glance.

Dynamic

noun / adjective

/daɪˈnæmɪk/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) An efficient incentive
2. (adjective) Characterized by action or forcefulness or force of personality
3. (adjective) Of or relating to dynamics

USAGE

1. They hoped it would act as a spiritual **dynamic** on all churches

2. A **dynamic** market

Keen

noun / verb / adjective

/kin/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) A funeral lament sung with loud wailing
2. (verb) Express grief verbally
3. (adjective) Having a sharp cutting edge or point

USAGE

1. A **keen** blade

2. **Keen** winds

Imperturbable

adjective

/ˌɪmpərˈtɜrbəbəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Not easily perturbed or excited or upset; marked by extreme calm and composure

USAGE

1. Hitherto **imperturbable**, he now showed signs of alarm

2. An **imperturbable** self-possession

Pejorative

adj.

/pɪˈdʒɔrətɪv/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Expressing disapproval (usu. refers to a term)

USAGE

1. Most psychologists object to the **pejorative** term "shrink", believing that they expand the human mind, not limit it.

2. The critics used the word amateur as a **pejorative**.

Irrational

noun / adjective

/ˌɪˈræʃənəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) A real number that cannot be expressed as a rational number
2. (adjective) Not consistent with or using reason
3. (adjective) Real but not expressible as the quotient of two integers

USAGE

1. **Irrational** fears

2. **Irrational** animals

Phenomenology

noun

/fəˈnɑməˌnɑlɑˌgi/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

A philosophical doctrine proposed by Edmund Husserl based on the study of human experience in which considerations of objective reality are not taken into account

USAGE

1. **Phenomenology** studies how people experience the world.

2. In **phenomenology**, the study of experience is central to philosophy.

Indolent

adjective

/ˈɪndələnt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (of tumors, e.g.) Slow to heal or develop and usually painless
2. Disinclined to work or exertion

USAGE

1. An **indolent** ulcer

2. Leprosy is an **indolent** infectious disease

Culmination

noun

/ˌkʌlməˈneɪʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. A concluding action
2. The decisive moment in a novel or play
3. A final climactic stage

USAGE

1. Their achievements stand as a **culmination** of centuries of development

2. The festival was the **culmination** of a year of planning.

Disgrace

noun / verb

/dɪsˈgreɪs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) A state of dishonor
2. (verb) Damage the reputation of
3. (verb) Reduce in worth or character, usually verbally

USAGE

1. The scandal was a **disgrace** to the whole team.

2. He was sent home in **disgrace**.

Futile

adj.

/ˈfjutəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Producing no result or effect; unproductive of success

USAGE

1. I thought I could repair the car myself, but after two days of work with no success, I have to admit that my efforts were **futile**.

2. Their efforts to save the farm were **futile**.

Knowledgeable

adjective

/ˈnɑlədʒəbəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Highly educated; having extensive information or understanding
2. Thoroughly acquainted through study or experience
3. Alert and fully informed

USAGE

1. A **knowledgeable** critic

2. A **knowledgeable** audience

Encomium

noun

/ɛnˈkɔˌmɪəm/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

A formal expression of praise

USAGE

1. The newspaper printed an **encomium** for the retiring doctor.

2. His speech was a warm **encomium** for the teacher.

Linguistics

noun

/lɪŋˈgwɪstɪks/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The humanistic study of language and literature
2. The scientific study of language

USAGE

1. She studies **linguistics** to learn how languages change.

2. **Linguistics** explores how sounds and grammar shape a language.

Precursor

noun

/priˈkɜrsər/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Something that precedes and indicates the approach of something or someone
2. A person who goes before or announces the coming of another

USAGE

1. The early steam engine was the **precursor** of the modern train.

2. The early typewriter was a **precursor** of the modern keyboard.

Hyperbolic

adjective

/ˌhaɪpərˈbɑlɪk/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Enlarged beyond truth or reasonableness
2. Of or relating to a hyperbola

USAGE

1. A **hyperbolic** style

2. **Hyperbolic** functions

Permeable

adjective

/ˈpɜrˌmiəbəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Allowing fluids or gases to pass or diffuse through

USAGE

1. **Permeable** membranes

2. Rock that is **permeable** by water

Endorse

verb

/ɛnˈdɔrs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Sign as evidence of legal transfer
2. Guarantee as meeting a certain standard
3. Be behind; approve of

USAGE

1. **Endorse** cheques

2. **Endorse** a new project

Indictment

noun

/ˌɪnˈdaɪtmənt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

An accusation of wrongdoing

USAGE

1. The book is an **indictment** of modern philosophy

2. The report was a harsh **indictment** of the company's management.

Enigma

noun

/ɪˈnɪgmə/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Something that baffles understanding and cannot be explained
2. A difficult problem

USAGE

1. The painting remains an **enigma** to art historians.

2. Her silence was an **enigma** to everyone.

Fret

noun / verb

/frɛt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) A spot that has been worn away by abrasion or erosion
2. (noun) Agitation resulting from active worry

USAGE

1. There was a simple **fret** at the top of the walls

2. Don't **fret** over these small details

Alchemy

noun

/ˈælkəmi/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. A pseudoscientific forerunner of chemistry in medieval times
2. The way two individuals relate to each other

USAGE

1. A mysterious **alchemy** brought them together

2. Medieval **alchemy** tried to turn metals into gold.

Diversify

verb

/daɪˈvɜrsəˌfaɪ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Vary in order to spread risk or to expand
2. Spread into new habitats and produce variety or variegate
3. Make (more) diverse

USAGE

1. The company **diversified**

2. The plants on this island **diversified**

Slake

verb

/sleɪk/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Cause to heat and crumble by treatment with water
2. Make less active or intense
3. Satisfy (thirst)

USAGE

1. He drank water to **slake** his thirst after the run.

2. The cold lemonade **slaked** our thirst after the long walk.

Stationary

adjective

/ˈsteɪʃəˌnɛri/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Not capable of being moved
2. Standing still

USAGE

1. **Stationary** machinery

2. The car remained **stationary** with the engine running

Crescendo

noun / verb / adjective

/krɪˈʃɛndoʊ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) (music) a gradual increase in loudness
2. (verb) Grow louder
3. (adjective) Gradually increasing in volume

USAGE

1. The music **crescendoes** here

2. The music built to a loud **crescendo** at the end.

Vigilant

adjective

/ˈvɪdʒələnt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Carefully observant or attentive; on the lookout for possible danger

USAGE

1. The **vigilant** eye of the town watch

2. The guard remained **vigilant** throughout the night.

Frustrate

verb

/ˈfrʌstreɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Hinder or prevent (the efforts, plans, or desires) of

USAGE

1. I thought I would finish writing the paper by lunchtime, but a number of urgent interruptions served to **frustrate** my plan.

2. Heavy traffic **frustrated** every attempt to reach the airport on time.

Libertine

noun / adjective

/ˈlɪbərˌtin/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) A dissolute person; usually a man who is morally unrestrained
2. (adjective) Unrestrained by convention or morality

USAGE

1. The **libertine** lived a life of wild pleasure.

2. The **libertine** ignored every social rule.

Barren

noun / adjective

/ˈbærən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) An uninhabited wilderness that is worthless for cultivation
2. (adjective) Completely wanting or lacking
3. (adjective) Not bearing offspring

USAGE

1. The **barrens** of central Africa

2. Writing **barren** of insight

Interim

noun / adjective

/ˈɪntərəm/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) The time between one event, process, or period and another
2. (adjective) Serving during an intermediate interval of time

USAGE

1. An **interim** agreement

2. The **interim** manager will run the company until a new CEO is hired.

Uniform

noun / verb / adjective

/ˈjunəˌfɔrm/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (verb) Provide with uniforms
2. (adjective) Not differentiated
3. (adjective) The same throughout in structure or composition

USAGE

1. The guards were **uniformed**

2. At regular (or **uniform**) intervals

Disinclination

noun

/dɪsɪnkləˈneɪʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. A certain degree of unwillingness
2. That toward which you are inclined to feel dislike

USAGE

1. His **disinclination** for modesty is well known

2. Her **disinclination** to travel surprised her friends.

Elicit

verb

/ɪˈlɪsɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Call forth (emotions, feelings, and responses)

USAGE

1. Just smiling, even if you are depressed, can **elicit** feelings of pleasure and happiness.

2. The joke **elicited** laughter from the audience.

Ardent

adjective

/ˈɑrdənt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Glowing or shining like fire
2. Characterized by strong enthusiasm
3. Characterized by intense emotion

USAGE

1. From rank to rank she darts her **ardent** eyes

2. Frightened by his **ardent** burning eyes

Buoyant

adjective

/ˈbɔɪənt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Characterized by liveliness and lightheartedness
2. Tending to float on a liquid or rise in air or gas

USAGE

1. **Buoyant** spirits

2. **Buoyant** balloons

Displace

verb

/dɪsˈpleɪs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Cause to move, usually with force or pressure
2. Terminate the employment of; discharge from an office or position
3. Take the place of or have precedence over

USAGE

1. The refugees were **displaced** by the war

2. The flood **displaced** hundreds of families from their homes.

Insight

noun

/ˈɪnˌsaɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Grasping the inner nature of things intuitively
2. Clear or deep perception of a situation
3. The clear (and often sudden) understanding of a complex situation

USAGE

1. Her **insight** into human nature helped the counselor.

2. The book gave me new **insight** into the causes of the war.

Euphemism

noun

/ˈjufəˌmɪzəm/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

An inoffensive or indirect expression that is substituted for one that is considered offensive or too harsh

USAGE

1. Saying 'passed away' is a **euphemism** for dying.

2. Calling a tax increase a 'revenue adjustment' is a **euphemism**.

Fervid

adjective

/ˈfɜrvəd/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Extremely hot
2. Characterized by intense emotion

USAGE

1. Set out…when the **fervid** heat subsides

2. He gave a **fervid** speech about freedom.

Furtive

adj.

/ˈfɜrtɪv/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Marked by quiet and caution and secrecy; taking pains to avoid being observed

USAGE

1. While at work, George and his boss Regina felt the need to be as **furtive** as possible about their romantic relationship.

2. He gave a **furtive** glance over his shoulder before slipping out.

Disfigure

verb

/dɪsˈfɪgjər/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Mar or spoil the appearance of

USAGE

1. The vandals **disfigured** the statue

2. The scar **disfigured** his face.

Soothe

verb

/suð/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Cause to feel better
2. Give moral or emotional strength to

USAGE

1. The medicine **soothes** the pain of the inflammation

2. A warm bath helped **soothe** her aching muscles.

Desecrate

verb

/ˈdɛsɪkreɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

To willfully violate or destroy a sacred place

USAGE

1. After **desecrating** the pharaoh's tomb, the archaeologist soon fell victim to a horrible illness.

2. Vandals **desecrated** the old cemetery with graffiti.

Authoritarian

noun / adjective

/əˌθɔrəˈtɛriən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) A person who behaves in a tyrannical manner
2. (adjective) Expecting unquestioning obedience

USAGE

1. An **authoritarian** regime

2. The timid child of **authoritarian** parents

Finicky

adjective

/ˈfɪnəki/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Exacting especially about details

USAGE

1. A **finicky** eater

2. The **finicky** cat refused to eat any food but fish.

Diplomatic

adjective

/ˌdɪpləˈmætɪk/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Using or marked by tact in dealing with sensitive matters or people
2. Relating to or characteristic of diplomacy

USAGE

1. The hostess averted a confrontation with a **diplomatic** chenage of subject

2. **Diplomatic** immunity

Absorb

verb

/əbˈzɔrb/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Cause to become one with
2. Consume all of one's attention or time
3. Devote (oneself) fully to

USAGE

1. The sales tax is **absorbed** into the state income tax

2. Her interest in butterflies **absorbs** her completely

Perennial

adj.

/pəˈrɛniəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Lasting an indefinitely long time; eternal; everlasting

USAGE

1. Even at the old-timers games, Stan Musial would get the loudest cheer: he was a **perennial** favorite of the fans there.

2. Complaints about traffic are a **perennial** problem in the city.

Latent

adjective

/ˈleɪtənt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (pathology) Not presently active
2. Potentially existing but not presently evident or realized

USAGE

1. **Latent** infection

2. **Latent** diabetes

Esoteric

adj.

/ˌɛsəˈtɛrɪk/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Confined to and understandable by only an enlightened inner circle

USAGE

1. Map collecting is an **esoteric** hobby to most, but to geography geeks it is a highly enjoyable pasttime.

2. The **esoteric** jargon of the field meant little to outsiders.

Zoology

noun

/zoʊˈɑlədʒi/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The branch of biology that studies animals
2. All the animal life in a particular region or period

USAGE

1. The **zoology** of the Pliocene epoch

2. She studies **zoology** and the behavior of animals.

Pedagogy

noun

/ˈpɛdəˌgoʊdʒi/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The profession of a teacher
2. The principles and methods of instruction

USAGE

1. **Pedagogy** is recognized as an important profession

2. Modern **pedagogy** favors active learning in the classroom.

Friction

noun

/ˈfrɪkʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Effort expended in moving one object over another with pressure
2. The resistance encountered when one body is moved in contact with another
3. A state of conflict between persons

USAGE

1. **Friction** between the two departments slowed the project.

2. **Friction** between the two drivers caused the accident.

Enamor

verb

/ɪˈnæmər/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Attraction or feeling of love

USAGE

1. She is completely **enamored** with Justin Bieber, and goes to all his concerts on the East coast.

2. The young prince was **enamored** of the painter's work.

Incongruous

adj.

/ɪnˈkaŋgruəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Lacking in harmony or compatibility or appropriateness

USAGE

1. The vast economic inequality of modern society is **incongruous** with America's ideals.

2. A tuxedo looked **incongruous** at the beach barbecue.

Fleeting

adjective

/ˈflitɪŋ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Lasting for a markedly brief time

USAGE

1. A **fleeting** glance

2. The **fleeting** moment of happiness was soon gone.

Incredulous

adjective

/ˌɪnˈkrɛdʒələs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Not disposed or willing to believe; unbelieving

USAGE

1. The **incredulous** customer stared at the bill.

2. She was **incredulous** when she heard the news.

Fable

noun

/ˈfeɪbəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. A story about mythical or supernatural beings or events
2. A short moral story (often with animal characters)
3. A deliberately false or improbable account

USAGE

1. The old **fable** teaches children about honesty.

2. Aesop's **fable** about the tortoise and the hare is well known.

Exception

noun

/ɪkˈsɛpʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. A deliberate act of omission
2. An instance that does not conform to a rule or generalization
3. Grounds for adverse criticism

USAGE

1. With the **exception** of the children, everyone was told the news

2. All her children were brilliant; the only **exception** was her last child

Animosity

noun

/ˌænəˈmɑsɪti/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Intense hostility

USAGE

1. The governor's **animosity** toward his rival was only inflamed when the latter spread false lies regarding the governor's first term.

2. **Animosity** between the two neighbors grew into a long feud.

Illuminate

verb

/ˌɪˈlumɪnɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Make lighter or brighter
2. Make free from confusion or ambiguity; make clear
3. Add embellishments and paintings to (medieval manuscripts)

USAGE

1. The lamp **illuminated** the dark hallway.

2. Her essay **illuminates** the causes of the war.

Delude

verb

/dɪˈlud/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Be false to; be dishonest with

USAGE

1. Do not **delude** yourself into thinking the problem will disappear.

2. Do not let the bright lights **delude** you into thinking the town is rich.

Intrepid

adj.

/ɪnˈtrɛpɪd/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Fearless

USAGE

1. Captain Ahab was an **intrepid** captain whose reckless and fearless style ultimate leads to his downfall.

2. The **intrepid** explorer crossed the desert alone.

Extol

verb

/ɪkˈstoʊl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Praise, glorify, or honor

USAGE

1. **Extol** the virtues of one's children

2. The guide **extolled** the beauty of the valley.

Ultimate

noun / adjective

/ˈʌltəmət/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) The finest or most superior quality of its kind
2. (adjective) Being the last or concluding element of a series
3. (adjective) Furthest or highest in degree or order; utmost or extreme

USAGE

1. The **ultimate** in luxury

2. The **ultimate** sonata of that opus

Insignia

noun

/ˌɪnˈsɪgˌniə/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

A badge worn to show official position

USAGE

1. The officer's **insignia** showed his rank.

2. The soldiers wore the **insignia** of their regiment on their sleeves.

Efficacy

noun

/ˈɛfɪˌkæsi/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Capacity or power to produce a desired effect

USAGE

1. Concern about the safety and **efficacy** of the vaccine

2. The **efficacy** of the new drug is still being tested.

Infuriate

verb

/ˌɪnˈfjʊriˌeɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Make furious

USAGE

1. His rude comments **infuriated** the audience.

2. The delay **infuriated** the passengers.

Ceremony

noun

/ˈsɛrəˌmoʊni/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Any activity that is performed in an especially solemn elaborate or formal way
2. The proper or conventional behavior on some solemn occasion
3. A formal event performed on a special occasion

USAGE

1. The **ceremony** of smelling the cork and tasting the wine

2. He makes a **ceremony** of addressing his golf ball

Miser

noun

/ˈmaɪzər/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

A person who doesn't like to spend money (because they are greedy)

USAGE

1. Monte was no **miser**, but was simply frugal, wisely spending the little that he earned.

2. The **miser** counted every coin twice before spending it.

Secular

noun / adjective

/ˈsɛkjələr/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) Someone who is not a clergyman or a professional person
2. (adjective) Of or relating to clergy not bound by monastic vows
3. (adjective) Not concerned with or devoted to religion;,

USAGE

1. The **secular** clergy

2. **Secular** drama

Excavate

verb

/ˈɛkskəˌveɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Remove the inner part or the core of
2. Form by hollowing
3. Find by digging in the ground

USAGE

1. The mining company wants to **excavate** the hillside

2. Carnegie had a lake **excavated** for Princeton University's rowing team

Dispel

verb

/dɪsˈpɛl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Force to go away; used both with concrete and metaphoric meanings
2. To cause to separate and go in different directions

USAGE

1. **Dispel** doubts

2. The sunshine **dispelled** the morning fog.

Veritable

adj.

/ˈvɛrɪtəbəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Truthfully, without a doubt

USAGE

1. Frank is a **veritable** life-saver -- last year, on two different occasions, he revived people using CPR.

2. The garden was a **veritable** paradise of roses.

Irrigate

verb

/ˈɪrəˌgeɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Supply with water, as with channels or ditches or streams

USAGE

1. **Irrigate** the wound

2. Farmers **irrigate** their fields during the dry season.

Seize

verb

/siz/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Capture the attention or imagination of
2. Affect
3. Take hold of; grab

USAGE

1. The movie **seized** my imagination

2. Fear **seized** the prisoners

Procrastinate

verb

/prəkˈræstəˌneɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Postpone doing what one should be doing
2. Postpone or delay needlessly

USAGE

1. He did not want to write the letter and **procrastinated** for days

2. He **procrastinated** the matter until it was almost too late

Conversant

adjective

/kənˈvɜrsənt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Familiar with or well informed about a subject

USAGE

1. He is **conversant** with several languages.

2. She is **conversant** with the latest software.

Inconsequential

adjective

/ˌɪnˌkɑnsəkˈwɛntʃəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Lacking worth or importance
2. Not following logically as a consequence

USAGE

1. His work seems trivial and **inconsequential**

2. The quite **inconsequent** fellow was managed like a puppet

Dilate

verb

/ˌdaɪˈleɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Become wider

USAGE

1. His pupils were **dilated**

2. The pupils **dilate** in the dark.

Scanty

noun / adjective

/ˈskænti/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) Short underpants for women or children (usually used in the plural)
2. (adjective) Lacking in amplitude or quantity

USAGE

1. A **scanty** harvest

2. The **scanty** meal did not satisfy the hungry workers.

Magnanimous

adj.

/mægˈnænɪməs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Noble and generous in spirit, especially towards a rival or someone less powerful

USAGE

1. He was a great sportsman: in defeat he was complementary and in victory he was **magnanimous**.

2. The **magnanimous** winner congratulated her rival warmly.

Sultry

adjective

/ˈsʌltri/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Characterized by oppressive heat and humidity
2. Sexually exciting or gratifying

USAGE

1. The summer was **sultry** and oppressive

2. A **sultry** look

Adroit

adjective

/ədˈrɔɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Quick or skillful or adept in action or thought

USAGE

1. An exceptionally **adroit** pianist

2. An **adroit** technician

Gavel

noun

/ˈgævəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

A small mallet used by a presiding officer or a judge

USAGE

1. The judge struck the **gavel** to end the session.

2. The auctioneer raised his **gavel**.

Ascetic

adj. / noun

/əˈsɛtɪk/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (adj.) Practicing self-denial
2. (noun) One who practices great self-denial

USAGE

1. His **ascetic** life is the main reason he inspired so many followers, especially since he gave up wealth and power to live in poverty.

2. Historically, **ascetics** like Gandhi are often considered wise men, partly because of their restraint.

Niggard

noun

/ˈnɪgərd/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

A selfish person who is unwilling to give or spend

USAGE

1. The **niggard** refused to pay for the dinner.

2. The **niggard** counted every coin before spending it.

Spurious

adj.

/ˈspjʊriəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Plausible but false

USAGE

1. When listening to a politician speak, it is hard to distinguish the **spurious** claims from the authentic ones.

2. The **spurious** claims were quickly exposed by fact-checkers.

Lull

noun / verb

/lʌl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) A period of calm weather
2. (noun) A pause during which things are calm or activities are diminished
3. (verb) Become quiet or less intensive

USAGE

1. There was a **lull** in the storm

2. The fighting **lulled** for a moment

Desiccate

verb / adjective

/ˈdɛsəkeɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (verb) Lose water or moisture
2. (verb) Remove water from
3. (verb) Preserve by removing all water and liquids from

USAGE

1. A **desiccate** romance

2. A prissy and emotionless creature…settles into a mold of **desiccated** snobbery

Astronomy

noun

/əsˈtrɑnəmi/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

The branch of physics that studies celestial bodies and the universe as a whole

USAGE

1. The club meets each week to discuss **astronomy**.

2. **Astronomy** is the study of stars, planets, and galaxies.

Engross

verb

/ɪnˈgroʊs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Consume all of one's attention or time
2. Devote (oneself) fully to

USAGE

1. The novel **engrossed** her for the entire weekend.

2. The detective novel **engrossed** him all night.

Extraneous

adjective

/ɛksˈtreɪniəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Coming from the outside
2. Not essential
3. Not pertinent to the matter under consideration

USAGE

1. **Extraneous** light in the camera spoiled the photograph

2. Relying upon an **extraneous** income

Splendid

adjective

/ˈsplɛndɪd/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Having great beauty and splendor
2. Characterized by grandeur
3. Very good;of the highest quality

USAGE

1. **Splendid** costumes

2. A kind of **splendiferous** native simplicity

Obstinate

adj.

/ˈɑbstənət/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Resistant to guidance or discipline; stubbornly persistent

USAGE

1. The coach suggested improvements Sarah might make on the balance beam, but she remained **obstinate**, unwilling to modify any of the habits that made her successful in the past.

2. The **obstinate** mule would not move an inch.

Metaphysics

noun

/ˌmɛtəˈfɪzɪks/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

The philosophical study of being and knowing

USAGE

1. **Metaphysics** asks what reality is made of.

2. **Metaphysics** asks questions about the nature of time and existence.

Enhancement

noun

/ɛnˈhænsmənt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

An improvement that makes something more agreeable

USAGE

1. The new software is a useful **enhancement** to the system.

2. The new lighting is a welcome **enhancement** to the stage.

Homeopathy

noun

/ˌhoʊmioʊˈpæθi/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

A method of treating disease with small amounts of remedies that, in large amounts in healthy people, produce symptoms similar to those being treated

USAGE

1. Many scientists reject **homeopathy** as ineffective.

2. Doctors do not consider **homeopathy** a proven medical treatment.

Instigation

noun

/ˌɪnstɪˈgeɪʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Deliberate and intentional triggering (of trouble or discord)
2. The verbal act of urging on

USAGE

1. The riot began at the **instigation** of a small group.

2. The fight broke out at the **instigation** of a drunk visitor.

Laudable

adj.

/ˈlɔdəbəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Worthy of high praise

USAGE

1. To say that Gandhi's actions were **laudable** is the greatest understatement; he overthrew an empire without violence.

2. Her **laudable** effort to clean the river inspired the whole town.

Exotic

adjective

/ɪgˈzɑtɪk/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Strikingly strange or unusual
2. Being or from or characteristic of another place or part of the world

USAGE

1. An **exotic** hair style

2. Protons, neutrons, electrons and all their **exotic** variants

Hamper

verb

/ˈhæmpər/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Prevent the progress or free movement of

USAGE

1. As the rain water began to collect in pools on the highway, it began to **hamper** the flow of traffic.

2. Heavy snow **hampered** rescue efforts in the mountains.

Impermeable

adj.

/ɪmˈpɜrmiəbəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Does not allow fluids to pass through

USAGE

1. The sand bags placed on the river formed an **impermeable** barrier, protecting the town from flooding.

2. The jacket's **impermeable** fabric kept the rain out.

Impoverish

verb

/ˌɪmˈpɑvrɪʃ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Take away
2. Make poor

USAGE

1. The war **impoverished** the entire region.

2. The unfair tax policy could **impoverish** the poorest families.

Hackneyed

adj.

/ˈhæknid/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Lacking significance through having been overused

USAGE

1. Cheryl rolled her eyes when she heard the lecturer's **hackneyed** advice to "be true to yourself."

2. The speech was full of **hackneyed** phrases everyone had heard before.

Cryptic

adj.

/ˈkrɪptɪk/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Mysterious or vague, usually intentionally

USAGE

1. Since Sarah did not want her husband to guess the Christmas present she had bought him, she answered **cryptically** when he asked her questions about it.

2. Her **cryptic** text message left me guessing for hours.

Durable

adjective

/ˈdʊrəbəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Existing for a long time
2. Very long lasting
3. Capable of withstanding wear and tear and decay

USAGE

1. Hopes for a **durable** peace

2. Less **durable** rocks were gradually worn away to form valleys

Ostracize

verb

/ˈɑstrəˌsaɪz/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Exclude from a community or group

USAGE

1. Later in his life, Leo Tolstoy was **ostracized** from the Russian Orthodox Church for his writings that contradicted church doctrine.

2. The club **ostracized** members who criticized its leader.

Infamous

adjective

/ˈɪnfəməs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Known widely and usually unfavorably

USAGE

1. The **infamous** Benedict Arnold

2. The **infamous** pirate was feared along the coast.

Sterile

adjective

/ˈstɛrəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Deficient in originality or creativity; lacking powers of invention
2. Incapable of reproducing
3. Free of or using methods to keep free of pathological microorganisms

USAGE

1. A **sterile** ideology lacking in originality

2. A **sterile** operating area

Shrewd

adjective

/ʃrud/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Marked by practical hardheaded intelligence
2. Used of persons

USAGE

1. He was too **shrewd** to go along with them on a road that could lead only to their overthrow

2. The **shrewd** businessman made a profit from every deal.

Indeterminate

adjective

/ˌɪndɪˈtɜrmɪnɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Not leading to a definite ending or result
2. Not capable of being determined
3. Not precisely determined or established; not fixed or known in advance

USAGE

1. An **indeterminate** campaign

2. The **indeterminate** number of plant species in the jungle

Hostility

noun

/hɑsˈtɪləti/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Violent action that is hostile and usually unprovoked
2. A hostile (very unfriendly) disposition
3. The feeling of a hostile person

USAGE

1. He could not conceal his **hostility**

2. He could no longer contain his **hostility**

Quench

verb

/kwɛntʃ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Cool (hot metal) by plunging into cold water or other liquid
2. Suppress or crush completely
3. Satisfy (thirst)

USAGE

1. **Quench** steel

2. **Quench** a rebellion

Lugubrious

adj.

/luˈgubriəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Excessively mournful

USAGE

1. At the funeral, **lugubrious** songs filled the small church.

2. The **lugubrious** song made the funeral even sadder.

Meticulous

adj.

/məˈtɪkjələs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Marked by extreme care in treatment of details

USAGE

1. The Japanese noodle maker was **meticulous** in making his noodles and would never let another person take over the task.

2. She kept **meticulous** records of every expense.

Derivative

adj.

/dɪˈrɪvətɪv/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

(of a creative product) Not original but drawing on the work of another person

USAGE

1. Because the movies were utterly **derivative** of other popular movies, they did well at the box office.

2. Critics called the album **derivative** of earlier rock records.

Hallucination

noun

/həˌlusəˈneɪʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. An object perceived during a hallucinatory episode
2. A mistaken or unfounded opinion or idea
3. Illusory perception; a common symptom of severe mental disorder

USAGE

1. He refused to believe that the angel was a **hallucination**

2. His dreams of vast wealth are a **hallucination**

Preclude

verb

/prɪˈklud/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Keep from happening or arising; make impossible

USAGE

1. The manager specified that all other gates be locked, to **preclude** the possibility of persons without tickets entering the arena undetected.

2. Heavy snow will **preclude** any flights tomorrow.

Besiege

verb

/bɪˈsidʒ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Harass, as with questions or requests; cause to feel distressed or worried

USAGE

1. After discovering a priceless artifact in her backyard, Jane was **besieged** by phone calls, emails, and reporters all trying to buy, hold or see the rare piece of history.

2. Reporters **besieged** the actor with questions outside the hotel.

Stationery

noun

/ˈsteɪʃəˌnɛri/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Paper cut to an appropriate size for writing letters; usually with matching envelopes

USAGE

1. She bought paper and pens at the **stationery** shop.

2. She bought notebooks, envelopes, and pens from the **stationery** shop.

Ludicrous

adjective

/ˈludəkrəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Broadly or extravagantly humorous; resembling farce
2. Incongruous;inviting ridicule

USAGE

1. **Ludicrous** green hair

2. It is **ludicrous** to call a cottage a mansion

Divine

noun / verb / adjective

/dɪˈvaɪn/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) Terms referring to the Judeo-Christian God
2. (noun) A clergyman or other person in religious orders
3. (verb) Search by divining, as if with a rod

USAGE

1. He claimed he could **divine** underground water

2. Her pies were simply **divine**

Audible

noun / adjective

/ˈɑdəbəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

(adjective) Heard or perceptible by the ear

USAGE

1. He spoke in an **audible** whisper

2. The speaker's voice was barely **audible** in the back row.

Imperious

adj.

/ɪmˈpɪriəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Having or showing arrogant superiority to and disdain of those one views as unworthy

USAGE

1. Children are **imperious** with each other before they learn that earning someone's respect is better than demanding.

2. The **imperious** queen expected every guest to bow.

Disparity

noun

/dɪsˈpɛrəti/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Inequality or difference in some respect

USAGE

1. There is a huge **disparity** between rich and poor.

2. The **disparity** in pay between men and women is still large.

Admissible

adjective

/ədˈmɪsəbəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Deserving to be admitted

USAGE

1. **Admissible** evidence

2. The judge ruled that the evidence was **admissible**.

Day 07- 200 Words: Analgesic through Understatement

Cards 1201 to 1400

Analgesic

noun / adjective

/ˌænəlˈdʒisɪk/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) A medicine used to relieve pain
2. (adjective) Capable of relieving pain

USAGE

1. An **analgesic** effect

2. Take an **analgesic** if the pain gets worse.

Saccharine

adjective

/ˈsækərˌaɪn/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Overly sweet

USAGE

1. The **saccharine** smile hid his true feelings.

2. The movie's **saccharine** ending was too sweet.

Pacify

verb

/ˈpæsəˌfaɪ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Fight violence and try to establish peace in (a location)
2. Cause to be more favorably inclined; gain the good will of

USAGE

1. The U.N. troops are working to **pacify** Bosnia

2. The mother gave the baby a toy to **pacify** him.

Adulterate

verb / adjective

/əˈdʌltərˌeɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

(adjective) Mixed with impurities

USAGE

1. **Adulterate** liquor

2. Some sellers **adulterate** milk with water.

Omission

noun

/oʊˈmɪʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. A mistake resulting from neglect
2. Neglecting to do something; leaving out or passing over something
3. Any process whereby sounds or words are left out of spoken words or phrases

USAGE

1. She searched the table for **omissions**

2. The **omission** of his name from the list was a mistake.

Relegate

verb

/ˈrɛləgeɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Assign to a lower position

USAGE

1. When Dexter was unable to fulfill his basic duties, instead of firing him, the boss **relegated** him to kitchen cleanup.

2. The team was **relegated** to the second division after losing the final.

Conclusive

adjective

/kənˈklusɪv/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Forming an end or termination; especially putting an end to doubt or question

USAGE

1. **Conclusive** proof

2. The evidence is **conclusive**

Legislation

noun

/ˌlɛdʒəsˈleɪʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The act of making or enacting laws
2. Law enacted by a legislative body

USAGE

1. The government passed new **legislation** on clean air.

2. The new **legislation** protects workers from unsafe conditions.

Surpass

verb

/sərˈpæs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Be or do something to a greater degree
2. Move past
3. Be greater in scope or size than some standard

USAGE

1. Her performance **surpasses** that of any other student I know

2. One line of soldiers **surpassed** the other

Quixotic

adj.

/kwɪkˈsatɪk/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Wildly idealistic; impractical

USAGE

1. For every thousand startups with **quixotic** plans to be the next big name in e-commerce, only a handful ever become profitable.

2. Her **quixotic** plan to sail around the world on a raft seemed impractical.

Reluctant

adjective

/rɪˈlʌktənt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Not eager
2. Disinclined to become involved
3. Unwillingness to do something contrary to your custom

USAGE

1. Foreigners stubbornly **reluctant** to accept our ways

2. Fresh from college and **reluctant** for the moment to marry him

Paucity

noun

/ˈpɔsɪti/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

A lack of something

USAGE

1. There is a **paucity** of jobs hiring today that require menial skills, since most jobs have either been automated or outsourced.

2. There was a **paucity** of evidence to support the claim.

Bask

verb

/bæsk/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Be exposed
2. Derive or receive pleasure from; get enjoyment from; take pleasure in

USAGE

1. The seals were **basking** in the sun

2. She relished her fame and **basked** in her glory

Constitution

noun

/ˌkɑnstəˈtuʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The act of forming or establishing something
2. The way in which someone or something is composed
3. Law determining the fundamental political principles of a government

USAGE

1. The **constitution** of a PTA group last year

2. The country's **constitution** protects freedom of speech.

Arid

adjective

/ˈærəd/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Lacking vitality or spirit; lifeless
2. Lacking sufficient water or rainfall

USAGE

1. A technically perfect but **arid** performance of the sonata

2. An **arid** climate

Misconduct

noun / verb

/mɪsˈkɑndəkt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) Activity that transgresses moral or civil law
2. (verb) Manage badly or incompetently
3. (verb) Behave badly

USAGE

1. The officer was dismissed for **misconduct**.

2. The manager was investigated for professional **misconduct**.

Viable

adjective

/ˈvaɪəbəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Capable of life or normal growth and development
2. Capable of being done with means at hand and circumstances as they are

USAGE

1. **Viable** seeds

2. A **viable** fetus

Insensible

adjective

/ˌɪnˈsɛnsəbəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Unresponsive to stimulation
2. Barely able to be perceived
3. Incapable of physical sensation

USAGE

1. He lay **insensible** where he had fallen

2. An almost **insensible** change

Clandestine

adjective

/klænˈdɛstɪn/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Conducted with or marked by hidden aims or methods

USAGE

1. **Clandestine** intelligence operations

2. The spies held a **clandestine** meeting in the park.

Brittle

noun / adjective

/ˈbrɪtəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) Caramelized sugar cooled in thin sheets
2. (adjective) Lacking warmth and generosity of spirit

USAGE

1. **Brittle** bones

2. Glass is **brittle**

Menace

noun / verb

/ˈmɛnəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) A threat or the act of threatening
2. (noun) Something that is a source of danger
3. (verb) Act in a threatening manner

USAGE

1. He spoke with desperate **menace**

2. He **menaced** the bank manager with a stick

Zealous

adjective

/ˈzɛləs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Marked by active interest and enthusiasm

USAGE

1. The **zealous** fans waited outside the stadium all night.

2. The **zealous** officer enforced every rule.

Concealment

noun

/kənˈsilmənt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The activity of keeping something secret
2. A covering that serves to conceal or shelter something
3. The condition of being concealed or hidden

USAGE

1. The simplest **concealment** is to match perfectly the color of the background

2. The **concealment** of the evidence led to a long investigation.

Cohabit

verb

/koʊˈhæbɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Share living quarters; usually said of people who are not married and live together as a couple

USAGE

1. The two students decided to **cohabit** in a small apartment.

2. The couple decided to **cohabit** before they married.

Query

noun / verb

/ˈkwiri/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) An instance of questioning
2. (verb) Pose a question

USAGE

1. She sent a **query** about the missing package.

2. He sent a **query** to the bank about the charge.

Obtuse

adj.

/ɑbˈtus/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Slow to learn or understand; lacking intellectual acuity; lacking in insight or discernment

USAGE

1. Jackson was the most **obtuse** member of the team: the manager's subtle ironies were always lost on him.

2. His **obtuse** reply showed he had missed the whole point.

Amorphous

adj.

/əˈmɔrfəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Shapeless

USAGE

1. His study plan for the GRE was at best **amorphous**; he would do questions from random pages in any one of seven test prep books.

2. The protest movement was **amorphous**, with no leaders and no formal goals.

Retaliate

verb

/rɪˈtæliˌeɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Make a counterattack and return like for like, especially evil for evil
2. Take revenge for a perceived wrong

USAGE

1. The Israeli army **retaliated** for the Hamas bombing

2. The soldiers **retaliated** after the attack.

Petulant

adj.

/ˈpɛtʃələnt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Easily irritated or annoyed

USAGE

1. When Ed first met Ruth, he didn't realize she was so **petulant**, but now that they are three months into their relationship, Ed feels a day doesn't go by in which she isn't whining about some minor issue.

2. The **petulant** toddler crossed his arms and refused to eat.

Connive

verb

/kəˈnaɪv/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Form intrigues (for) in an underhand manner
2. Encourage or assent to illegally or criminally

USAGE

1. The servants **connived** to steal the jewels.

2. The clerks **connived** with the manager to hide the losses.

Vapid

adjective

/ˈvæpɪd/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Lacking significance or liveliness or spirit or zest
2. Lacking taste or flavor or tang

USAGE

1. A **vapid** conversation

2. A **vapid** smile

Resentment

noun

/rɪˈzɛntmənt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

A feeling of deep and bitter anger and ill-will

USAGE

1. Her **resentment** grew when she was passed over for promotion.

2. **Resentment** grew between the two brothers after the will was read.

Cloture

noun / verb

/ˈkloʊtʃər/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) A rule for limiting or ending debate in a deliberative body
2. (verb) Terminate debate by calling for a vote

USAGE

1. **Cloture** the discussion

2. The senators voted for **cloture** to end the debate.

Wholesome

adjective

/ˈhoʊlsəm/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Sound or exhibiting soundness in body or mind
2. Conducive to or characteristic of physical or moral well-being

USAGE

1. Exercise develops **wholesome** appetites

2. A grin on his ugly **wholesome** face

Curiosity

noun

/ˌkjʊriˈɑsəti/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Something unusual -- perhaps worthy of collecting
2. A state in which you want to learn more about something

USAGE

1. Her **curiosity** led her to explore every room in the house.

2. **Curiosity** led the child to open every box in the attic.

Verify

verb

/ˈvɛrəˌfaɪ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Confirm the truth of
2. To declare or affirm solemnly and formally as true
3. Attach or append a legal verification to (a pleading or petition)

USAGE

1. Please **verify** that the doors are closed

2. **Verify** a claim

Intellect

noun

/ˈɪntəˌlɛkt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Knowledge and intellectual ability
2. The capacity for rational thought or inference or discrimination
3. A person who uses the mind creatively

USAGE

1. He has a keen **intellect**

2. Her **intellect** impressed every professor.

Plagiarism

noun

/ˈpleɪdʒərˌɪzəm/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The act of plagiarizing; taking someone's words or ideas as if they were your own
2. A piece of writing that has been copied from someone else and is presented as being your own work

USAGE

1. The student was punished for **plagiarism**.

2. The editor found clear evidence of **plagiarism** in the article.

Frieze

noun

/friz/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

A heavy woolen fabric with a long nap

USAGE

1. A carved **frieze** ran along the top of the temple wall.

2. The **frieze** on the building shows scenes from ancient battles.

Accentuate

verb

/ækˈsɛntʃueɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Put stress on; utter with an accent
2. To stress, single out as important

USAGE

1. The bright scarf **accentuates** her eyes.

2. The red belt **accentuates** her slim waist.

Accuse

verb

/əkˈjuz/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Bring an accusation against; level a charge against
2. Blame for, make a claim of wrongdoing or misbehavior against

USAGE

1. The neighbors **accused** the man of spousal abuse

2. They **accused** him of stealing the money.

Accumulation

noun

/əkˌjumjəˈleɪʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The act of accumulating
2. Several things grouped together or considered as a whole
3. An increase by natural growth or addition

USAGE

1. The **accumulation** of dust covered the old books.

2. The **accumulation** of snow closed the road for three days.

Impromptu

noun / adjective / adverb

/ˌɪmˈpramptu/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) An extemporaneous speech or remark
2. (adjective) With little or no preparation or forethought
3. (adverb) Without advance preparation

USAGE

1. A witty **impromptu** must not sound premeditated

2. An **impromptu** speech

Taint

noun / verb

/teɪnt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) The state of being contaminated
2. (verb) Contaminate with a disease or microorganism
3. (verb) Place under suspicion or cast doubt upon

USAGE

1. The scandal **tainted** the reputation of the whole team.

2. Rumors can **taint** a person's name.

Conspicuous

adj.

/kənˈspɪkjuəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Without any attempt at concealment; completely obvious

USAGE

1. American basketball players are always **conspicuous** when they go abroad: not only are they American, but some are over seven feet tall.

2. The bright red jacket made her **conspicuous** in the crowd.

Homogeneous

adjective

/ˌhoʊməˈdʒiniəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

All of the same or similar kind or nature

USAGE

1. A close-knit **homogeneous** group

2. The town was **homogeneous**, with few people from other backgrounds.

Amendment

noun

/əˈmɛndmənt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

The act of amending or correcting

USAGE

1. The new **amendment** changed the rules for voting.

2. The **amendment** added a new clause about privacy.

Nondescript

noun / adjective

/ˈnɑndɪsˈkrɪpt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

(noun) A person is not easily classified and not very interesting

USAGE

1. Women dressed in **nondescript** clothes

2. A **nondescript** novel

Valiant

adjective

/ˈvæljənt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Having or showing valor

USAGE

1. A **valiant** attempt to prevent the hijack

2. A **valiant** soldier

Recondite

adj.

/ˈrɛkəndaɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Difficult to penetrate; incomprehensible to one of ordinary understanding or knowledge

USAGE

1. I found Ulysses **recondite** and never finished the book, waiting instead to read it with someone else so we could penetrate its meaning together.

2. The lecture covered **recondite** theories that few students had heard of.

Flaunt

noun / verb

/flɔnt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) The act of displaying something ostentatiously
2. (verb) Display proudly; act ostentatiously or pretentiously

USAGE

1. His behavior was an outrageous **flaunt**

2. He liked to **flaunt** his expensive watch.

Suspicious

adjective

/səsˈpɪʃəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Not as expected
2. Openly distrustful and unwilling to confide

USAGE

1. **Suspicious** behavior

2. The guard became **suspicious** of the man at the gate.

Pessimism

noun

/ˈpɛsəˌmɪzəm/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

The feeling that things will turn out badly

USAGE

1. Her **pessimism** made her expect the worst in every situation.

2. **Pessimism** about the economy spread quickly through the office.

Quorum

noun

/ˈkwɔrəm/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

A gathering of the minimal number of members of an organization to conduct business

USAGE

1. The meeting could not begin without a **quorum**.

2. The board could not vote because there was no **quorum**.

Viscous

adjective

/ˈvɪskəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Having the sticky properties of an adhesive
2. Having a relatively high resistance to flow

USAGE

1. The **viscous** honey dripped slowly from the spoon.

2. The **viscous** paint took a long time to spread.

Cumulative

adjective

/ˈkjumjələtɪv/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Increasing by successive addition

USAGE

1. The benefits are **cumulative**

2. The **cumulative** effect of small savings is large.

Oral

noun / adjective

/ˈɔrəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) An examination conducted by spoken communication
2. (adjective) Using speech rather than writing

USAGE

1. The **oral** cavity

2. The **oral** mucous membrane

Termination

noun

/tərməˈneɪʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The act of ending something
2. The end of a word (a suffix or inflectional ending or final morpheme)
3. Something that results

USAGE

1. The **termination** of the agreement

2. The **termination** of the contract came as a surprise.

Nostalgia

noun

/nɔsˈtældʒə/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Longing for something past

USAGE

1. Old photographs filled her with **nostalgia** for her childhood.

2. Old songs from her youth always fill her with **nostalgia**.

Revenue

noun

/ˈrɛvəˌnu/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The entire amount of income before any deductions are made
2. Government income due to taxation

USAGE

1. The company's **revenue** rose sharply this year.

2. The city's **revenue** from tourism rose sharply last year.

Satiate

verb / adjective

/ˈseɪʃiˌeɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (verb) Overeat or eat immodestly; make a pig of oneself
2. (verb) Fill to satisfaction
3. (adjective) Supplied (especially fed) to satisfaction

USAGE

1. A large meal **satiated** his hunger.

2. Full and **satiate**, the guests leaned back in their chairs.

Infer

verb

/ˌɪnˈfɜr/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Believe to be the case
2. Guess correctly; solve by guessing
3. Reason by deduction; establish by deduction

USAGE

1. From her silence, we can **infer** that she is upset.

2. From the empty plates, we can **infer** that the guests have left.

Subscribe

verb

/səbsˈkraɪb/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Adopt as a belief
2. Mark with one's signature; write one's name (on)
3. Receive or obtain regularly

USAGE

1. I **subscribe** to your view on abortion

2. The broker **subscribed** 500 shares

Simulate

verb

/ˈsɪmjələt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Make a pretence of
2. Create a representation or model of
3. Reproduce someone's behavior or looks

USAGE

1. The pilots are trained in conditions **simulating** high-altitude flights

2. The software **simulates** the flight of a plane.

Luminous

adjective

/ˈlumənəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Softly bright or radiant

USAGE

1. A sky **luminous** with stars

2. The moon cast a **luminous** glow over the lake.

Saturate

verb

/ˈsætʃərˌeɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Infuse or fill completely

USAGE

1. Heavy rain **saturated** the ground in the field.

2. The sponge became **saturated** with water after the spill.

Impending

adj.

/ɪmˈpɛndɪŋ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Close in time; about to occur

USAGE

1. The **impending** doom of our world has been a discussed and debated for 2000 years--maybe even longer.

2. The **impending** storm forced the fishermen to return early.

Plethora

noun

/ˈplɛθərə/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Extreme excess

USAGE

1. The shop offers a **plethora** of options for every budget.

2. The library holds a **plethora** of books on history.

Hyperbole

noun

/haɪˈpɜrbəˌli/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Extravagant exaggeration

USAGE

1. Saying you are starving is a **hyperbole**, but it makes the point.

2. Saying the test took a million years is pure **hyperbole**.

Coddle

verb

/ˈkɑdəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Cook in nearly boiling water
2. Treat with excessive indulgence

USAGE

1. **Coddle** eggs

2. Parents should not **coddle** children too much.

Perjury

noun

/ˈpɜrdʒəri/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Criminal offense of making false statements under oath

USAGE

1. The witness was charged with **perjury** after lying in court.

2. He was sentenced for **perjury** after lying under oath.

Narrative

noun / adjective

/ˈnærətɪv/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

(adjective) Consisting of or characterized by the telling of a story

USAGE

1. His **narrative** was interesting

2. **Narrative** poetry

Burlesque

noun / verb / adjective

/bərˈlɛsk/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (verb) Make a parody of
2. (adjective) Relating to or characteristic of a burlesque

USAGE

1. **Burlesque** theater

2. The comedy show was a **burlesque** of the classic play.

Obsolete

adjective

/ˈɑbsəˌlit/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

No longer in use

USAGE

1. **Obsolete** words

2. Floppy disks are now **obsolete**.

Opportune

adjective

/ˌɑpərˈtun/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Suitable or at a time that is suitable or advantageous especially for a particular purpose

USAGE

1. An **opportune** place to make camp

2. An **opportune** arrival

Injustice

noun

/ˌɪnˈdʒʌstɪs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. An unjust act
2. The practice of being unjust or unfair

USAGE

1. Her campaign fought the **injustice** in the legal system.

2. The **injustice** of the verdict angered the entire community.

Sediment

noun / verb

/ˈsɛdəmənt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) Matter that has been deposited by some natural process
2. (verb) Settle as sediment
3. (verb) Deposit as a sediment

USAGE

1. **Sediment** settled at the bottom of the glass.

2. **Sediment** settled at the bottom of the river after the flood.

Overweening

adj.

/ˌoʊvərˈwiniŋ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Arrogant; presumptuous

USAGE

1. Mark was so convinced of his basketball skills that in his **overweening** pride he could not fathom that his name was not on the varsity list; he walked up to the basketball coach and told her she had forgotten to add his name.

2. The **overweening** director ignored every suggestion from his team.

Vitality

noun

/vaɪˈtæləti/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. An energetic style
2. The property of being able to survive and grow
3. A healthy capacity for vigorous activity

USAGE

1. The **vitality** of a seed

2. The old man still had the **vitality** of a much younger person.

Accomplish

verb

/əˈkɑmplɪʃ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Put in effect
2. To gain with effort

USAGE

1. With hard work, we can **accomplish** our goals.

2. She hopes to **accomplish** her goals before she turns thirty.

Bizarre

adjective

/bəˈzɑr/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Conspicuously or grossly unconventional or unusual

USAGE

1. Restaurants of **bizarre** design--one like a hat, another like a rabbit

2. The **bizarre** story made no sense to anyone.

Impassivity

noun

/ˌɪmpæˈsɪvɪti/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Apathy demonstrated by an absence of emotional reactions

USAGE

1. His **impassivity** during the trial surprised the jury.

2. The nurse answered the frightening news with calm **impassivity**.

Classification

noun

/ˌklæsəfəˈkeɪʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The act of distributing things into classes or categories of the same type
2. The basic cognitive process of arranging into classes or categories
3. A group of people or things arranged by class or category

USAGE

1. The **classification** of the plants is shown in the table.

2. The **classification** of animals into groups is based on their features.

Stimulant

noun / adjective

/ˈstɪmjələnt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) A drug that temporarily quickens some vital process
2. (noun) Any stimulating information or event; acts to arouse action
3. (adjective) That stimulates

USAGE

1. **Stimulant** phenomena

2. Caffeine is a common **stimulant** found in coffee and tea.

Impious

adjective

/ˌɪmˈpaɪəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Lacking piety or reverence for a god
2. Lacking due respect or dutifulness

USAGE

1. **Impious** toward one's parents

2. The **impious** king mocked the priests.

Imperial

noun / adjective

/ˌɪmˈpɪriəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) A piece of luggage carried on top of a coach
2. (noun) A small tufted beard worn by Emperor Napoleon III
3. (adjective) Belonging to or befitting a supreme ruler

USAGE

1. Golden age of **imperial** splendor

2. **Imperial** palace

Strident

adjective

/ˈstraɪdənt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Unpleasantly loud and harsh
2. Being sharply insistent on being heard
3. Conspicuously and offensively loud; given to vehement outcry

USAGE

1. **Strident** demands

2. The **strident** voice of the speaker filled the room.

Onerous

adjective

/ˈoʊnərəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Not easily borne; wearing

USAGE

1. My duties weren't **onerous**; I only had to greet the guests

2. The **onerous** duties left him no time to rest.

Commiseration

noun

/kəˌmɪzəˈreɪʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. An expression of sympathy with another's grief
2. A feeling of sympathy and sorrow for the misfortunes of others

USAGE

1. He offered his **commiseration** after she lost the match.

2. The neighbors offered their **commiseration** after the fire.

Rationale

noun

/ˌræʃəˈnæl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

(law) An explanation of the fundamental reasons (especially an explanation of the working of some device in terms of laws of nature)

USAGE

1. The **rationale** for capital punishment

2. The manager explained the **rationale** behind the decision.

Precede

verb

/prɪˈsid/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Furnish with a preface or introduction
2. Move ahead (of others) in time or space
3. Be the predecessor of

USAGE

1. She always **precedes** her lectures with a joke

2. Bill **preceded** John in the long line of Susan's husbands

Assurance

noun

/əˈʃʊrəns/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Freedom from doubt; belief in yourself and your abilities
2. A statement intended to inspire confidence
3. A binding commitment to do or give or refrain from something

USAGE

1. His **assurance** in his superiority did not make him popular

2. The President's **assurances** were not respected

Adverse

adjective

/ædˈvɜrs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. In an opposing direction
2. Contrary to your interests or welfare

USAGE

1. **Adverse** currents

2. **Adverse** circumstances

Sabotage

noun / verb

/ˈsæbəˌtɑʒ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

(verb) Destroy property or hinder normal operations

USAGE

1. The Resistance **sabotaged** railroad operations during the war

2. The workers accused the owners of **sabotage**.

Resilient

adjective

/rɪˈzɪljənt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Elastic; rebounds readily
2. Recovering readily from adversity, depression, or the like

USAGE

1. As **resilient** as seasoned hickory

2. Children are often **resilient** after difficult times.

Reside

verb

/rɪˈzaɪd/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Live (in a certain place)
2. Make one's home in a particular place or community
3. Be inherent or innate in

USAGE

1. She **resides** in Princeton

2. May parents **reside** in Florida

Horde

noun

/hɔrd/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. A vast multitude
2. A moving crowd
3. A nomadic community

USAGE

1. A **horde** of fans rushed into the stadium.

2. A **horde** of insects covered the field.

Mince

noun / verb

/mɪns/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) Food chopped into small bits
2. (verb) Make less severe or harsh
3. (verb) Cut into small pieces

USAGE

1. A **mince** of mushrooms

2. **Mince** the garlic

Labyrinth

noun

/ˈlæbərˌɪnθ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Complex system of paths or tunnels in which it is easy to get lost

USAGE

1. The old city is a **labyrinth** of narrow alleys.

2. The maze was a **labyrinth** of hedges.

1300 / 1400

Zest

noun / verb

/zɛst/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) A tart spicy quality
2. (noun) Vigorous and enthusiastic enjoyment
3. (verb) Add herbs or spices to

USAGE

1. She approached the new job with **zest** and energy.

2. Lemon **zest** adds flavor to the cake.

Accommodate

verb

/əˈkɑməˌdeɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Make fit for, or change to suit a new purpose
2. Make (one thing) compatible with (another)
3. Provide a service or favor for someone

USAGE

1. The scientists had to **accommodate** the new results with the existing theories

2. Can you **accommodate** me with a rental car?

1302 / 1400

Accord

noun / verb

/əˈkɔrd/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) Sympathetic compatibility
2. (noun) A written agreement between two states or sovereigns
3. (noun) Concurrence of opinion

USAGE

1. We are in **accord** with your proposal

2. The two nations signed an **accord** to end the war.

1303 / 1400

Preface

noun / verb

/ˈprɛfəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) A short introductory essay preceding the text of a book
2. (verb) Furnish with a preface or introduction

USAGE

1. He **prefaced** his lecture with a critical remark about the institution

2. The author wrote a short **preface** for the new edition.

Regal

adjective

/ˈrigəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Belonging to or befitting a supreme ruler

USAGE

1. **Regal** attire

2. The queen walked into the hall with a **regal** bearing.

Filibuster

noun / verb

/ˈfɪləˌbʌstər/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

(verb) Obstruct deliberately by delaying

USAGE

1. The senator delayed the vote with a long **filibuster**.

2. They **filibustered** for twelve hours.

Abject

adjective

/ˈæbdʒɛkt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Showing humiliation or submissiveness
2. Of the most contemptible kind
3. Most unfortunate or miserable

USAGE

1. An **abject** apology

2. **Abject** cowardice

Preeminent

adjective

/priˈɛmənənt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Greatest in importance or degree or significance or achievement

USAGE

1. A **preeminent** archeologist

2. She is the **preeminent** expert in her field.

Heterogeneous

adjective

/ˌhɛtərəˈdʒinjəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Originating outside the body
2. Consisting of elements that are not of the same kind or nature

USAGE

1. The population of the United States is vast and **heterogeneous**

2. The city has a **heterogeneous** population from many countries.

Inhibition

noun

/ˌɪnhəˈbɪʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The action of prohibiting or inhibiting or forbidding (or an instance thereof)
2. (psychology) The conscious exclusion of unacceptable thoughts or desires
3. The quality of being inhibited

USAGE

1. A medical **inhibition** of alcoholic beverages

2. The **inhibition** of the heart by the vagus nerve

Agile

adjective

/ˈædʒəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Moving quickly and lightly
2. Mentally quick

USAGE

1. Sleek and **agile** as a gymnast

2. An **agile** mind

Perception

noun

/pərˈsɛpʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Becoming aware of something via the senses
2. The process of perceiving
3. Knowledge gained by perceiving

USAGE

1. A man admired for the depth of his **perception**

2. Luther had a new **perception** of the Bible

Verdant

adjective

/ˈvɜrdənt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Characterized by abundance of verdure

USAGE

1. The **verdant** hills were covered in green grass.

2. The **verdant** garden was full of fresh plants.

Unjustified

adjective

/ənˈdʒʌstəˌfaɪd/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Lacking justification or authorization

USAGE

1. The criticism was **unjustified** and unfair.

2. The **unjustified** price increase angered customers.

Credence

noun

/ˈkridəns/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Belief in something

USAGE

1. He placed no **credence** in psychics, claiming that they offered no special powers beyond the ability to make people part with their money.

2. The judge gave no **credence** to the rumor.

Rogue

noun

/roʊg/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

A deceitful and unreliable scoundrel

USAGE

1. The **rogue** elephant charged at the cars.

2. The **rogue** agent refused to follow orders.

Fairness

noun

/ˈfɛrnəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The quality of being good looking and attractive
2. Conformity with rules or standards
3. The property of having a naturally light complexion

USAGE

1. The judge recognized the **fairness** of my claim

2. **Fairness** requires that everyone gets an equal chance.

Alacrity

noun

/əˈlækrɪti/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

An eager willingness to do something

USAGE

1. The first three weeks at his new job, Mark worked with such **alacrity** that upper management knew it would be giving him a promotion.

2. She accepted the invitation with **alacrity**.

Parody

noun / verb

/ˈpɛrədi/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) Humorous or satirical mimicry
2. (verb) Make a parody of
3. (verb) Make a spoof of or make fun of

USAGE

1. The comedy show was a **parody** of the political news.

2. She wrote a **parody** of the famous poem.

Manifest

noun / verb / adjective

/ˈmænəˌfɛst/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) A customs document listing the contents put on a ship or plane
2. (verb) Reveal its presence or make an appearance
3. (verb) Record in a ship's manifest

USAGE

1. The ghost **manifests** each year on the same day

2. The buildings in Rome **manifest** a high level of architectural sophistication

Corroboration

noun

/kərˌɔbərˈeɪʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Confirmation that some fact or statement is true through the use of documentary evidence

USAGE

1. The witness's account needed **corroboration** from another source.

2. The reporter needed **corroboration** from a second witness.

Repulse

noun / verb

/riˈpʌls/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) An instance of driving away or warding off
2. (verb) Force or drive back
3. (verb) Cause to move back by force or influence

USAGE

1. The soldiers **repulsed** the attack.

2. The smell **repulsed** the children.

Penchant

noun

/ˈpɛntʃənt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

A strong liking

USAGE

1. The Irish have a **penchant** for blarney

2. He has a **penchant** for old jazz records.

Amalgamate

verb / adjective

/əˈmælgəˌmeɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (verb) To bring or combine together or with something else
2. (adjective) Joined together into a whole

USAGE

1. The **amalgamated** colleges constituted a university

2. The two schools will **amalgamate** next year.

Anticipation

noun

/ænˌtɪsəˈpeɪʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The act of predicting (as by reasoning about the future)
2. Something expected (as on the basis of a norm)
3. An expectation

USAGE

1. Each of them had their own **anticipations**

2. The children waited in **anticipation** for the holiday.

Concession

noun

/kənˈsɛʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. A contract granting the right to operate a subsidiary business
2. The act of conceding or yielding
3. A point conceded or yielded

USAGE

1. He got the beer **concession** at the ball park

2. They won all the **concessions** they asked for

Torpor

noun

/ˈtɔrpər/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Inactivity resulting from lethargy and lack of vigor or energy

USAGE

1. After work, I was expecting my colleagues to be enthusiastic about the outing, but I found them in a state of complete **torpor**.

2. The afternoon heat left the whole town in a **torpor**.

Morbid

adjective

/ˈmɔrbəd/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Caused by or altered by or manifesting disease or pathology
2. Suggesting the horror of death and decay
3. Suggesting an unhealthy mental state

USAGE

1. A **morbid** growth

2. **Morbid** details

Adhere

verb

/ədˈhɪr/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Follow through or carry out a plan without deviation
2. Come or be in close contact with; stick or hold together and resist separation
3. Stick to firmly

USAGE

1. They **adhered** to their plan

2. Will this wallpaper **adhere** to the wall?

Invariable

noun / adjective

/ˌɪnˈvɛriəbəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) A quantity that does not vary
2. (adjective) Not liable to or capable of change

USAGE

1. An **invariable** temperature

2. An **invariable** rule

1330 / 1400

Amend

verb

/əˈmɛnd/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Set straight or right
2. To make better
3. Make amendments to

USAGE

1. **Amend** the document

2. The lawyer asked the court to **amend** the document.

Assent

noun / verb

/əˈsɛnt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) Agreement with a statement or proposal to do something
2. (verb) To agree or express agreement

USAGE

1. He gave his **assent** eagerly

2. The Maestro **assented** to the request for an encore

Paradox

noun

/ˈpɛrəˌdɑks/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

(logic) A statement that contradicts itself

USAGE

1. `I always lie' is a **paradox** because if it is true it must be false

2. It is a **paradox** that the richest people are not always the happiest.

Mandate

noun / verb

/ˈmænˌdeɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) A document giving an official instruction or command
2. (verb) Assign authority to

USAGE

1. The new director of the school board **mandated** regular tests

2. **Mandate** a colony

Overbearing

adjective

/ˈoʊvərˈbɛrɪŋ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Expecting unquestioning obedience

USAGE

1. Insufferably **overbearing** behavior toward the waiter

2. Her **overbearing** manner made the team uncomfortable.

Eloquence

noun

/ˈɛləkwəns/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Powerful and effective language

USAGE

1. His **eloquence** attracted a large congregation

2. Her **eloquence** won over the crowd in minutes.

Surreptitious

adj.

/ˌsɜrəpˈtɪʃəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Stealty, taking pains not to be caught or detected

USAGE

1. Since his mom was a light sleeper, Timmy had to tiptoe **surreptitiously** through the entire house, careful to not make the floors creak, until he at last was able to enjoy his plunder: a box of chocolate chip cookies.

2. She made a **surreptitious** call from the bathroom.

Forsake

verb

/fɔrˈseɪk/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Leave someone who needs or counts on you; leave in the lurch

USAGE

1. He would never **forsake** his friends in trouble.

2. The lost traveler felt **forsaken** in the desert.

Mollify

verb

/ˈmɑlɪfaɪ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

To make someone angry less angry; placate

USAGE

1. In the morning, Harriat was unable to **mollify** Harry, if he happened to become angry, unless he had his cup of coffee.

2. A free dessert **mollified** the angry customers.

Acrid

adjective

/ˈækrɪd/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Harsh or corrosive in tone
2. Strong and sharp

USAGE

1. Her **acrid** remarks make her many enemies

2. The **acrid** smell of burning rubber

1340 / 1400

Malice

noun

/ˈmæləs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The quality of threatening evil
2. Feeling a need to see others suffer

USAGE

1. He spoke with **malice** about his former colleague.

2. Her comments were full of **malice**, but nobody took them seriously.

Rue

noun / verb

/ru/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) (French) a street or road in France
2. (noun) Sadness associated with some wrong done or some disappointment

USAGE

1. To his **rue**, the error cost him the game

2. She would **rue** the day she signed the contract.

Monotony

noun

/məˈnɑtəni/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Constancy of tone or pitch or inflection
2. The quality of wearisome constancy, routine, and lack of variety

USAGE

1. He had never grown accustomed to the **monotony** of his work

2. The **monotony** of the long drive made everyone sleepy.

Rarefy

verb

/ˈrɛrəfaɪ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Weaken the consistency of (a chemical substance)
2. Make more subtle or refined
3. Lessen the density or solidity of

USAGE

1. High mountains **rarefy** the air.

2. At high altitude, the air becomes **rarefied** and thin.

Rational

noun / adjective

/ˈræʃənəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) An integer or a fraction
2. (adjective) Of or associated with or requiring the use of the mind
3. (adjective) Consistent with or based on or using reason

USAGE

1. A **rational** analysis

2. The triumph of the **rational** over the animal side of man

Recluse

noun / adjective

/rɪkˈlus/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) One who lives in solitude
2. (adjective) Withdrawn from society; seeking solitude

USAGE

1. Lived an unsocial **reclusive** life

2. The **recluse** rarely left his small house in the woods.

Inquisitive

adjective

/ˌɪnˈkwɪzɪtɪv/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Showing curiosity
2. Inquiring or appearing to inquire

USAGE

1. If someone saw a man climbing a light post they might get **inquisitive**

2. The police are proverbially **inquisitive**

Gusto

noun

/ˈgʌsˌtoʊ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Vigorous and enthusiastic enjoyment

USAGE

1. The children ate their dinner with **gusto**.

2. He sang the final song with great **gusto**.

Rancor

noun

/ˈræŋkər/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

A feeling of deep and bitter anger and ill-will

USAGE

1. Old **rancor** between the families never faded.

2. **Rancor** divided the two parties for years.

Segregate

noun / verb

/ˈsɛgrəˌgeɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) Someone who is or has been segregated
2. (verb) Divide from the main body or mass and collect
3. (verb) Separate by race or religion; practice a policy of racial segregation

USAGE

1. The sun **segregates** the carbon

2. Large mining claims are **segregated** into smaller claims

1350 / 1400

Disparate

adj.

/ˈdɪspərət/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Two things are fundamentally different

USAGE

1. With the advent of machines capable of looking inside the brain, fields as **disparate** as religion and biology have been brought together by scientists trying to understand what happens in the brain when people have a religious experience.

2. The committee included **disparate** voices from several industries.

Supplant

verb

/səˈplænt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Take the place or move into the position of

USAGE

1. For many, a cell phone has **supplanted** a traditional phone; in fact, most 20-somethings don't even have a traditional phone anymore.

2. Digital maps have **supplanted** paper atlases in most classrooms.

Exonerate

verb

/ɪgˈzɑnəreɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Pronounce not guilty of criminal charges

USAGE

1. The document clearly indicated that Nick was out of the state at the time of the crime, and so served to **exonerate** him of any charges.

2. New DNA evidence **exonerated** the man after twenty years in prison.

Restitution

noun

/ˌrɛstɪˈtuʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Getting something back again
2. The act of restoring something to its original state
3. A sum of money paid in compensation for loss or injury

USAGE

1. Upon the **restitution** of the book to its rightful owner the child was given a tongue lashing

2. The company offered **restitution** to the families of the victims.

Paradigm

noun

/ˈpɛrəˌdaɪm/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. A standard or typical example
2. The generally accepted perspective of a particular discipline at a given time
3. Systematic arrangement of all the inflected forms of a word

USAGE

1. He framed the problem within the psychoanalytic **paradigm**

2. The discovery shifted the **paradigm** of modern medicine.

Astonishment

noun

/əsˈtɑnɪʃmənt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

The feeling that accompanies something extremely surprising

USAGE

1. He looked at me in **astonishment**

2. To her **astonishment**, she had won the prize.

Random

adjective

/ˈrændəm/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Lacking any definite plan or order or purpose; governed by or depending on chance

USAGE

1. A **random** choice

2. Bombs fell at **random**

Carnage

noun

/ˈkɑrnɪdʒ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

The savage and excessive killing of many people

USAGE

1. The battle left the field covered in **carnage**.

2. The earthquake left the streets in **carnage**.

Renewable

adjective

/riˈnuəbəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Capable of being renewed; replaceable
2. That can be renewed or extended

USAGE

1. **Renewable** energy such as solar energy is theoretically inexhaustible

2. A **renewable** lease

Prevail

verb

/prɪˈveɪl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Be widespread in a particular area at a particular time; be current:
2. Prove superior

USAGE

1. During the labor negotiations, an air of hostility **prevailed** in the office.

2. Before the cricket match, Australia was heavily favored, but India **prevailed**.

Tentative

adjective

/ˈtɛntətɪv/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Under terms not final or fully worked out or agreed upon
2. Unsettled in mind or opinion

USAGE

1. Just a **tentative** schedule

2. Drew a few **tentative** conclusions

Momentary

adjective

/ˈmoʊmənˌtɛri/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Lasting for a markedly brief time

USAGE

1. Rapid **momentaneous** association of things that meet and pass

2. A **momentary** glimpse

Acerbic

adj.

/əˈsɜrbɪk/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Harsh in tone

USAGE

1. Most movie critics are **acerbic** towards summer blockbusters, often referring to them as garbage.

2. Her **acerbic** comments about the new menu made the chef wince.

Skepticism

noun

/ˈskɛptɪˌsɪzəm/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Doubt about the truth of something
2. The disbelief in any claims of ultimate knowledge

USAGE

1. Her **skepticism** about the claims was reasonable.

2. The audience greeted the claim with **skepticism**.

Slither

verb

/ˈslɪðər/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

To pass or move unobtrusively or smoothly

USAGE

1. The snake began to **slither** through the grass.

2. The lizard began to **slither** across the hot rocks.

1365 / 1400

Allegiance

noun

/əˈlidʒəns/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

The loyalty that citizens owe to their country (or subjects to their sovereign)

USAGE

1. The soldiers swore **allegiance** to the king.

2. Each soldier pledged **allegiance** to the flag.

Conflagration

noun

/ˌkɑnfləˈgreɪʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

A very intense and uncontrolled fire

USAGE

1. In the summer months, **conflagrations** are not uncommon in the southwest, do to the heat and lack of rain.

2. A **conflagration** swept through the forest in minutes.

Shirk

verb

/ʃɜrk/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Avoid dealing with
2. Avoid (one's assigned duties)

USAGE

1. She **shirks** her duties

2. The derelict soldier **shirked** his duties

Shun

verb

/ʃʌn/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Avoid and stay away from deliberately; stay clear of
2. Expel from a community or group

USAGE

1. The community began to **shun** the family after the scandal.

2. The town chose to **shun** the company after the pollution scandal.

Fragmentary

adjective

/ˈfrægmənˌtɛri/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Consisting of small disconnected parts

USAGE

1. **Fragmentary** remains

2. The **fragmentary** records made the history hard to piece together.

Vacillate

verb

/ˈvæsəleɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Be undecided about something; waver between conflicting positions or courses of action

USAGE

1. Some students **vacillate** between schools when deciding which to attend, while others focus only on one school.

2. The voters **vacillated** between the two candidates until election day.

Maelstrom

noun

/ˈmeɪlstrəm/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

A powerful circular current of water (usually the result of conflicting tides)

USAGE

1. The ship was swallowed by the **maelstrom** of waves.

2. The boat was caught in a **maelstrom** of crashing waves.

Systematic

adjective

/ˌsɪstəˈmætɪk/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Characterized by order and planning
2. Of or relating to taxonomy

USAGE

1. The investigation was very **systematic**

2. A **systematic** administrator

Tact

noun

/tækt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Consideration in dealing with others and avoiding giving offense

USAGE

1. In a tremendous display of **tact**, Shelly was able to maintain a strong friendship with Marcia, even though Marcia's husband, Frank, confessed to finding Shelley more attractive than Marcia.

2. She handled the awkward question with great **tact**.

Veracity

noun

/vərˈæsɪti/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Unwillingness to tell lies

USAGE

1. The judge questioned the **veracity** of the witness.

2. The reporter checked the **veracity** of every quote in the story.

President

noun

/ˈprɛzəˌdɛnt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The office of the United States head of state
2. The chief executive of a republic
3. The person who holds the office of head of state of the United States government

USAGE

1. A **President** is elected every four years

2. The **President** likes to jog every morning

Desultory

adjective

/ˈdɛsəlˌtɔri/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Marked by lack of definite plan or regularity or purpose; jumping from one thing to another

USAGE

1. **Desultory** thoughts

2. The **desultory** conversation characteristic of cocktail parties

Succinct

adjective

/səkˈsɪŋkt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Briefly giving the gist of something

USAGE

1. **Succinct** comparisons

2. Her **succinct** answer covered every point in one sentence.

Urbane

adj.

/ɜrˈbeɪn/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Showing a high degree of refinement and the assurance that comes from wide social experience

USAGE

1. Because of his service as an intelligence officer and his refined tastes, W. Somerset Maugham became the inspiration for the **urbane** and sophistcate spy James Bond.

2. The **urbane** diplomat spoke five languages with ease.

Apprehension

noun

/ˌæprɪˈhɛnʃən/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Fearful expectation

USAGE

1. Test day can be one of pure **apprehension**, as many students worry about their test scores.

2. She felt **apprehension** as the plane began its descent.

Probability

noun

/ˌprɑbəˈbɪləˌti/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

The quality of being probable; a probable event or the most probable event

USAGE

1. For a while mutiny seemed a **probability**

2. Going by past experience there was a high **probability** that the visitors were lost

Validate

verb

/ˈvælədeɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Make valid or confirm the validity of
2. Prove valid; show or confirm the validity of something
3. Give evidence for

USAGE

1. **Validate** a ticket

2. The results **validate** the theory.

Zenith

noun

/ˈzinɪθ/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

The highest point; culmination

USAGE

1. At the **zenith** of his artistic career, Elvis was outselling any other artist on the charts.

2. The band reached its **zenith** with the final album.

Veracious

adj.

/vəˈreɪʃəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Truthful

USAGE

1. While we elect our leaders in the hope that every word they speak will be **veracious**, history has shown that such a hope is naive.

2. The **veracious** witness told the court exactly what she had seen.

1384 / 1400

Marshal

noun / verb

/ˈmɑrʃəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) (in some countries) a military officer of highest rank
2. (verb) Make ready for action or use
3. (verb) Arrange in logical order

USAGE

1. **Marshal** resources

2. **Marshal** facts or arguments

Stint

noun / verb

/stɪnt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) An individual's prescribed share of work
2. (noun) Smallest American sandpiper
3. (noun) An unbroken period of time during which you do something

USAGE

1. Her **stint** as a lifeguard exhausted her

2. She worked a three-month **stint** at the hospital.

Arabesque

noun

/ˌærəˈbɛsk/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

An ornament that interlaces simulated foliage in an intricate design

USAGE

1. The dancer held a graceful **arabesque** on one leg.

2. The ballerina balanced in a graceful **arabesque**.

Cogent

adj.

/ˈkoʊdʒənt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Clear and persuasive

USAGE

1. A **cogent** argument will change the minds of even the most skeptical audience.

2. The lawyer made a **cogent** argument that persuaded the jury.

Moralistic

adjective

/ˌmɔrəˈlɪstɪk/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Narrowly and conventionally moral

USAGE

1. The **moralistic** speech lectured everyone about their habits.

2. Her **moralistic** attitude annoyed her friends.

Analogous

adj.

/əˈnæləgəs/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Similar in some respects but otherwise different

USAGE

1. In many ways, the Internet's transformative effect on society has been **analogous** to that of the printing press.

2. The new software is **analogous** to the old system, though it works differently.

1390 / 1400

Slander

noun / verb

/ˈslændər/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) An abusive attack on a person's character or good name
2. (noun) Words falsely spoken that damage the reputation of another

USAGE

1. He was sued for **slander** after the false report.

2. The newspaper was sued for **slander** after printing the rumor.

Perpetual

adjective

/pərˈpɛtʃuəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Uninterrupted in time and indefinitely long continuing
2. Continuing forever or indefinitely

USAGE

1. The **perpetual** struggle to maintain standards in a democracy

2. Hell's **perpetual** fires

Inure

verb

/ɪˈnjʊr/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

To make accustomed to something unpleasant

USAGE

1. Three years of Manhattan living has **inured** her to the sound of wailing sirens; she could probably sleep through the apocalypse.

2. Soldiers are **inured** to hardship after years of training.

Mock

noun / verb / adjective

/mak/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. (noun) The act of mocking or ridiculing
2. (verb) Treat with contempt
3. (verb) Imitate with mockery and derision

USAGE

1. They made a **mock** of him

2. The new constitution **mocks** all democratic principles

Collaborate

verb

/kəˈlæbərˌeɪt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Work together on a common enterprise of project
2. Cooperate as a traitor

USAGE

1. He **collaborated** with the Nazis when they occupied Paris

2. Two scientists **collaborated** on the new study.

Protract

verb

/proʊtˈrækt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Lengthen in time; cause to be or last longer

USAGE

1. The meeting was **protracted** by long, unnecessary speeches.

2. The debate was **protracted** far beyond its scheduled time.

Uphold

verb

/əpˈhoʊld/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Stand up for; stick up for; of causes, principles, or ideals
2. Support against an opponent
3. Keep or maintain in unaltered condition; cause to remain or last

USAGE

1. The judge chose to **uphold** the decision of the lower court.

2. The court's job is to **uphold** the original verdict.

Inept

adjective

/ˌɪˈnɛpt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. Revealing lack of perceptiveness or judgment or finesse
2. Generally incompetent and ineffectual
3. Not elegant or graceful in expression

USAGE

1. An **inept** remark

2. **Inept** handling of the account

Metaphorical

adjective

/ˌmɛtəˈfɔrɪkəl/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

Expressing one thing in terms normally denoting another

USAGE

1. A **metaphorical** expression

2. **Metaphoric** language

Vanity

noun

/ˈvænəti/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

1. The trait of being unduly vain and conceited; false pride
2. The quality of being valueless or futile
3. Feelings of excessive pride

USAGE

1. His **vanity** made him check his reflection every few minutes.

2. Her **vanity** made her spend hours in front of the mirror.

Understatement

noun

/ˈʌndərsˌteɪtmənt/

PRONUNCIATION

MEANING

A statement that is restrained in ironic contrast to what might have been said

USAGE

1. Calling the storm 'a bit windy' was an **understatement**.

2. Calling the flood 'a little wet' was a clear **understatement**.